CHENNAI - TUESDAY - OCTOBER 13, 2026

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SCAN FOR LOCATION

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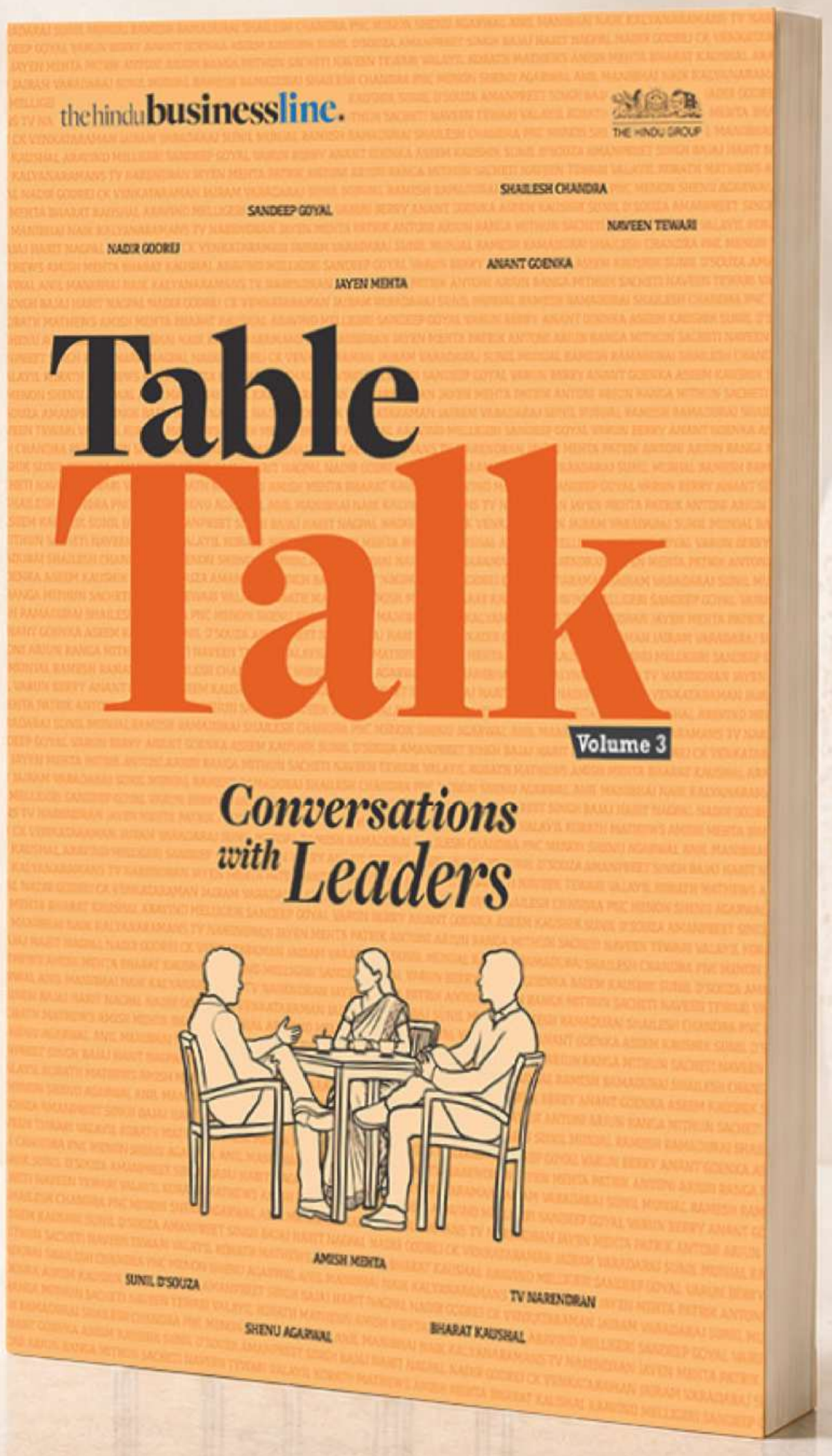
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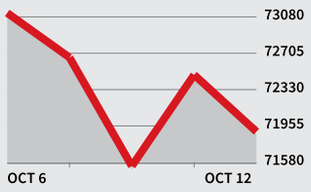
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SENSEX 71924.68 (-547.65)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	22363.35	-157.10
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.07	-0.15
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.77	-0.96
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	147468.00	-1364
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	220295.00	-814

COST CONTROL.

Supreme Court questions why 30% margin cap limited to cancer drugs and not extended to other essential medicines **p11**



SHINING BRIGHT.

Positive inflows, led by China, into gold ETFs continued for the 12th week in a row **p10**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

QUICKLY.

DESPITE EQUITY SELL-OFF

SIP inflows hit fresh high of ₹32,490 crore in Sept



Mumbai: Systematic investment plan (SIP) inflows hit a new high of ₹32,490 crore in September, up from ₹32,297 crore in August, despite the continued equity sell-off amid global headwinds. Overall, equity MF inflows rose to a five-month high of ₹38,306 crore from ₹29,328 crore in August, per data from the Association of Mutual Funds in India. **p8**

FEE DEBATE

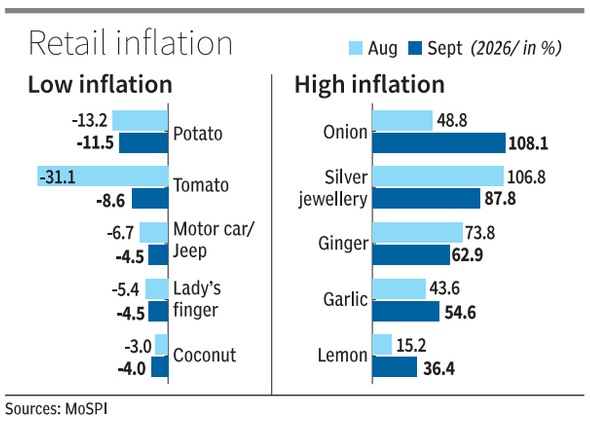
UPI MDR rollout on Oct 15; deferment unclear

Mumbai: Days before the merchant discount rate (MDR) rollout, a senior NPCI official said there was no information on a possible deferment or whether the Supreme Court's direction to file a short affidavit would affect the timeline. The NPCI decided on September 14 to levy MDR on UPI transactions above ₹2,000. The Finance Ministry announced the applicable rates the next day, with implementation scheduled for October 15. **p4**

Retail inflation hits 21-month high in Sept on higher food prices

WORRISOME. Low base, costlier fuel push inflation to 5.54% — close to the RBI's 6% ceiling

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi



Sources: MoSPI

Retail inflation rose to a 21-month high of 5.54 per cent in September, as a low base a year ago amplified the impact of rising food prices, signalling that price pressures are strengthening beyond a statistical rebound.

Inflation, measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI), rose from 4.83 per cent in August and 1.54 per cent in September 2025, bringing it close to the upper end of the Reserve Bank of India's 2-6 per cent target band.

Economists warn that rising food prices and broader price pressures could push inflation closer to, or above, the 6 per cent ceiling in the coming months, raising the prospect of further repo rate hikes by the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC).

PRICE PRESSURES

The increase extended beyond food, with price pressures broadening across consumption categories.

"About 11 to 12 subgroups recorded higher inflation in September, indicating generalisation of inflation," said Devendra Pant, Chief Economist at India Ratings & Research.

Pant noted that inflation had been rising since November 2025, with September marking the fourth consecutive month of inflation above 4 per cent.

Sujan Hajra, Chief Economist at Anand Rathi Group, said the low base had amplified headline inflation, but the sequential rise in food prices suggested that the increase was not entirely base-driven.

FUEL IMPACT

"Food inflation continued to quicken, driven by a broader set of sub-segments amid below-normal rainfall, imported price pressures and derivative fuel impacts," said Radhika Rao, Senior Economist at DBS Bank.

She expects the combination of a low base and higher food, fuel and services inflation to push headline inflation closer to 6 per cent in the fourth quarter of 2026.

FURTHER RATE HIKES

With inflation nearing the upper end of the RBI's target band, economists expect the central bank to remain alert to the risk of a further breach.

Upasna Bhardwaj, Chief Economist at Kotak Mahindra Bank, expects inflation to exceed 6 per cent in the coming months as adverse base effects and food-price shocks play out.

She considers the RBI's revised inflation estimates realistic.

"We expect an additional 50 bps repo rate hike, with upside risks likely if geopolitical risks do not subside," she said.

Rajeev Sharan, Head of Research at Brickwork Ratings, said the September reading reinforced the RBI's hawkish turn following its 25-basis-point rate hike in October.

Markets, he added, were pricing in another increase in December.

HOUSEHOLD BUDGETS

"Sticky food inflation alongside rising rates could strain household budgets and retail-loan servicing," Sharan said, adding that contained core inflation would moderate the broader risks.

2 Americans win economics Nobel

Press Trust of India
Stockholm

American economists Robert E Hall and Michael Woodford won the Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences on Monday for their work on models that have helped governments and central banks manage economic shocks, including energy crises and inflation.

Hall is affiliated with Stanford University in California, and Woodford with Columbia University in New York.

Also read **p11**

Rupee rebounds, G-Sec yields jump

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The RBI's weekend measures to curb speculation and contain forex market volatility had the desired effect, with the rupee gaining about 1 per cent at the opening. G-Sec yields jumped on hopes that the RBI will accelerate rate hikes amid inflation concerns.

The rupee opened 97 paise stronger at ₹95.76/$ but pared gains to close at ₹95.77, recovering almost all its losses over the past two weeks.

Details **p4**

IRDAI may go slow on distribution fee reforms

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) is likely to take a cautious approach to the proposed distribution reforms, as building consensus among stakeholders remains a challenge.

The regulator may extend the October 25 deadline for submitting feedback to allow wider consultations and push back the reforms implementation timeline, according to sources.

The IRDAI released a consultation paper on distribution reforms on September 23, proposing caps on insurer expenses, including commissions.

METHODOLOGY ISSUES

Industry representatives, including insurance company heads, have raised concerns over the methodology for calculating current distribution costs, including commissions, and the tighter norms proposed for the bancassurance channel. Some proposals on health insurance have also come up for discussion, an industry source told *businessline*.

While the IRDAI is keen to make insurance more affordable and has asked stakeholders to explore options such as non-financial incentives to lower distribution costs, the industry has called for a viable commission structure and a review of the proposed norms.

Consensus is also needed on bancassurance, which the regulator's data identify as one of the costliest insurance distribution channels.

The consultation paper noted that, instead of translating into lower costs or better customer outcomes, the extensive customer reach of bancassurance entities appeared to be contributing to the maximisation of commission income.

Banks are also assessing the potential impact of commission caps on their 'other income'. They are expected to participate in the consultation process through the Reserve Bank of India.

PHASED ROLLOUT

Insurers have sought a phased rollout or a longer implementation window, beyond the start of the next financial year, said sources.

The Insurance Brokers Association of India has also taken its concerns beyond the IRDAI and sought an appointment with Prime Minister Narendra Modi to present its views on the proposed reforms.



CHENNAI
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TUESDAY - OCTOBER 13 - 2026

Tata Trusts gets time till Oct 19 to reply to trustees



Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) has secured a one-week extension to submit its response to complaints alleging misgovernance, filed by two trustees, Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh.

The trust, the largest shareholder in Tata Sons, was given seven days until October 12 to respond to the allegations. Now, it has been granted time till October 19.

Srinivasan and Singh had asked the Charity Commissioner of Maharashtra to probe into SDTT's affairs and raised concerns over Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata's move to ask the Tata Sons board to explore steps other than listing. Srinivasan also accused Tata of trying to carry out a power grab.

SDTT has denied all assertions and also filed a caveat to ensure it gets heard before any order is passed.

HCLTech's Q2 profit rises 21% to ₹5,132 cr, powered by AI services

STRONG SHOWING. Raises growth guidance to 2.5-4%; partners with Anthropic to build enterprise AI solutions

Our Bureau
New Delhi



Noida-headquartered HCLTech's consolidated net profit rose 21.1 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) to ₹5,132 crore in the second quarter ended September 30, outpacing the 11.5 per cent growth in revenue from operations to ₹35,620 crore.

The growth came as operational efficiencies, expansion of existing client relationships and rising demand for Advanced AI services helped the company offset pricing pressures from AI-led automation.

The company also declared an interim dividend of ₹12 per equity share of face value ₹2 for FY27.

Scorecard

	Q2 FY26	Q2 FY27	% change
Revenue (₹ cr)	31,942	35,620	11.5
Net profit (₹ cr)	4,236	5,132	21.1
TCV (new deal wins) ($ billion)	2.57	3.26	26.8
Total headcount	2,26,640	2,30,339	1.6

Source: Company

GROWTH DRIVER
The performance reflects a shift in its growth drivers, with AI-led offerings adding to its traditional IT and engineering services business.

HCLTech secured several contracts from the US and Europe during the quarter to develop AI-powered solutions across manufacturing, banking, engineering and cybersecurity, among other areas.

On Monday, HCLTech also announced a global partnership with Anthropic under which it will establish a dedicated business unit to develop agentic AI solutions using Claude for enterprise clients. Its software arm will also embed Anthropic's AI models in select products.

"The accelerating growth in Advanced AI revenue validates our business strategy. Through strategic partnerships and continued investments across the full AI stack, HCLTech is well-positioned to be a trusted technology partner for enterprises and governments globally," Roshni Nadar Malhotra, Chairperson of HCLTech, said.

MAIN BUSINESS
The company's IT and business services revenue rose to ₹26,938 crore from ₹23,693 crore a year ago, while engineering and R&D services revenue increased to ₹5,973 crore from ₹5,423 crore. Growth across these businesses indicates that demand for technology services continues even as clients look to integrate AI into their operations.

HCLTech also reported an increase in the number of large clients. It had 23 clients generating more than $100 million in revenue during the quarter, compared with 22 a year ago.

The number of clients in the $50 million-plus category grew to 62 from 54.

EMBEDDING AI
"A new offering in advanced AI is helping us capture a share of the ever-growing spend in the tech ecosystem. This quarter's template is what we aspire to repeat in the future," said C Vijayakumar, CEO and MD. "We offset effectively the AI-related deflation, grow wallet share and market share in the core services and add a top-up to all of that by delivering strong growth in Advanced AI services."

AI-related deflation refers to the pressure on traditional IT services revenue as AI tools automate tasks that previously required more human effort.

Vijayakumar said the company was proactively embedding AI across its delivery model, both in existing and new engagements, with visible benefits in productivity, quality and client outcomes. AI was also deepening client relationships and driving larger engagements, he added.

HCLTech also raised its revenue growth guidance for FY27 to 2.5-4 per cent from the earlier range of 1-4 per cent. Its EBIT margin guidance, however, remains unchanged at 17.5-18.5 per cent.

'Short-term impact of AI investments will be cushioned by margin'

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai


K Krithivasan, CEO, TCS

Voicing bullish sentiments on AI focused growth, TCS CEO K Krithivasan said the company margins can cushion any impact from the technology investment in the near-term.

"We believe the margin gives the cushion to aggressively grow and invest. And there will always be short-term impact because we have had to invest in terms of AI capability. But we stay close to our projected margin levels," Krithivasan told *businessline*.

MARGIN PRESSURE
While the AI revenue has become 10 per cent of TCS' revenue and growing faster, the overall company margin remains at 24 per cent.

Despite being lower than street expectations, the company has stressed on its strategy to continue investments into AI talent, partnerships, M&A, niche talent, higher bench and subcontractors. Some of these factors were offset this quarter by currency gains and operating leverage, according to Nuvama Research.

"While near-term margins face pressure, we view investments for growth as the right strategy," said Nuvama in its research note, flagging margin headwinds in coming months as investments for future growth.

Other brokerages noted the company's confidence in AI revenue carrying materially higher margins. Anand Rathi said, "The associated costs will weigh before revenue conversion, with [auto-consulting firm] MHP expected to add approximately 50bps of margin dilution depending on the closure timing."

Hero MotoCorp struggles to meet festival demand as supply chains face new pressures

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Hero MotoCorp is struggling to keep pace with a festival surge in two-wheeler demand following GST reductions. This is even as commodity cost pressures and growing competition for semiconductors from AI and emerging industries complicate the supply-chain outlook for Indian manufacturers.

'GOOD PROBLEM'
"This is an opportunity that has come after a long time that we are not able to supply enough. It's a good problem to have," Vikram Kasbekar, Executive Director, Hero MotoCorp, said on the sidelines of a Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) visionary leadership for manufacturing event in Mumbai on Monday.

> There are pressures from the commodity point of view. And that is something that we need to be prepared for
>
> **VIKRAM KASBEKAR**
> Executive Director



Kasbekar said the broader automobile industry was benefiting from GST reductions, with manufacturers gearing up to meet stronger demand. The recovery has created an unusual situation in which automakers must increase supplies while navigating uncertainties in global sourcing and input costs. Asked about increasing battery and cell prices and their implications for EV manufacturers, Kasbekar said, "Definitely, there are pressures from the commodity point of view. And that is something that we need to be prepared for." He did not quantify the impact on Hero MotoCorp's margins or indicate whether the company would pass on higher costs to consumers.

On semiconductor availability, Kasbekar said companies were adopting different sourcing strategies based on their requirements for microprocessors, controllers and other electronic components. He identified Taiwan as a leading source of advanced microprocessors and pointed to growing demand from AI-related computing, storage and processing applications.

THE WARNING
Jamshyd N Godrej, CMD of Godrej Enterprises Group, cautioned against pursuing manufacturing self-sufficiency, saying India's industrial competitiveness depended on access to supply chains. "Global supply chains are essential," he said.

He pointed to India's machine-tool industry, which continues to depend on overseas suppliers for ultra-precision machinery, laser equipment, and advanced cutting tools despite decades of experience. "Can we make everything? My answer is no," he said.

GE Aerospace to nearly double India sourcing spend

Our Bureau
New Delhi



WHAT LIES AHEAD. The company said more than 1,400 of its commercial engines were currently in service in India, and over 3,200 are expected to be delivered over the next decade REUTERS

GE Aerospace plans to nearly double its spending on sourcing from India by 2030, from around $200 million in 2025.

This is as the company expands its engagement with the country's aerospace manufacturing ecosystem, a senior company executive said.

Speaking at the company's "India Taking Flight: Aviation, Innovation, and the Road to Viksit Bharat 2047" event here, Vikram Rai, Chief Executive Officer, South Asia, GE Aerospace, said the planned increase reflected confidence in India's aviation ecosystem and manufacturing capabilities.

RISING DEMAND
According to the company, its in-country supply chain includes 17 major domestic partners, including small and medium-sized enterprises, alongside its Pune manufacturing facility. Accordingly, the increased spending will support the development of this ecosystem to meet rising demand from the aviation industry.

"It's in the components machined in Pune, the innovation in Bengaluru, and our trusted customers, who are building the next generation of India's aerospace industry," said Rai.

The sourcing expansion comes against the backdrop of rising passenger demand, growing connectivity and substantial expenditure on aviation infrastructure.

Besides, Rai said more than 1,400 commercial engines from GE Aerospace and its joint ventures were currently in service in India, with over 3,200 engines expected to be delivered over the next nine to 10 years. Approximately nine out of every 10 aircraft delivered to Indian airlines over the next decade will be powered by GE Aerospace or its joint ventures, he said.

At the event, the company launched "Powering Progress: GE Aerospace's Economic Impact in India", a report compiled by EY examining its contribution across commercial aviation, defence, manufacturing and engineering.

THE OPPORTUNITY
According to the report, GE Aerospace and its partner engines are expected to power most of the approximately 1,500 new aircraft already on order with Indian carriers.

The report values the associated opportunity for India's maintenance, repair and overhaul (MRO) industry at more than $5.5 billion.

Separately, Rai highlighted the contribution of the company's Bengaluru Technology Centre, established in 2000. According to the company, the centre has secured more than 1,000 aviation patents and contributed to the design, development and certification of the GE9X engine.

CenturyPly aims ₹600 cr annual revenue from new manufacturing facility

Our Bureau
Kolkata

THE ADVANTAGE
The unit's location in Hoshiarpur offers proximity to an established timber, plywood ecosystem, skilled manpower and efficient connectivity to consumption centres. It's expected to improve product availability, too

Century Plyboards inaugurated its ₹215-crore greenfield plywood manufacturing facility in Hoshiarpur, Punjab, on Monday, marking a significant step in the company's expansion strategy and strengthening its presence in North India.

The facility will commence operations with an annual production capacity of 60,000 cubic metres (CBM), with the second phase planned to scale the capacity to 1 lakh CBM within the next six months. At full capacity, the facility is expected to contribute an annual revenue of around ₹600 crore.

CLOSER TO CUSTOMERS
The facility is spread over 27 acres and has been designed to cater to the growing demand for plywood across northern and north-western markets, the Kolkata-based company said.

The Hoshiarpur facility is Century Plyboards' seventh plywood manufacturing plant in the country, adding to its existing manufacturing network across West Bengal, Assam, Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, Haryana and Uttarakhand. The new facility will further strengthen the company's ability to serve key markets including Punjab, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, Delhi-NCR, Rajasthan and UP.

"For us, this is not simply about adding capacity. It is about getting closer to our customers, strengthening our supply chain and being more agile in responding to changing market needs," said Nikita Bansal, Executive Director, Century Plyboards.

The company has the flexibility to build capacity in line with market demand, Bansal said. The addition of the facility comes at a time when CenturyPly's existing plywood manufacturing network is operating at high-capacity utilisation.

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GP Petroleums eyes ₹3,000 cr turnover through global integration, automotive bet

Mahesh Ravidas Nayak
Mumbai

Under the leadership of Dilip Vaswani, former CMD of Total India, and a three-decade veteran of the global energy and lubricants industry, GP Petroleums Ltd (GPPL) is embarking on what could be the biggest transformation in its 50-year history.

From a largely India-focused industrial lubricants company, GPPL is preparing to evolve into a diversified international energy and lubricants platform with a projected turnover of about ₹3,000 crore.

Vaswani sees striking parallels between his past experience at ELF and the opportunity before him at GPPL. "When you are starting from virtually zero, the only way is up," said Vaswani, Non-Executive Director at GPPL.

BUILDING IT
The restructuring plan revolves around integrating a portfolio of assets acquired by Incubit, GPPL's new strategic investor that hold close to 14 per cent stake in the company as of June 2026.

Once consolidated, the combined entity is expected to generate revenue of around ₹3,000 crore, compared with GPPL's standalone turnover of roughly ₹643 crore as on FY26.

But Vaswani insists the story is not merely about acquisitions.The larger opportunity lies in transforming GPPL's business mix. The company has historically had a limited presence in automotive lubricants, a segment that accounts for nearly 55 per cent of India's lubricant market and offers higher margins. To address that gap, GPPL is revamping its distribution network, strengthening its leadership team, and leveraging its licensing arrangement with Spanish lubricant major Repsol.

THE ROADMAP
- The restructuring plan revolves around integrating a portfolio of acquired assets
- These include lubricant manufacturing operations in Nigeria and Tanzania and fuel retail networks in Kenya and Uganda
- It also includes a terminal asset at Pipavav and the Dubai-based lubricant company MagLube


Dilip Vaswani, Non-Executive Director, GP Petroleums

"The main focus is now on growing the automotive business," Vaswani said. GPPL expects annaul automotive lubricant volumes to increase nearly five-fold to about 20,000 tonnes over the next five years.

AFRICA PUSH
Beyond India, Vaswani sees Africa as a major growth engine. He believes the continent offers both scale and attractive margins. GPPL plans to expand its fuel retail network in Kenya and Uganda from about 40 stations to nearly 100 over the next few years.

Technology is another pillar of the growth blueprint. GPPL has recently appointed an AI leader and is investing in digital tools aimed at improving efficiency and enabling expansion.

Tax provision reversal lifts Swan Defence's Q2 net

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Gujarat-based Swan Defence and Heavy Industries Ltd (SDHI) reported a net profit of ₹566 crore for Q2 FY27, compared with a loss of ₹55 lakh in the year-ago period, largely aided by a one-time write-back of an earlier tax provision of ₹563 crore.

Revenue from operations rose 72.5 per cent y-o-y to ₹69 crore.

The tax provision write-back related to a reassessment of tax provisions carried in the books of the transferor company, Triumph Offshore Pvt Ltd, after its amalgamation with SDHI

TaMo's final €14.40 offer faces test as Iveco shareholders hold the key

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai



IN THE MAKING. If completed, the acquisition will create a global group with roughly €21 billion in annual revenue REUTERS

Tata Motors' €3.91-billion bid for Iveco Group has entered its most decisive phase, with the automaker making what it has described as its "best and final" offer of €14.40 a share and ruling out any further increase.

While a key shareholder vote this week could significantly improve the transaction's chances, the ultimate outcome will still depend on whether enough investors are willing to tender their shares at the revised price. Sources close to Tata Motors said it remains confident of securing the deal.

The company's confidence has risen after Exor, Iveco's largest shareholder, committed its 27.06 per cent stake and continues to control more than 43 per cent of the voting rights. If shareholders approve the restructuring proposal, Tata Motors will gain an alternative route to complete the acquisition even if it falls short of the original 95 per cent threshold. But the final offer remains the deal's defining test.

Market participants are closely watching the stance of large minority shareholders, particularly Davidson Kempner, Syquant Capital and Petrus Advisers, which together are said to hold about 20 per cent of Iveco.

THE AFTERMATH
Experts say the consequences of a failed transaction would be far more severe for Iveco than for Tata Motors

BEARING THE BRUNT
Kranthi Bathini, Director, Equity Strategy at WealthMills Securities, said the consequences of a failed transaction would be far more severe for Iveco than for Tata Motors.

"For Tata Motors, it will remove immediate integration and currency exposure risks, freeing up capital for debt reduction, defending domestic market share and scaling its EV business. But it will also delay Tata's ambition to establish a significant presence in the western CV markets," Bathini said.

For Iveco, however, the stakes are considerably higher. "The collapse of the transaction could trigger a correction in its shares, leaving the company to fund Europe's costly transition to cleaner commercial vehicles without the financial backing of a larger parent," he said.

That asymmetry, analysts say, explains why the focus has shifted from Tata Motors' strategic rationale to whether Iveco shareholders believe the final offer adequately reflects the company's long-term value.

Arlekar named TN Governor, Mathur moved to Keralam



Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Keralam Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar has been appointed as the Governor of Tamil Nadu, as part of a major gubernatorial reshuffle effected by President Droupadi Murmu on Monday.

Om Prakash Mathur, Governor of Sikkim, will be the new Governor of Keralam in place of Arlekar, a communique issued by the Rashtrapati Bhavan said. Dushyant Gautam has been appointed the Governor of Sikkim, it said.

Senior BJP leader from Jharkhand, Braj Mohan Ram, has been appointed as the Governor of Odisha.

Sudha Yadav has been named the Governor of Karnataka and Dhal Singh Bisen will be Uttarakhand Governor, the communique said.

India's petroleum product exports help reduce $ burn

FOREX CUSHION. Export earnings offset 26-30% of import bill amid volatile oil prices

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The current geopolitical turmoil has led to high prices of crude oil, transport and marine insurance, which, coupled with a weak rupee against the US dollar, is pushing up India's oil and gas import as well as its current account deficit (CAD). However, the same factors are also helping the world's third largest crude oil importer to reduce its US dollar outflows, albeit in a moderate range. India imports more than 88 per cent of its crude oil requirement.

For instance, while India's oil and gas import bill during FY25 and FY26 averaged at $166.65 billion, export earnings stood at $42.75 billion, which helped compensate for roughly 26 per cent of the import bill.

Oil & gas bill ($ billion)

	June		July		August	
	Import*	Export	Import*	Export	Import*	Export
2024	14.3	3.5	15.1	3.7	14.8	3.4
2025	13	3.3	12.7	3.3	12.9	3.5
2026	17.4	4.3	16.2	5	14.2	5

Source: PPAC
*Imports include crude oil, petroleum products & LNG. Export is of petroleum products

HIGH FREIGHT RATES

During June-August 2026, India's oil and gas imports averaged at $15.93 billion, while exports averaged at $4.77 billion, helping compensate for around 30 per cent of the total import bill.

Analysts and refiners pointed out that record high shipping freight rates and high marine insurance premiums are adding more volatility to high crude oil prices. India's CAD has risen to $11.2 billion during April-July this fiscal year against $6.6 billion during the same period in FY26.

Oil Minister H S Puri in October 2025 said that oil marketing companies (OMCs) pay around $5 per barrel to transport crude from the US and about $1.2 from West Asia.

In the last 5 years, PSUs such as IOCL, BPCL, and HPCL have spent nearly $8 billion on chartering ships.

Ashish Rajodiya, Head of Commodities at PL Capital, said the rupee has opened Monday with a rebound of around 1 per cent to near 95.80 against the dollar, from Friday's close of 96.71. "From today (Monday) it will sell dollars to Indian Oil, HPCL and BPCL to cover their entire daily requirement until further notice, taking a major source of dollar demand out of the spot market. The catch is the cost: dollar sales to oil companies will draw down reserves, which already slipped by nearly $13 billion in the week to October 2," he added.

On Monday evening, Brent was at $106.8 per barrel and Murban was at $110.6 a barrel. The crude oil price for Indian basket on Friday (October 9) was $124.22 per barrel. The monthly Indian basket price for October 2026 averaged at $121.85 a barrel, the highest in the current fiscal year.

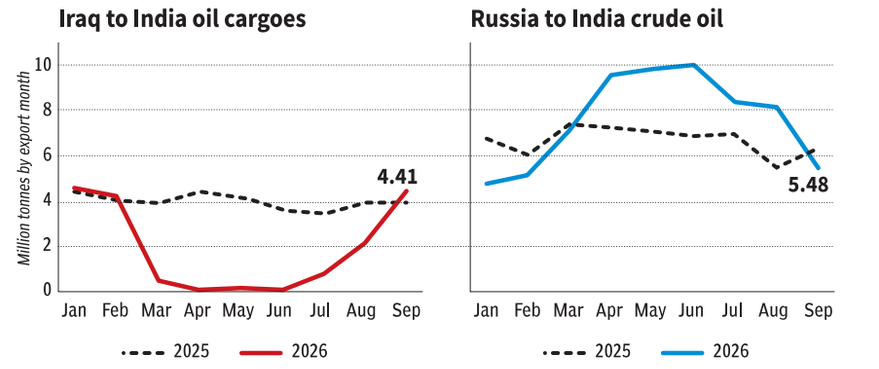
PRICE PINCH

As per ICRA, a $10 per barrel uptick in the average crude oil price for the fiscal pushes up the net oil imports by around $12-13 billion during the year, thereby enlarging the CAD by 0.3 per cent of GDP.

The price pinch also reflects in CPI inflation, which CareEdge Ratings said rose to a 23-month high of 5.5 per cent in September, breaching the RBI's 4 per cent target for the fourth consecutive month. Global energy prices remained volatile amid the ongoing conflict in West Asia. Higher energy costs contributed to transport inflation, while elevated cooking fuel and food prices kept inflation high in restaurant and accommodation services.

Iraq crude shipments to India rebound as Russian supplies fall

Mixed bag



T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Iraqi crude oil shipments to India more than doubled in September as Indian refiners increased purchases from the Persian Gulf supplier, amid elevated shipping risks and rising freight rates.

Shipments from Iraq's Basrah port to India rose 106.3 per cent month on month to 4.41 million tonnes in September, up 13.7 per cent year on year, according to data from Greece-based shipping analytics firm Signal Ocean.

The rebound comes at a time when Russian crude shipments to India declined 32.3 per cent from August to 5.48 mt. Russian shipments had ranged between 7.1 mt million and 9.9 mt a month from March to August, the report said.

Iraqi supplies, which had nearly stalled between March and July, resumed in August and have peaked in September. There were about 21 voyages from Basrah to Indian terminals during the month, compared with nine in August, Maria Bertzeletou, Signal's senior market analyst and author of the report, told *businessline*. The September total of 4.41 mt is just above the January–February average of 4.38 mt, says the report.

On the other hand, Russian crude shipments to India was between 7.1 mt and 9.9 mt a month from March to August, but declined to 5.48 mt in September.

The September volume of Iraqi crude was slightly above the average of 4.38 mt recorded in January and February, before disruptions to Gulf oil movements, the report says.

The return of Iraqi cargoes is supporting tanker demand even as shipping conditions remain uncertain. The extent to which freight rates ease will depend on the continuity of export programmes, improved transit conditions and greater vessel availability, said an industry source.

PEAKS IN LATE SEPT

The highest level of shipment activity was recorded between September 27 and 29. The shipment continued during the first 10 days of October, although at a lower level, Bertzeletou said.

The cargoes were destined for Sikka and Vadinar in Gujarat. Sikka accounted for about 75 per cent of the discharge destinations and Vadinar about 26 per cent.

Indian Oil Corporation, Reliance Industries, Bharat Petroleum Corporation and HPCL-Mittal Energy were among the refiners buying Iraqi crude on a free-on-board (FOB) basis and arranging tankers to transport the cargoes, the report said.

Under FOB purchases, refiners arrange vessels and onward transportation, bringing tanker availability, freight rates and voyage-related risks more directly into their crude procurement decisions.

The vessels travelled from Basrah's offshore oil terminals through the Arabian Gulf and the Strait of Hormuz, across the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea, before reaching the Gulf of Kutch and the Sikka or Vadinar terminals, Bertzeletou said. The increase in Iraqi crude shipments coincided with disruptions to Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline.

The shift to FOB purchases makes vessel chartering and voyage costs a more direct consideration for refiners, particularly when security concerns affect shipping and insurance.

The UK Maritime Trade Operations reported attacks on vessels transiting the Strait of Hormuz during September. Its September 21 report included vessels affected by incidents that continued towards their destinations. The Iraqi crude shipments took place despite the security risks, Bertzeletou said.

RISKS REMAIN

The recovery in Iraqi supplies has not eliminated the risks associated with transporting crude from the region. Elevated war-risk insurance quotations and uncertainty around shipping routes continue to complicate voyage planning and vessel availability, Bertzeletou added.

RE power generation surpasses 100 BUs in a quarter

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

India's power generation from renewable energy sources (excluding large hydro) crossed 100 billion units (BU) for the first time, reaching 101 BU in Q2 FY27. The combined non-fossil fuel power generation reached a record 177 BU, up from 163 BU in Q2 FY26.

Solar accounted for 10 per cent of the total electricity generation in Q2 FY27 for the first time and reached a new daily record of 705 million units (MU) on September 30, Finland-based the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air (CREA) said in a commentary.

Non-fossil sources, including renewables, hydropower, and nuclear, accounted for around 33 per cent of the total generation in Q2 FY27, it added.

Overall, India's electricity generation increased 11 per cent Y-o-Y 536 BU during the July-September period in FY27, while peak electricity demand reached a record 270 gigawatts (GW), 18 per cent higher than the peak recorded in Q2 FY26.

Manoj Kumar, India Analyst at CREA, pointed out that even with the national peak demand reaching a record 270 GW, India's coal power plants only reached 68 per cent of their utilisation rate in Q2 FY27.

"As solar increasingly meets daytime electricity demand and storage helps meet evening and nighttime peaks, new thermal capacity should be assessed against expected demand, renewable generation, and storage availability. This will help avoid building capacity that could remain underutilised as India's power system evolves," he told *businessline*.

SOLAR POWER

Solar remained the fastest-growing major power source, with generation increasing 39 per cent Y-o-Y to 51 BU, while wind generation rose 29 per cent Y-o-Y to 45 BU.

Large hydropower generation rose from 39 BU in Q1 FY227 to 60 BU in Q2 FY27, a 53 per cent Q-o-Q increase, but fell 20 per cent on an annual basis.

CREA pointed out that even as national peak demand reached a record 270 GW in Q2 FY27, coal power plant utilisation remained at just 68 per cent, down from 73 per cent in Q1 indicating that coal fleet had substantial unused capacity even during periods of record electricity demand.

Coal consumption remained broadly stable at around 79 mt per month from May through September, but coal dispatch to power plants declined from 74 MT in May to 66 MT in August, the lowest level in 2026, it added.

India-UK JETCO meet focuses on FTA gains as British firms announce £1 b new deals

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Union Minister Piyush Goyal and UK Secretary of State for Business & Trade Jonathan Reynolds co-chaired the Joint Economic and Trade Committee meeting (JETCO) on Monday, the first after the implementation of the India-UK Free Trade Agreement, amid announcement of over £1 billion in new commercial deals by the UK.

"Communities across the UK and India are set to benefit from over £1 billion in new deals. The announcement comes as a major UK delegation arrives in India with a mission to maximise business benefit from the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA), the landmark UK-India FTA," per a statement issued by the British High Commission in India on Monday. Focus sectors include aviation services, artificial intelligence, healthcare, advanced communications and engineering.

With the new package, deals worth nearly £12 billion have now been announced since the signing of the FTA in July 2025, supporting thousands of jobs across both countries, it added.



TRADE PUSH. Union Minister Piyush Goyal and UK Secretary of State for Business, Innovation, Science and Trade Jonathan Reynolds at the 16th meeting of the India-UK Joint Economic and Trade Committee (JETCO), in New Delhi PTI

Goyal said that European carmakers would prefer to manufacture in India, as producing vehicles there would be uncompetitive due to the region's regulations. "Finally, India is going to become the global hub for car manufacturing. Everybody is going to come and manufacture in India and with Europe having such crazy regulations, it is going to be impossible to be competitive. All the European manufacturers will come to India," he said at The Dilli Dialogue. In its free trade agreements, India has provided quota-based tariff concessions for automobiles to the UK and the EU.

BIZ DELEGATION

The UK delegation, comprising more than 100 businesses and seven mayors from northern England, is led by Reynolds, along with the Secretaries of State for Scotland and Environment, Food and Rural Affairs. The mission will visit Delhi and Mumbai to forge new partnerships and expand market access for British businesses.

The agreement entered into force three months ago and is expected to boost bilateral trade by £25.5 billion annually by 2040.

Deals announced on Monday include a £50 million investment from Meta for Data Technologies (MFD) to fund AI research in the UK, and leading UK aviation services company, Menzies Aviation, seeking to generate over £600 million in revenue with an expanded footprint in India.

The mission also includes British food and drink businesses, with UK ministers seeking to translate the FTA's commitments into export gains for farmers and producers.

Scottish businesses, in particular, see opportunities in products such as salmon and whisky.

"Our trade deal with India opened the door, and now regional businesses are walking through it with our northern Mayors leading the way in building partnerships to drive jobs, investment and growth," Reynolds said.

Coal supply to power sector averaged at 2.49 million tonnes per day in October

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Coal Ministry said on Monday that coal supply to the power sector averaged at 2.49 million tonnes (mt) per day in October against 2.21 mt per day in September.

The actual coal supply in October (till October 10) is higher than the supply plan of 2.37 mt per day for the month, and supply exceeded the plan on nine out of the 10 days.

Higher rake loading has driven this improvement. Rakes loaded to the power sector averaged 469 rakes per day in October 2026 (October 1–10), against 426 rakes per day in September, an increase of about 10 per cent. Daily rake loading in the current month ranged between 447 and 482 rakes.

The coal stocks at domestic coal-based power plants have remained stable above 18 mt since September 29, 2026. Stock was 18.932 mt on September 29 and is at 18.205 mt on October 10, the Ministry said.

The stabilisation reflects coal supplies keeping pace with daily consumption at power plants and the supply to the plants with critical stocks is being closely monitored, with requirement-based redistribution of coal to vulnerable stations to ensure adequate supplies and uninterrupted power generation, it added.

The pace of depletion has eased considerably in October compared to September.

For instance, in September 2026, stock declined by about 7.28 mt over the month, an average of about 0.24 mt per day. In the first 10 days of October, stock declined by only about 0.56 mt in total, an average of about 0.06 mt per day.

The Ministry continues to work in close coordination with Coal India (CIL), SCCL, the Ministry of Railways and power utilities to ensure sustained coal evacuation and supply, thereby maintaining adequate coal stocks at thermal power plants.

The Ministry duly acknowledges and appreciates the continued support and professional commitment of Indian Railways in facilitating the efficient movement of coal.



CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - OCTOBER 13 - 2026

QUICKLY.

LTTS inaugurates AI-Native EI Lab

Bengaluru: L&T Technology Services (LTTS) has inaugurated its AI-Native EI Lab for Digital Manufacturing in Bengaluru, an experiential environment where customers and partners can see AI-Native Manufacturing, digital twins and autonomous systems working together across the lifecycles. The EI Lab extends LTTS' Engineering Intelligence charter to the manufacturing shop floor. The EI Lab is built around multiple capability pillars: Manufacturing Intelligence, AI-Native Factory, Operations AI and Autonomy, LTTS' Unified Intelligence platform EIOne. OUR BUREAU

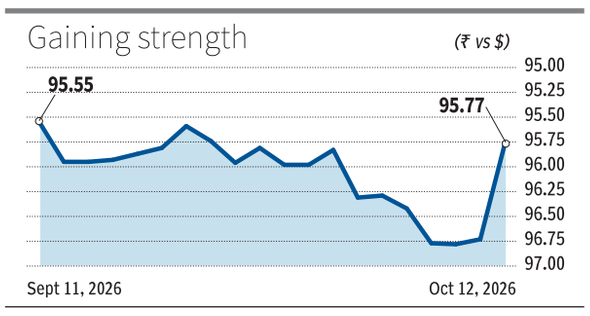
Karnataka Bank launches forex services platform

Mangaluru: Karnataka Bank has launched 'Trade Konnect', a digital platform that enables customers to submit requests for import, export transactions and outward cross border remittances online, anytime, anywhere eliminating the need for physical branch visits. OUR BUREAU

Rupee perks up 96 paise on RBI's weekend measures to curb speculation

OPENING HIGH. The last time the currency unit had a better opening than Monday's was on February 3

Our Bureau
Mumbai



The RBI's weekend measures to curb speculation and contain volatility in the forex market had the desired effect, with the rupee appreciating about 1 per cent, even as yields of government securities (G-Secs) jumped on expectations that the RBI may quicken rate hikes on inflation worries.

The Indian currency (INR) opened 97 paise stronger at 95.76 per US dollar (USD) against the previous close of 96.73. However, it closed almost flat at 95.77, erasing two weeks of losses.

The last time the INR had a better opening than Monday's was on February 3, when it opened 111 paise stronger at 90.40 per USD against previous close of 91.51.

TARGETED MEASURES

The Central bank, on October 10, announced a series of restrictions on forex derivatives contracts and opened a special window to meet the daily dollar requirement of three public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) — Indian Oil Corporation, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation and Bharat Petroleum Corporation — in view of the evolving market conditions and the need to ensure orderly functioning of the forex market.

The RBI announced restrictions on rebooking of cancelled foreign exchange derivative contracts; reduced the threshold for undertaking foreign exchange derivative transactions without establishing underlying exposure from $100 million to $5 million; introduced foreign exchange risk reserve (FERR) for banks; and prescribed additional documentation for verification of underlying exposures.

V Rama Chandra Reddy, Head - Treasury, Karur Vysya Bank, said such measures are intended to be temporary to curb currency volatility, ease market panic and quell one-sided expectations. They will ensure that the currency would not breach the 97-per-dollar level in the near term.

The central bank, on October 10, opened a special window to meet the daily dollar requirement of three public sector oil marketing companies

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda, noted that if the current USD/INR level remains steady, then it can be surmised that the speculative forces had a role to play in the rupee decline.

"A pullback in crude oil prices, driven by expectations of improving supply conditions, further aided sentiment. However, gains were limited after the higher open as weaker domestic equities and continued foreign fund outflows weighed on the currency," Dilip Parmar, Senior Research Analyst, HDFC Securities, said.

In the near term, spot USD/INR may drift towards the 95.30 levels, though the broader medium-to-long-term trend will hinge on dollar flows, the trade balance, interest rate differentials and evolving geopolitical developments, per his assessment.

Meanwhile, G-Secs yields jumped on fears that the RBI may further up interest rates, including via an off-cycle meeting, and conduct open market operation sales of G-Secs.

Yield of the 10-year benchmark jumped about 8 basis points to close at 7.3850 per cent against the previous close of 7.30 per cent.

The last time the 10-year G-Sec was around these levels was in October 2023.

Banks seek operational guidelines on maintaining forex risk reserve with RBI

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Banks have sought operational guidelines on maintaining the newly introduced foreign exchange risk reserve (FERR) with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

The FERR has been introduced as part of the RBI's measures to curb speculation and contain volatility in the forex market.

In respect of all foreign exchange derivative contracts involving Indian rupee (INR) that are for notional value exceeding $2 million equivalent, authorised dealers will be required to maintain with the RBI an FERR in cash, equal to 20 per cent of the INR equivalent of the notional amount of each transaction, per the central bank.

NEW CHALLENGES

Banks are seeking clarity on aspects such as how these costs should be passed on to importer and exporter clients; the methodology for calculating the cost; the operational procedures for setting aside and remitting the required reserves to the RBI; and whether the cost of the reserve requirement should be uniform across banks or determined independently by each bank.

For example, for every $3 million derivative contract (approximately ₹28.73 crore), a bank would need to park about ₹5.75 crore with the RBI. Banks would not earn any interest on these funds, creating an additional cost that they may seek to recover from clients.

CONCERN

However, the absence of clear guidelines on cost calculation and recovery remains a key concern.

"The FERR requirement is a first-of-its-kind measure. While banks are familiar with managing the cash reserve ratio (CRR), the FERR requirement introduces a different set of operational challenges," said a forex dealer with a public sector bank.Meanwhile, the RBI has sought feedback from four leading banks on the impact of the measures announced on Saturday.

High-altitude medicine centre in Himachal Pradesh

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The centre will focus on the health implications of low-oxygen levels, extreme cold and changing climatic conditions

The Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) is setting up a dedicated centre for high-altitude medicine in Keylong, Himachal Pradesh, to study the health effects of extreme climatic conditions on soldiers deployed in high-altitude areas and civilian populations living across the Himalayan region.

The centre will focus on the health implications of low-oxygen levels, extreme cold and changing climatic conditions, with research spanning maternal and newborn health, child nutrition, acclimatisation and disease patterns among high-altitude populations.

The Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare JP Nadda said the centre is worth ₹36 crore, with the cost expected to rise to ₹50 crore once all research equipment are installed.

The initiative brings together ICMR, the Armed Forces Medical Services and AIIMS Bilaspur, with the aim of strengthening research and generating evidence to address the specific healthcare challenges faced by people living and working in high-altitude environments.

USE OF DRONES

The proposed research will explore the use of drones for medicine delivery, digital health tools and artificial intelligence to improve access to healthcare in remote and difficult-to-reach areas.

Uncertainty clouds MDR rollout; NPCI official says unaware of deferment

Ashokamithran T
Mumbai

Days ahead of the roll-out of the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR), a senior NPCI official said they were unaware of any possible deferment and whether the Supreme Court's direction seeking a short affidavit would have any bearing on the implementation timeline.

The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), a not-for-profit entity registered under the Companies Act, decided on September 14 to levy an MDR on Unified Payments Interface (UPI) transactions exceeding ₹2,000. The following day, the Finance Ministry outlined the applicable rates and stated that they would come into effect from October 15.

On September 16, a public interest litigation (PIL) was filed in the Supreme Court by advocate Anjan Datta, questioning the manner in which the charge was imposed. "The grievance is that a compulsory rate regime affecting a digital public infrastructure has been created through an opaque and inadequately disclosed process, with unexplained cliff-edge classifications and no credible protection against indirect burden or digital exclusion," the petition stated.

Further, Datta questioned the constitutionality of amending Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, to end the zero-MDR regime for high-value UPI transactions. The petitioners also argued that extending the no-MDR benefit to RuPay card payments, while excluding high-value UPI transactions, violated Article 14 of the Constitution, which guarantees the fundamental right to equality before the law.

The Supreme Court heard the matter on September 28 and asked whether MDR was a tax or a fee. Additional Solicitor General N. Venkataraman, appearing for the Government of India, stated that it was neither. The Court then sought clarification on the nature of the charge and what constituted the alleged "expropriation," directing the respondents to file an affidavit within four weeks. The Supreme Court is scheduled to hear the matter again on November 2. However, the Court did not stay the implementation of MDR, as requested by the petitioners.



DECISION VALIDITY. A public interest litigation filed in the Supreme Court questioned the constitutionality of amending Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, to end the zero-MDR regime for high-value UPI transactions

NPCI was reportedly considering deferring the MDR roll-out and had convened meetings of its steering committee to deliberate on the issue in the first week of October. When asked whether reports of discussions around a postponement were accurate, what the revised implementation date could be, and whether any deferment was linked to the requirement of filing an affidavit before the Supreme Court, the senior official said they had no information on the matter.

When further asked whether this implied MDR would be implemented as scheduled on October 15, the official declined to comment. E-mails sent to NPCI seeking clarification remained unanswered at the time of publication.

BROADER QUESTIONS

Experts say the case raises broader questions about accountability in regulated digital infrastructure, as well as the distinction between NPCI's role as a facilitator of the payments ecosystem and that of an authority with independent powers to impose charges.

"It is not that the Supreme Court has not given a discretion. The Supreme Court is not accepting that legally it is valid. If they are not able to file the affidavit on time or even if the Supreme Court is not satisfied with the reply, the government will have to stop it. So in my opinion, they will defer the implementation. You cant implement it and not file the affidavit," said Suman Kumar Jha, Founding and Managing Partner, Corp Legex

"The decisive question is whether the amended provision, read with the wider statutory and regulatory framework, sufficiently supports the charging mechanism being introduced. The Court will need to distinguish between permitting charges within a payment system and conferring the power to impose or determine those charges," said Sonam Chandwani, Managing Partner at KS Legal.

"The government must demonstrate not only the policy rationale for introducing MDR but also the legal authority under which the arrangement operates," she said, adding that it would be premature at this stage to reach a definitive conclusion on the constitutional validity of the measure.

RBL Bank PAT doubles to ₹481.7 crore on FCNR(B) boost in Q2FY27

Our Bureau
Mumbai

RBL Bank's standalone net profit increased 2.7 times to ₹481.7 crore in the quarter ended September 30, 2026, against ₹178.52 crore in the year-ago period.

The PAT increased 1.9 times sequentially from ₹253.7 crore in the prevoius quarter.

The bank beat Bloomberg estimates of ₹479 crore by a small margin.

The lender's net interest income increased 37.4 per cent to ₹2,131 crore in the reporting quarter, compared with ₹1550.7 crore last year. Net interest margin increased to 4.61 per cent (4.51 per cent).

The bank's gross advances grew 42 per cent to ₹1.42 lakh crore and gross deposits grew 34 per cent to ₹1.57 lakh crore. The credit to deposit ratio is expected to be 90 per cent in the current quarter.

The bank received $3.4 billion in FCNR(B) deposits, which grew at 6 per cent on a year-on-year basis. CASA grew 14 per cent year-on-year to ₹42,526 crore.

LOAN GROWTH

The large headline loan growth, however, was on account of a ₹10,300-crore leverage provided to FCNR (B) depositors.

Scorecard

	Q2 FY26	Q2 FY27	y-o-y (%)
NII (₹ cr)	1,550.68	2,130.90	37.42
PAT (₹ cr)	178.52	481.77	169.87
NIM (%)	4.51	4.61	
GNPA (%)	2.32	1.02	
NNPA (%)	0.57	0.29	

Source: BSE

Not including the leverage to FCNR(B) deposits, the loan growth came in at about 31 per cent on a year-on-year basis.

In the secured retail category, the overall lending grew 52 per cent to ₹52,000 crore.

However, loan growth slowed by 2-3 percentage points year-on-year on all segments except gold loan, which quickened 2 percentage points to 8 per cent.

The bank lent ₹10,300 crore against FCNR(B) deposits, taking other deposits to 28 per cent of secured retail loans.

The growth in loan book and FCNR(B) leverage led to the bank setting a provision of ₹766.5 crore, 53 per cent more than the provisions in the same quarter last fiscal.

The increase in provisioning cost that comes from FCNR(B) is one time, a senior official of the bank said.

ASSET QUALITY

In terms of asset quality, Gross Non-Profitable to Assets (GNPA), as a share of gross advances, dipped to 1.02 per cent (2.32 per cent).

The NNPA share in net advances also improved to 0.29 per cent (0.57 per cent).

"Our normal business trends are improving quarter-on-quarter as unsecured structure normalises. At the same time, we are working on putting together building blocks, which we will articulate in greater detail over the coming months. But briefly, we would focus on deepening and starting new relationships with large corporates, which were not accessible earlier either due to a constraint of the credit rating and capital positions or our cost of funds," said R Subramaniakumar, MD and CEO, RBL Bank.

Viyona Fintech expands operations to Zimbabwe

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Viyona Fintech, an NPCI-certified technology service provider, is planning to to roll out its Viyona Tap and Pay platform to extend its payment technologies to African markets, positioning Zimbabwe as its initial entry point for sub-Saharan deployment.

"Zimbabwe's high digital payment adoption, surpassing ZiG200 billion in monthly electronic transactions, makes it an ideal testing ground for Tap & Pay technology before broader regional scaling," Ravindranath Yarlagadda, Founder and Chief Executive Officer, Viyona Fintech, said in a release on Monday. The company is currently in talks with the Government of Zimbabwe to facilitate this expansion," he added.

The move aligns with the upcoming rollout of Viyona Tap & Pay, an NFC-based SoftPOS solution designed to turn commercial Android smartphones into contactless payment terminals, eliminating hardware costs for small businesses, the release said.

Freshworks to acquire SaaS management platform Torii

Our Bureau
Chennai

SaaS major Freshworks is set to expand its IT service management (ITSM) capabilities with a definitive agreement to acquire Torii, a SaaS management platform.

Torii gives businesses visibility into applications, AI projects, spend, licences and users.

It tracks AI consumption to the token, attributes it to the people and teams driving it, so that IT teams can charge it back, set limits and catch spikes.

Freshworks said in a media release that the combination of Torii alongside its ITSM offering Freshservice can bring the full picture of a company's technology inventory, usage and spend into one place.

"Modern IT teams are being asked to govern more of the business than ever, with less visibility into what it costs. Freshservice already gives IT one place to see everything they run. With Torii, that same view now extends to software and AI spend", said Dennis Woodside, CEO and President of Freshworks.

"We built Torii because IT, finance, and security were each working off a different partial picture of the same problem. Freshservice already gives IT one system of record for everything it runs. Extending that to software and AI means one less blind spot, not one more dashboard," said Uri Haramati, CEO of Torii.

'Every time you sense frustration, that's an opportunity'

Our Bureau
Chennai

Successful entrepreneurship is less about having a breakthrough innovative idea at the very beginning and more about identifying a real problem and staying with it long enough, Mithun Sacheti, Founder, CaratLane, and Partner, Q Partners Axana Estates, told a gathering of management students, here on Monday.

"Every time you sense frustration, that's an opportunity," he said, explaining that his own frustration with the inventory-driven nature of the traditional family jewellery business helped him identify an opportunity to start and grow an online jewellery business like Caratlane.

Sacheti was speaking at the Madras Management Association's (MMA) 25th MMA All-India Management Students' Convention 2026.

Drawing on his experience of building an online jewellery business at a time when the market was not ready for it, he said entrepreneurship requires conviction, patience and a willingness to adapt. "If you feel there is a genuine problem to solve, you don't need anyone's permission or approval," he said.

ROLE OF AI

Interestingly, Sacheti noted that AI has the potential to level the playing field for Chennai entrepreneurs. "AI is the biggest game changer that has happened...Now sitting in a noise-free place like Chennai, you have all the information that anybody else has anywhere else. You can use that and build anything and everything out of Chennai," he said.



EXPERT EXCHANGE. (from left) AR Unnikrishnan, President, MMA, and MD, Saint-Gobain India Private Ltd – Glass Business; and Mithun Sacheti, Founder, CaratLane, and Partner, Q Partners Axana Estates

"If you are a builder, if you want to be an entrepreneur, it is the biggest friend you're going to have in this journey," he told the students about AI.

The event also saw sessions centered around transforming organisations in an AI world, reinventing employability skills. The event concluded with the Grand Finale of Chanakya-The Mastermind, which recognises the Best Management Student of the Year 2026.

SUCCESS STORIES

Another session during the day brought on stage Srinath Ravichandran, Co-Founder and CEO, Agnikul Cosmos; Anand Bharadwaj, Co-Founder, Sweet Karam Coffee (SKC); and Dinesh Arjun, Co-Founder and CEO, Raptee.HV, to portray success stories of first-generation entrepreneurs.

"The societal expectation for being a founder is much higher today compared to 2006. Everyone should capitalize on this societal acceptance," Ravichandran said.

"We wanted to build a brand that would be th Brand of South in global arena; it was a category dominated by legendary brands both in the South and nationally," SKC's Bharadwaj said.

A R Unnikrishnan President, MMA & MD, Saint-Gobain India Private Ltd – Glass Business, CA M P Vijay Kumar Convention Chairman & ED & Group CFO, Sify Technologies Ltd, and Sai Sudha Chandrasekaran Alpha Alternatives & Former CEO, India Fintech Foundation, were among others part of the inaugural session at the event.

Shyam Srinivasan, Senior Advisor and Operating Partner at TVS Capital Funds and former Managing Director of Federal Bank, delivered the valedictory address.

The Hindu Group was a media partner of the event.

QUICKLY.

Stellantis,Tata Motors expand Pune partnership



Chennai: Stellantis India, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd (TMPV) and its subsidiary Tata Passenger Electric Mobility Ltd (TPEM) on Monday signed a definitive agreement that expands the scope of their long-standing partnership further into advanced technology and product collaboration. This partnership builds on the memorandum of understanding signed in February 2026 and marks an important expansion of the companies' long-standing strategic partnership. TMPV will provide Stellantis access to its advanced product technology and vehicle architecture, which Stellantis will build upon through its product development and engineering capabilities in India to address the requirements of more than 50 global markets. OUR BUREAU

Hospitals told to display list of fees charged for services

CLEAR GUIDELINES. Move will help patients plan their expenses, minimise billing disputes

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi


Union Health Secretary Punya Salila Srivastava

The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare has urged all States and Union Territories to ensure that clinical establishments prominently display the rates charged for their services and facilities, so that patients can make informed decisions about their treatment.

In a letter to the Chief Secretaries of all States and UTs, Union Health Secretary Punya Salila Srivastava called for a review of compliance to ensure that information on healthcare charges is clearly visible and easily accessible to patients and their attendants.

RULES LAID

The Health Secretary noted that conspicuous display of rates will help patients and their families understand the likely cost of treatment and plan their medical expenditure. It will also minimise avoidable confusion and billing-related disputes, while fostering trust in the healthcare delivery system.

The letter refers to the Clinical Establishments (Registration and Regulation) Act, 2010, and the Clinical Establishments (Central Government) Rules, 2012. Under the rules, clinical establishments in States and UTs where the Act is applicable must display the rates for each type of service and the facilities available at a conspicuous place, in the local language as well as in English.

In States and UTs where the Act is not applicable, clinical establishments are regulated under respective State or UT frameworks, several of which also contain provisions on displaying rates. Recognising that health is a State subject, and that implementation and enforcement rest with the States and UTs, the Health Secretary asked the Chief Secretaries to ensure effective compliance through the authorities concerned.

OVERSEAS PATIENTS

The letter also places particular emphasis on international patients. States and UTs have been requested to encourage, wherever applicable, the prominent display of package rates for foreign patients travelling to India on medical or Ayush Visas. This will strengthen India's position as a trusted destination for medical and Ayush care.

The Health Secretary sought the personal attention of the Chief Secretaries and asked them to issue appropriate advisories to the concerned authorities and clinical establishments, including ensuring that rates are displayed at conspicuous, clearly visible and easily accessible locations, in line with applicable regulations.

RDI Fund selects 19 fund managers for ₹7,131 cr investment commitment

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

The Research, Development and Innovation Fund (RDIF), a flagship initiative of the Government of India, has announced the selection of the first cohort of 19 second level fund managers (SLFMs).

"The Empowered Group of Secretaries in its meeting held on October 08, 2026 has approved 14 alternative investment funds and 5 focused research organisations, with a total RDIF commitment of ₹7,131 crore," the government said in a statement. The names of the SLFMs were not disclosed. The ₹1 lakh crore Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Scheme was launched in November 2025.

The 19 institutions approved under the first cohort will play a pivotal role in channelling RDIF capital to Eligible Technology Enterprises undertaking research, development and innovation activities at Technology Readiness Level 4 and above.

Hero Moto, Philips clock surge in sales as EMIs spur big-ticket buying

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Amazon and Flipkart have set the tone for a firecracker start to India's festival online shopping season, with no-cost EMIs and discounts fuelling big-ticket purchases. A large number of Amazon sellers have crossed ₹1 crore in opening-day sales that jumped over 80 per cent year-on-year. Hero MotoCorp's two-wheeler sales surged 30-fold, Samsonite's premium luggage business grew 200 per cent, and Philips domestic appliances recorded tenfold demand, while Flipkart drew more than six times its usual number of shoppers during the opening hour of its Big Billion Days sale.

More than one-third of Amazon customers opted for EMIs, while Amazon Pay Later EMI transactions doubled. At Flipkart, one in three mobile customers chose no-cost EMIs and one in four used exchanges, indicating how financing and trade-ins helped make upgrades affordable. "We've seen a record 100 per cent increase in products ordered and are humbled to see aspirations becoming affordable with extra savings for Prime members, instant bank discounts, exchange, no-cost EMI, Amazon Pay Later and a host of value-driving programs," said Saurabh Srivastava, Vice President, Amazon India.

Two-wheelers emerged among the more striking categories. Hero MotoCorp's Ashutosh Varma, Chief Business Officer, India Business Unit, said sales reached 30 times regular-day levels in the first 48 hours, led by the Destini 125 scooter and Xtreme 125R motorcycle.

Premiumisation was visible beyond vehicles. Samsonite India CEO Jai Krishnan said the luggage maker's premium portfolio was attracting stronger demand, with Samsonite growing 200 per cent year-on-year in the first 24 hours, against 60 per cent for American Tourister.

The buying extended to kitchen appliances and home improvement.

HOME UPGRADES

Gulbahar Taurani, MD and CEO of Versuni India, which markets Philips domestic appliances, reported tenfold regular-day demand, led by cooking appliances and mixers. Solara founder Gopal Kolli reported 35-fold sales, driven by air fryers and cold-press juicers.

Eureka Forbes Chief Growth Officer Anurag Kumar reported the company's biggest-ever festival opening day, with premium water purifiers and robotic vacuum cleaners performing strongly.

Demand was not confined to durable goods. Reebok India Brand Head Arjun Ramamoorthy reported that sales more than doubled year-on-year, while WROGN Co-Founder Anjana Reddy said the fashion brand recorded tenfold regular-day sales.

RENÉE Cosmetics E-commerce Head Jitendra Rawal reported opening-day sales doubling year-on-year, while Penguin Random House India CEO Gaurav Shrinagesh reported nearly 50 per cent growth over two days. Speaking to *businessline*, Aman Deep Lohan, Director, Home, Kitchen and Outdoors, Amazon India, said its automotive business was growing approximately 70 per cent year-on-year.

Lohan said no-cost EMIs spanning three to 12 months were encouraging customers to choose higher-specification products.

Agilisium eyes topline of $0.5 billion in 5-7 years

Rohan Das
Chennai

Agilisium, a life science-focused technology services firm has set itself a target of $0.5 billion in revenues by the next five to seven years.

The ambitious topline target comes at a time when the company, which has a large presence in Chennai, has been growing at a rate of 45 per cent y-o-y and is poised to reach its earlier goal of a $100 million revenue by 2027. Speaking at a media roundtable here on Monday, Raj Babu, Founder and CEO, Agilisium said that the firm is banking heavily on the innovations and rapid growth within the Indian life science and pharma industry.

"Some of the innovation projects and transformation that Indian life science players are doing are at par if not better than what our US clients are doing," he said.

Babu suggested that the company plans to expand India's share in the overall revenue mix to 20 per cent by 2030. Currently, over 95 per cent of its business comes from the US market with the rest being predominantly from India and some other global markets.

NEW HUB

Though Chennai is the company's largest hub with a team of 700-800, Agilisium expects its long-term growth to be anchored from Hyderabad which Babu believes is going to be the life sciences hub in the Eastern Hemisphere — akin to Boston in the west.

"I think over the next few years we will grow our strength to somewhere between 2-5 thousand in Hyderabad," he said.

DOMAIN EXPERTISE

Interestingly, only around 30 per cent of the new talent Agilisium is hiring are from a computer science background with the company instead prioritising domain expertise. "It is much easier to hire domain people who understand STEM, and train them in technology as opposed to hiring a computer science person and asking them to understand cell biology," he said.

He added that the firm has recently bought in doctors, dentists, pharmacologists, biologists and PhDs to build this domain depth.

Agilisium plans to train and develop a significant Forward Deployed Expert (FDE) talent pool having already invested around ₹50 crore to reskill and deploy Agilisium's global workforce as embedded AI transformation partners.

"We are looking at around 100 full time FDEs to be part of our teams by the end of this year and are expecting to scale this further in the coming years," he said.

Though life sciences accounts for the overwhelming majority of Agilisium's business, Babu suggested that the company is also looking to develop a considerable presence in the fast growing medtech space.

CIEL HR Services posts 27% y-o-y growth in H1, beats industry average

Our Bureau
Chennai



CIEL HR Services posted revenues of ₹1,178 crore for the half year ended September 2026 (H1FY27), a growth of 27 per cent when compared to the same period last year. Profit after tax increased 19.3 per cent year-on-year at ₹13.7 crore.

Speaking at a virtual press conference on Tuesday, Executive Director & Chairman, K Pandiarajan said that the Chennai-based company's growth has beaten the HR industry average of 8 per cent year-on-year recorded by its peers.

"For the first time, we have also seen a big turnaround in free cashflow; from negative ₹12.6 crore in the same period last year our free cash flow has grown to ₹2.3 crore," he said. Pandiarajan added that the positive free cash flow will help in better valuations as the company gears up for its previously postponed IPO in FY28.

'CONTINUED FOCUS'

During the half year, the company also structurally integrated its two prior acquisitions — People metrics and Courseplay.

"Bringing People Metrics and Courseplay together gives our clients one connected path... We expect this, along with our continued focus on productivity, to strengthen our bottom line further," he added.

Aditya Mishra, Managing Director and Group CEO said that the company's business has been aided by strong momentum in sectors such as healthcare and quick commerce. He added that the company is deploying AI across internal functions, as well as its products while it is also being integrated into its assessment and learning offerings.

As for the full financial year FY27, the company expects revenues to be around ₹2,600 crore, a 31 per cent growth compared to FY26.

Nazara Tech Director reshuffle

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Nazara Technologies on Monday announced a rejig in its Director and management mix with Founder Nitin Mittersain stepping down from his role as Managing Director. Mittersain will act as the Non-Executive Director effective October 12. As Founder and Non-Executive Director, Mittersain will continue to provide strategic guidance and leverage his experience to support the company. However, the company has not disclosed who will be taking over as Managing Director. Earlier, Raymond Albaladejo Stauffer took over as the Chief Executive Officer of Nazara.

The Board also redesignated Mithun Sacheti as the Whole-time Director and Key Managerial Personnel and designated as Executive Director of the company. Sacheti will take over once the current Whole-time Director Rohit Sharma steps down on January 2027. Further, Chief Financial Officer Rakesh Shah will step down on October 15, 2026. The role will be taken over by Arun Agrawal, a Chartered Accountant.

McCain Foods to buy Falcon Agrifriz's potato processing business in Gujarat

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi


NEED FOR MORE. The acquisition comes post McCain's recent completion of a C$135 million (nearly ₹906 crore) expansion of its existing operations in Gujarat VIJAY SONEJI

McCain Foods on Monday said it has entered into an agreement to acquire Falcon Agrifriz Foods' frozen potato processing business in Gujarat.

This acquisition will complement McCain's existing operations in Mehsana, Gujarat, strengthening its manufacturing footprint and creating a strong platform to support future growth.

The acquisition comes post McCain's recent investment in India, including the completion of a C$ 135 million (nearly ₹906 crore) expansion of its existing operations in Gujarat.

PRIORITY MARKET

While the company did not reveal the commercials of the transaction, it said the acquisition is part of a long-term growth strategy in India. "India continues to be a priority growth market for McCain Foods. This acquisition reflects our confidence in the Indian market and builds on nearly three decades of continued investment in our people, local operations and agricultural partnerships," said Pierre Danet, Regional President, Asia Pacific and South Africa at McCain, adding, "By strengthening our network, we will be better positioned to grow alongside our customers, growers and communities for the long term."

Falcon Agrifriz, which produces a range of frozen potato products for domestic and international markets, has over 450 employees along with relationships with over 1,000 farmers across Gujarat. Following closing of the transaction, the company said it will look forward to building on these relationships as part of its broader farming partner network in India.

"We are proud of the modern, fully automated processing facility we have built at Falcon Agrifriz in less than two years...," said Parthajeet Patnaik, Vice-Chairman, Falcon Agrifriz.

Aditya Krishna, MD, McCain Foods India, added, "We look forward to welcoming Falcon employees and growers to the McCain network and continuing to create local employment opportunities."



the hindu businessline.
TUESDAY - OCTOBER 13, 2026

Signs of nerves

RBI should avoid knee-jerk response to Re movement

The Reserve Bank of India's weekend moves — to contain demand for dollars and curb speculative dollar-rupee positions — betray a strange sense of nervousness over the rupee's trajectory. Oddly enough, they have come just days after the MPC meeting that decided to raise policy rates by 25 basis points. For a central bank which has always maintained that it is not targeting any level of the rupee but is only concerned about keeping volatility in check, RBI's actions suggest the contrary.

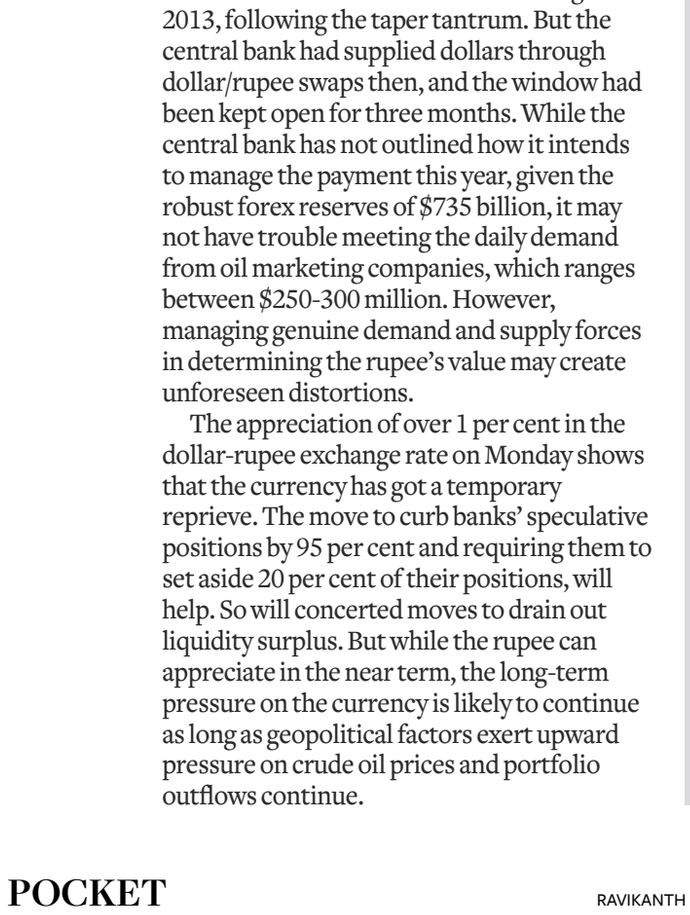
Such muddled messaging could send wrong signals — of vulnerability, despite macros being sound. It is to be hoped that speculators are not emboldened. The trigger seems to have been the pressure on the rupee last week, owing to Brent crude oil prices moving above $100 a barrel and the US treasury bond yields spiking above 5.2 per cent. The RBI has announced two sets of measures to curb rupee depreciation. The first set, meant to curb currency speculation, is aimed at preventing transmission of prices from the offshore non-deliverable forward market to domestic markets. These include disallowing re-booking of cancelled rupee derivative contracts and reducing the limit for taking hedging positions in rupee derivative contracts in the domestic market without showing an underlying exposure — to $5 million from the existing $100 million. It may be recalled that the RBI had capped this limit at $100 million in March this year, when the rupee was under pressure due to the onset of the US-Iran war. By slashing the limit to $5 million, the central bank is clamping down strongly on the trading positions of banks. For contracts exceeding $2 million, the RBI has asked banks to maintain 20 per cent of the notional value in a foreign exchange risk reserve.

The other significant measure is a special window for sale of dollars directly to oil marketing companies to meet their daily requirements. This move appears aimed at cooling the spot dollar-rupee market. The RBI had announced a similar window in August 2013, following the taper tantrum. But the central bank had supplied dollars through dollar/rupee swaps then, and the window had been kept open for three months. While the central bank has not outlined how it intends to manage the payment this year, given the robust forex reserves of $735 billion, it may not have trouble meeting the daily demand from oil marketing companies, which ranges between $250-300 million. However, managing genuine demand and supply forces in determining the rupee's value may create unforeseen distortions.

The appreciation of over 1 per cent in the dollar-rupee exchange rate on Monday shows that the currency has got a temporary reprieve. The move to curb banks' speculative positions by 95 per cent and requiring them to set aside 20 per cent of their positions, will help. So will concerted moves to drain out liquidity surplus. But while the rupee can appreciate in the near term, the long-term pressure on the currency is likely to continue as long as geopolitical factors exert upward pressure on crude oil prices and portfolio outflows continue.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH





VIPIN SONDHI
THULASI RAMAN KH



Cancer — an opportunity for manufacturing

SAME PRESCRIPTION. The capabilities for manufacture of advanced radiation therapy equipment are similar to those for semiconductor fabrication, fusion energy and defence

GETTY IMAGES

Walk into the radiotherapy wing of a cancer hospital in most Indian cities and the waiting area tells you something. Patients travel from districts where no machine exists. Where one does exist, a single linear accelerator serves a caseload that demands three and when it breaks down, as imported machines serviced on foreign timelines do, the list grows longer still. India recorded nearly 1.5 million new cancer cases in 2022; over half require radiation therapy at some point. Yet the country has roughly 0.6 machines per million people, against four to six in developed healthcare systems, with a shortfall conservatively at about 1,200. This is a healthcare crisis and seen differently, one of the most consequential manufacturing gaps in the country.

India trains radiation oncologists of international standing and its medical physicists are sought after globally. The clinical knowledge to deploy even the most advanced radiation technologies exists within the country. What does not exist, in any meaningful measure, is the industrial capability to build the machines those clinicians need.

This is not a matter of cost or foreign exchange alone; it is a question of strategic dependence. The next generation of radiation therapy — proton beam systems, carbon-ion therapy, MR-guided linear accelerators and AI-driven adaptive treatment — represents the convergence of accelerator physics, superconducting magnets, high-vacuum engineering, precision robotics and software. India imports virtually every critical subsystem: each new centre commissioned, each machine replaced, sends capital abroad and transfers no capability home.

India has been here before, in Defence. Decades of dependence on imported platforms — aircraft, submarines, artillery — created not merely a foreign exchange burden but a structural inability to absorb, adapt or advance the technology. The lesson took a long time to learn. In radiation therapy, there is still time to learn it earlier.

Proton therapy, which stops a beam of charged particles within a tumour rather than passing through surrounding healthy tissue, has treated close to 350,000 patients and is no longer experimental. India has two operational proton centres, with several more projected by 2028.

THE RIGHT QUESTION

The standard question asked about medical equipment in India is whether a machine is 'Made in India'. For advanced radiation therapy systems, that question is too blunt. A proton therapy installation contains an ion source, radio-frequency accelerating structures, precision electromagnets, high-vacuum chambers, a rotating gantry that must position tonnes of hardware to within a millimetre, scanning systems and treatment-planning software. No country manufactures all of this from scratch. The productive question is which layers India can progressively own.

The answer is more encouraging than current policy conversation suggests. RRCAT in Indore has built major operational accelerator facilities and demonstrated capabilities across superconducting RF, cryogenics, ultra-high vacuum and proton-accelerator subsystems, training generations of accelerator physicists. BARC and VECC bring decades of experience in radio-frequency systems, vacuum engineering and radiation instrumentation. The Bhabhatron programme showed that laboratory-grade accelerator capability can be translated into a clinical-grade cancer treatment machine. Indian software houses already contribute to treatment planning internationally.

The gap is not one of scientific knowledge. It is the fragmented connection between laboratories, hospitals, industry and regulatory pathways and the absence of a procurement philosophy that treats each machine purchase as an opportunity to close that gap.

Government cancer centres will require new and replacement equipment consistently over the coming decades

PROCUREMENT AS STRATEGY

Government cancer centres will require new and replacement equipment consistently over the coming decades; substantial, predictable demand of the kind that has driven manufacturing capability-building in other strategic sectors.

Global suppliers seeking to participate in India's growing radiation therapy market should be invited through structured arrangements that include technology co-development, subsystem localisation and vendor qualification for Indian manufacturers. This is not protectionism. The clinical benchmark must remain what IBA, Siemens, Hitachi and Toshiba can deliver and patient outcomes are non-negotiable. But procurement that also asks what capability each purchase creates in India is the kind of patient industrial policy that has worked in space, pharmaceuticals and more recently, semiconductor design.

The measure of success should not be the share of components sourced domestically by weight. The measure should be design ownership, intellectual property and manufacturing competence in the high-value subsystems: accelerator architecture, magnet technology, radio-frequency systems, beam diagnostics and treatment-planning software.

There is a larger reason this matters. The capabilities required to manufacture advanced radiation therapy equipment — superconducting magnets, high-vacuum accelerator chambers, precision motion systems, beam control electronics — are the same capabilities needed in semiconductor fabrication, fusion energy, scientific instruments and defence: an anchor application for an advanced engineering ecosystem whose value extends well beyond healthcare.

India has built nuclear reactors, launch vehicles and sophisticated digital infrastructure. Machines that direct particle beams to destroy tumours with sub-millimetre precision are a different order of challenge but not a categorically different one. The ingredients are present: accelerator laboratories, engineering universities, medical physicists, a growing precision manufacturing base, a world-class software industry and a cancer burden that will, regrettably, create one of the largest markets for these technologies on earth.

The question before policymakers is not whether India can afford to build this capability. It is whether India can afford to spend the next 20 years creating the world's largest market for radiation therapy equipment entirely for the benefit of those who manufacture it elsewhere.

The machines that treat cancer could, with the right intent, also build the industrial capability India needs.

Sondhi is former MD & CEO of Ashok Leyland and JCB India, and serves as an Independent Director. Raman is Principal Research Scientist, Society for Innovation and Development, Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru. Views are personal

Nobel Prize for macroeconomic stabilisation

The Laureates argue markets cannot be left to self-correct, and govt action is needed for economies to recover from crises

Madan Sabnavis

It is quite befitting that this year's Nobel Prize in Economics goes for work related to economic stabilisation. The world economy is typified by volatile markets and idiosyncratic political developments, including tariffs that are puzzling. We see different shades of unemployment and inflation across countries which call for concerted action by governments and central banks.

Robert Hall and Michael Woodford have been awarded the prize for their work that goes back to the micro foundations of economics, to explain macroeconomic stabilisation solutions. The former worked more on household decisions to spend based on income; and the latter on decision-making process of firms. Together, they had the right recipe for governments as they represent consumption and production. And given the rapid pace of globalisation where countries are interconnected, these lessons are universal.

Their work in a way means going back to Keynesianism of the 1930s, which focused on governments lowering taxes and interest rates to spur demand. For a while, these principles were given up when the oil crisis struck in the early 1970s. Countries inflated their economies to lower unemployment when the price shock was on the supply side leading to hyperinflation. Some even said, Keynesianism is dead. The route followed was to let the markets decide the course of the economy. However, as Hall and Woodford have argued, markets cannot be left to self-correct.

GOVT INTERVENTION

The Lehman crisis showed that we need government intervention to stabilise economic systems when they are dealt severe blows. For this Hall and Woodford went back to the micro foundations of the subject. Households look at future and not current income when taking decisions today. Right? This holds for us too when we guide our consumption according to future flow of income.

With AI looming, this will hold even for white-collar workers. Hall thus used the rational expectations theory tenets here to show that transitory benefits don't work and if there are tax cuts, they should be sharp and permanent to have an impact. The GST cut in India last year had this flavour.

Similarly, as Woodford pointed out, firms fix the price of products of, say, ice cream, for the season and cannot change the price every day when making plans. Hence the future is what matters when drawing up the macro picture. This in turn affects the financial system in terms of credit growth as well as asset quality.



THE WINNERS. Robert Hall and Michael Woodford

How does the government fit in here? It brings about stabilisation through both monetary and fiscal policies. During the Lehman crisis, central banks could not lower rates below zero. Hence the answer was quantitative easing which stabilised the world economy as central banks bought assets.

When Covid struck, governments generally veered towards lowering interest rates besides running large deficits to ensure that the economies did not collapse. There were cash transfers and deficits touched double digit numbers. Macroeconomic stabilisation was of utmost interest. It was not surprising that the world economy (barring China) was able to bounce back as policies had addressed the micro issues of employment, income and production. The current environment of war and tariffs is destabilising. This eventually affects employment and income and consumption of households. This in turn affects production decisions of other firms. Markets cannot correct on their own and require action from the government.

In India for example, the RBI is seen working to stabilise the rupee as it has to balance stability with providing an advantage for exporters. All central banks are raising interest rates to control inflation, even though it is on the supply side. This is a strong way to manage inflationary expectations. The forward guidance provided by some of them bears testimony to how expectations are guided, which affect decisions of households and firms.

It has been observed that over the years countries have realised that while growth is important, macroeconomic stability is non-negotiable. This is because growth can be directed through policy, but without stability will mean less. This is what the Nobel laureates would underline.

The writer is Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda and author of: Policies that shaped Modern India. Views are personal

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Cost-push inflation

This refers to 'Can rate hikes control cost-push inflation?' (October 12). Since 2000, the dot-com crash and 2008 global financial crisis had caused major economic upheavals. The current crisis has its origin to Russia-Ukraine war and US-Iran conflict. Greater political sagacity might have averted or contained these conflicts, which had disrupted supply chains and pushed up crude oil prices. The resulting inflationary pressures had prompted central banks to tighten monetary policy. Since several forces are at play, rate hikes could contain demand-driven and second-round inflationary pressures, but breaking the cost-push inflation cycle requires geopolitical de-escalation, restoration of energy supplies and resilient supply chains.

Srinivasan Velamur
Chennai

Starlink entry issue

This is with reference to 'Spaced out' (October 12). The editorial has rightly mentioned that satcom's need for India cannot be overemphasised and the government should resolve the issue through a balanced and transparent regulatory framework. However, the unsubstantiated allegation made by Elon Musk accusing an Indian industrialist of blocking Starlink entry is in poor taste and doesn't behove a person of his stature on the world's business space. Public allegations against competitors are no substitute for evidence.
It is futile trying to exert pressure through inflammatory rhetoric to influence Indian regulatory decisions. India would naturally have to take into account national security and critical data security considerations, even while adhering to its policy of strategic autonomy, before allowing a foreign company into the satcom network.

Kosaraju Chandramouli
Hyderabad

Security concerns

This refers to 'India will not succumb to Musk's pressure tactics' (October 12). India is justified in placing national security above commercial pressure when considering foreign satellite communication services. However, security concerns must be supported by a transparent assessment rather than vague apprehensions. The government should establish clear, consistent rules covering spectrum allocation, data protection, lawful interception and emergency access. These requirements must apply equally to domestic and foreign operators.

BA Avyaan
Perundurai, TN

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Trump sees red in midterm

Why GOP's last-minute gimmicks may not work

Sridhar Krishnaswami

The White House and the administration seem to be working overtime to ensure that the political damage from the midterm elections on November 3 is limited. Strategists in the grand old party appear to have concluded that even the deep red states that President Donald Trump carried comfortably in 2020 and 2024 may no longer be safe; hence, millions of dollars are being spent for last-minute ads to save what was once considered 'sure wins', leaving Republicans in a tight contest out in the cold.

With President Trump's approval rating hovering between 29 per cent and 32 per cent, the rank and file have started thinking aloud about Texas, Ohio, Iowa, Kansas, Nebraska, Alaska and even the ruby red states of Oklahoma and Alabama. And throw in Michigan and Georgia, it gives a complete picture of the GOP's worries over both the House of Representatives and the Senate. Republicans were hoping for relief from an end to the Iran war, which has had an impact on gas and grocery prices. But they have had no luck.



TRUMP. On a sticky wicket

A SLIPPERY MOVE

Unmindful of all the hoopla around the Lindsey Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act 2026, which called for 100 per cent tariff on buyers of Russian oil, President Trump called President Vladimir Putin for a "highly successful discussion", after which the Russian leader agreed to supply hundreds of thousands of tonnes of diesel fuel to the American and global markets through April 2027.

Undercutting the Graham Act was meant to appease the farmer voting blocs in the red states and the transportation industry reeling under high fuel prices of $6 per gallon.

Immigration has always been a hot button issue for the Trump administration, both legal and undocumented, and one of the prime objectives is to make the process of getting permanent residency difficult.

RESIDENCY STATUS

A subject close to the Make America Great Again (MAGA) campaign is the H1B visa, green cards and the optional practical training permit for foreign students, seen as a pathway to residency and eventual citizenship. In one swoop, the Labor Department moved against Microsoft and top Indian IT companies by halting the processing of new and pending applications for permanent residency.

"You cannot lay off American workers and then replace them with foreign indentured servants," said Vice President JD Vance.

New Delhi hit back, calling the statement "unwarranted and deeply offensive", and reminded that America has been shaped by "generations of immigrants whose labour, enterprise and innovation have contributed to its growth and prosperity".

Ironically, on the same day, Trump honoured Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella and five other prominent tech leaders, including Elon Musk, with the National Medal of Science and the National Medal of Technology and Innovation. Five out of the six awardees, except Michael Dell of Dell Technologies, were born outside the US.

ROLE OF INDIAN AMERICANS

The yanking of the PERM applications may have been welcomed by the MAGA crowd, but even some Republicans could be questioning the timing and the fact that it is pushing another demographic group, the Indian Americans, farther away from the Republican camp.

As surveys show, Hispanics and African Americans, instrumental in President Trump's 2024 win, are moving away from him and the GOP in huge numbers. Now, questions will be raised if alienating the three million Indian American voters — for whom legal immigration is a high priority and have demonstrated their importance in the key suburban centers in recent polls — was a smart thing to do.

The writer is a senior journalist who has reported from Washington DC on North America and United Nations

Desperate moves to shore up rupee

THE VOID. Steps to prevent rupee depreciation have been futile. The most recent measures are also less likely to succeed

MACROSCAN.



CP CHANDRASHEKHAR, JAYATI GHOSH

The Modi government's cup of woes runneth over. Politically, the government is unable to respond to — much less effectively address — the widespread protests against the urgent problems of lack of employment, scams in education, and now the public anger over manipulation of voters' rolls and elections. Its ham-handed, large-fisted, stick-wielding approach to protests is making things much worse.

Its economic policy is similarly a combination of paralysis and doubling down on clearly failed strategies, which are now generating even worse outcomes for the people. All of this has spread to the external sector, which is showing great strain. It was always more fragile than the government sought to portray, but now seems heading into quicksand.

One clear example of this is the continuous, occasionally precipitous and apparently unstoppable decline in the value of the rupee. The rupee to US dollar rate fell for several years from 2012 onwards, including 2020-22; it was largely stable at around ₹82 to the dollar in 2024, but thereafter it has slid substantially. In 2026, the rupee was one of the worst-performing currencies in the world. As chart 1 shows, it has even fallen significantly against the US dollar, which itself has been losing ground globally vis-a-vis other major currencies.

As in so many other areas, the Modi government's attempts to thwart, or even mitigate this process, have largely failed, or at best produced only temporary effects. Yet, these strategies themselves, which attempt to tide over the current problem of the falling rupee, are mostly not all that effective and can be very expensive in the future, entailing even more forex liabilities that the country may find it difficult to repay.

RBI INTERVENTION

The most standard way central banks today try to control currency volatility is through open market operations, selling or buying (typically) US dollars or other reserve currencies to prop up the value of the rupee in the currency markets. The RBI has certainly tried this multiple times even in the current year, losing tens of billions of US dollars through market interventions to support the rupee.

Ironically, the very loss of official foreign exchange reserve holding that this requires tends to create investor expectations of future depreciation, which can therefore add to more private financial outflows. This conundrum led to the extraordinary measures taken in early June, when the RBI sought to encourage private inflows through all possible means. This involved creating a set of three concessional swaps aimed at encouraging overseas fund-raising by state-owned firms and attracting foreign currency non-resident deposits — Foreign Currency Non-Resident(B) scheme, the Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowing (OFCB) and External Commercial Borrowing (ECB) schemes.

FCNR(B) DOES MAGIC

All of these are questionable in that they enable and even actively encourage more foreign currency borrowing even when there is no reason to believe that the forex constraint on the Indian economy is likely to be eased much in the medium-term future. But the most extraordinary — and most significant — of such schemes is the FCNR(B) scheme.

This provided such a bonanza to non-resident Indians that it could even be called the FCNR(B) scam, not a scheme. It offered 6-7 per cent interest (more than double of what US term deposit rates provide), with the principal guaranteed in US dollars at maturity. The exchange rate risk is borne by the RBI, so there is no fear of nominal depreciation of the rupee reducing returns to NRI investors. What is even worse is the option provided to leverage the initial investment into further investments within India such as in GIFT City.

Not surprisingly, this proved to be popular with NRIs to the point that the scheme, which was intended to continue until mid-October, was closed on August 31. Nearly $1.33 billion flowed into these accounts, adding to India's future forex debt. As chart 2 show, this scheme dominated over the other two in terms of inflows.

The massive amount of investor interest and the inflows this generated led the government to proclaim the FCNR(B) scheme/scam to be a huge success. And chart 3 indicates that this was associated with a recovery of foreign exchange reserves from late June to the end of August. But this recovery was short-lived, with reserves once again beginning to fall once the scheme came to an end. So, it is difficult to claim success. And in any case, success for whom? While NRIs certainly benefit from this scheme, the people of India are set to lose because of the heavy costs of unnecessary forex borrowing which, in any case, is unlikely to be associated with any productive investment.

Another standard practice for dealing with currency volatility and depreciation fears is the exercise of various types of prudential regulation on cross-border financial flows. Indeed, these were the next to be resorted to after forex reserves fell by nearly $52 billion from $785.7 billion on September 4 to $734 billion on October 2. By October 10, the RBI announced a new set of measures. These include restrictions on rebooking of cancelled foreign exchange derivative contracts; reduction in the threshold for undertaking foreign exchange derivative transactions without establishing underlying exposure; requirement of additional documentation for verification of underlying exposures; and introduction of exchange risk reserve (FERR) for all foreign exchange derivative contracts involving rupee with notional values exceeding the equivalent of $2 million.

The rupee was one of the worst-performing currencies in the world in 2026. It has even fallen significantly against the US dollar, which itself has been losing ground globally vis-a-vis other major currencies

THE ROOT CAUSE

Unfortunately, while these measures may reduce some of the bleeding, they are unlikely to address the root cause of the rupee's decline: the combination of unbalanced trade, lower remittances from workers abroad, and stagnant domestic mass consumer demand that makes even domestic businesses less interested in expanding productive capacity.

We can hardly expect foreign corporations to invest in India (without massive and expensive blandishments) if domestic companies and our own wealthy people refuse to do so. Indeed, one of the reasons why our balance of payments position remains so weak despite our claims of great strength, is the extent of outflows by various forms of capital, which have been enabled by financial deregulation.

Chart 4 shows the net investment position of India, indicating both direct and portfolio investments and other investments (these categories contain both equity and debt holdings and are stock numbers, not flow). For a lower middle-income country, with most of its development projects incomplete and greatly in need to additional investments, the extent of capital outflows appears to be quite large. It significantly reduces the net inflows that economies in India's position require for development.

Overall, the government appears to have run out of ideas on all fronts. The turmoil within the country can and will be sorted out, ideally with more democratic and inclusive outcomes. But the costs of continued economic mismanagement today will haunt the people of India for decades thereafter.

CHART 1

Currency matters

Rupee to $



CHART 2

Swap outcome

Forex inflows under RBI's Swap Facility ($ million)

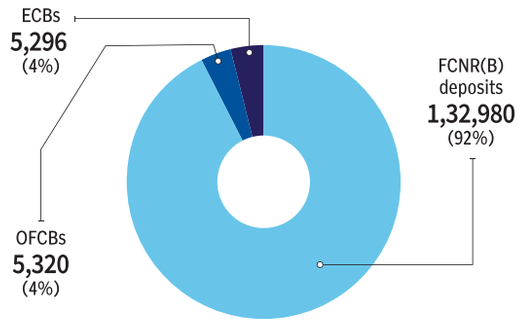


CHART 3

Forex kitty

Forex reserves ($ million)

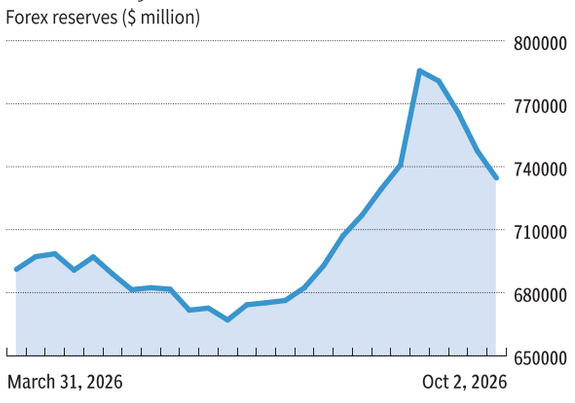
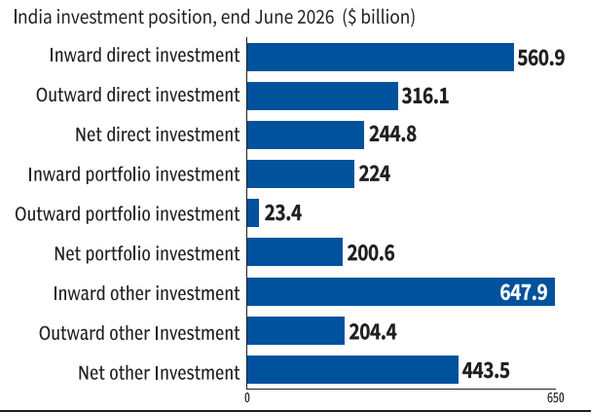


CHART 4

All about investments

India investment position, end June 2026 ($ billion)





thehindu businessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

October 13, 2006

Cairn IPO may raise $2 billion

Cairn India Ltd today filed with SEBI for its proposed IPO, which, according to analysts, stands a chance of being among the largest offers on the Indian bourses. The oil exploration company proposes to offer 538.47 million new equity shares of Rs 10 each for cash at a premium to be decided through a 100 per cent book building process.

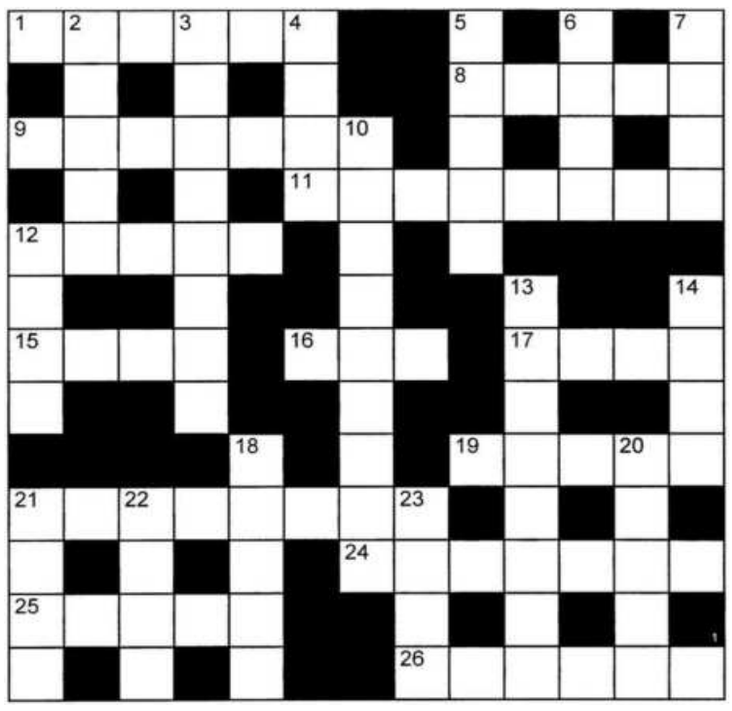
RIL cuts petrol, diesel prices

Within just 12 days of reducing prices of petrol and diesel sold through its retail outlets, Reliance Industries Ltd has once again cut prices of the two products by Re 1 a litre. However, the price of Reliance petrol and diesel would still continue to be marginally higher than the public sector products by about 50 paise to Re 1 in most of the States.

BSNL slashes fixed-line STD rate to Re 1/min

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd has reduced STD rates by 60 per cent from Rs 2.40 per minute to Re 1 per minute. Tariffs of local calls have also been brought down from Rs 1.20 to Re 1 for a three-minute call. The move is part of BSNL's One India plan, which allows calls to any part of the country at Re 1.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2755



EASY

ACROSS

1. To shine (6)
8. Cessation of hostilities (5)
9. Concerning doctoring (7)
11. Separate, unconnected (8)
12. Escargot (5)
15. _____ mater : old school, university (4)
16. Whichever; whatever amount (3)
17. Give back sound (4)
19. Spry, nimble (5)
21. Ringing instrument with a handle (8)
24. Backed for win or place (4,3)
25. To sport with epée (5)
26. Signify (6)

DOWN

2. Greek theatre or concert hall (5)
3. Hostile (8)
4. Leader, chief (4)
5. Cut of beef such as fillet, rump (5)
6. Apply pressure to (4)
7. Curve (4)
10. A species of flatfish (5,4)
12. Chair (4)
13. Increase the extent of (8)
14. To be tedious (4)
18. Declined, flowed back (5)
20. Minimum amount (5)
21. A fit of offended dignity (4)
22. The number of worthies, days' wonder (4)
23. The rendered fat of a hog (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

1. One could impart a gloss to this language (6)
8. Some respite for the English, rude and brief in retreat (5)
9. Sort of treatment claimed to cure (7)
11. Somehow cheated daughter in an impartial manner (8)
12. Its slow pace pins it tail-first (5)
15. An Egyptian dancing-girl in the carnival market-place (4)
16. Whichever, it can fail to start with an unknown (3)
17. Some of the chorus will repeat what's been said (4)
19. A leg one can shake if one's nimble (5)
21. But its ringer doesn't need to know the ropes (8)
24. Win or place it north, south, east and west (4,3)
25. A palisade may be visited by the thief (5)
26. Need to change it to mean something (6)

DOWN

2. A theatre to do up : one needs to change it (5)
3. At home, perhaps I claim it is unfriendly (8)
4. Possessed the internal energy to be at the top (4)
5. A meat portion takes some sorting out (5)
6. It could be considered offensive if this comes to shove (4)
7. It's a knot of a sort that won't go straight (4)
10. Yellow the only colour for this fish? (5,4)
12. If one is standing successfully one will gain one (4)
13. Stretch out from the glen, turning north (8)
14. How it carried the calibre of a shotgun (4)
18. Be up to the sea floor as the tide receded (5)
20. There's none less than the tales woven about it (5)
21. How to remove draughtsman in a fit of pique (4)
22. How many Morris men are over the eight? (4)
23. The fat deposited in a particular disorder (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2754

ACROSS 1. Constructor 8. Air-speed 9. Kale 10. Trust 13. Near 16. Drop 17. Lint 18. Sill 20. Ebbed 24. Easy 25. Parabola 26. Merchandise

DOWN 2. Ours 3. Super 4. Reeds 5. Token 6. Haberdasher 7. Territorial 11. Undue 12. Throb 14. Evil 15. Goal 19. Layer 21. Brava 22. Eland 23. Coss

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - OCTOBER 13 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Tonbo Imaging sets IPO price band at ₹665-700



New Delhi: Defence electronics maker Tonbo Imaging India has fixed a price band of ₹665-700 per share for its ₹852-crore initial public offering (IPO). The issue will open for public subscription on October 15 and conclude on October 19. The IPO is entirely an offer for sale of 1.22 crore shares by promoters and existing investors. The company designs and manufactures sensing, processing, communication and guidance systems used in surveillance, reconnaissance, targeting and control applications. Its product portfolio includes thermal imaging cores, weapon sights, handheld thermal imaging binoculars, targeting systems, missile seekers, fire control systems and missile guidance systems. PTI

Bajaj Finserv arm raises ₹950 cr for first realty fund

Mumbai: Bajaj Finserv's alternative investment platform on Monday said it has raised ₹950 crore for real estate bets. Bajaj Alternate Investment Management said this is the initial close for the 'Bajaj Alts Real Estate - Growth Fund I' and it is targeting a final close of ₹2,000 crore with a greenshoe option. There is a strong pipeline of investment opportunities that the fund is looking at, according to an official statement."This first fund launch marks an important milestone in our journey and sets the foundation for building a broader and diversified alternatives platform for our investors," Lakshmi Iyer, Managing director and chief executive of Bajaj Alts, said. PTI

SIP inflows into MFs hit another high

MARKET VAGARIES. Equity flows rise to 5-month high; AUM dips 5% on mark-to-market losses, debt outflows

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The inflows into mutual funds through systematic investment plan touched yet another high of ₹32,490 crore last month against ₹32,297 crore logged in August even as the free fall in equity markets continued unabated on global headwinds. The overall equity inflows touched 5-month high at ₹38,306 crore (₹29,328 crore), according to the Association of Mutual Funds in India data released on Monday.

Interestingly, small-cap funds received the highest inflow of ₹9,039 crore while mid-cap attracted ₹7,835 crore, as investors pumped-in more money to average out their investments

AUM DECLINE

Asset under management (AUM) of the industry dipped 5 per cent to ₹82.64 lakh crore against ₹87.08 lakh crore in August due to mark-to-market loss and outflow of ₹1.83 lakh crore from debt funds.

Venkat Chalasani, CEO, AMFI said the overall inflows into mutual funds despite the weak markets reflects investors confidence in the industry and economic growth prospects of the country.

The government has already clarified there will be no charges on SIP registered through UPI even as the industry has made representation to exempt charges on lump sum investment made through UPI, said Chalasani.

Manish Mehta, Chief Business Officer, SBI Mutual Fund, said investors seemed to have taken market drawdowns as an opportunity to add to their investments and average their acquisition costs.

A Balasubramanian, MD & CEO, Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC, said the flows reflect the importance of different investment approaches, with active equity funds attracting highest net inflows and equity ETFs witnessing investment of ₹9,960 crore besides strong inflows in Gold ETFs which reflects investors interest in gold as a portfolio diversifier amid market uncertainties.

Saugata Chatterjee President & Deputy CEO , Nippon India Mutual Fund, said the return of positive inflows into large-cap funds is particularly encouraging, as valuations have become relatively attractive even as investors are increasingly diversifying their equity allocations across market capitalisations.

Gaurav Goyal Chief Business Officer, Canara Robeco Asset Management Company, said the cumulative inflow into three scheme of small, mid and flexi cap categories alone accounted for 62 per cent of the active equity net flows. The steady inflows through SIP shows investors are increasingly staying invested through market cycles and are focused on long term wealth creation, he added.

Varun Gupta, CEO of Groww MF said passive products added another dimension, with Equity ETFs recording inflows of ₹9,960 crore and Gold ETFs ₹4,451 crore, both well above August levels.

Better show *(Inflows ₹ crore)*

	August	September
Multi Cap Fund	3,732.77	3,859.55
Large Cap Fund	-1,147.36	859.47
Large & Mid Cap Fund	3,872.79	4,271.22
Mid Cap Fund	6,989.40	7,834.84
Small Cap Fund	7,973.33	9,038.57
Flexi Cap Fund	5,059.42	6,701.80
Dividend Yield Fund	-133.57	179.31
Value Fund	24.40	1,290.89
Contra Fund	1,328.01	-97.88
Focused Fund	994.74	1,390.84
Sectoral Fund	-53.19	1,840.02
Thematic Fund	1,766.19	1,800.07
ELSS- Tax Saver Fund	-1,078.32	-662.14
Total	**29,328.62**	**38,306.55**

Source: AMFI

Nifty fails to hold on to positive start, falls 157 pts

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Equities closed lower on Monday as elevated crude oil prices, persistent foreign fund outflows and rising bond yields weighed on sentiment. The Nifty opened 70 points higher and touched an intra-day high of 22,651.10 before reversing course as selling pressure emerged.

The Nifty 50 fell 157.10 points to close at 22,363.35, while the Sensex declined 547.65 points to 71,924.68. The Bank Nifty shed 338.65 points, or 0.61 per cent, to settle at 54,918.

Nandish Shah, Deputy Vice-president at HDFC Securities, said profit booking set in almost immediately after the opening and persisted through the session. NSE cash-market turnover declined 4 per cent from the previous session.

Foreign institutional investor outflows, which have crossed ₹3-lakh-crore so far in 2026, continued to weigh on domestic equities. The 10-year government bond yield rose for a fourth consecutive session, adding to investor caution.

The sell-off in the benchmark indices contrasted with gains in parts of the broader market. The Nifty Smallcap 100 rose 1.42 per cent, while the Nifty Midcap 100 edged up 0.08 per cent. Sectorally, Nifty Media gained 4.60 per cent, leading advances, followed by Chemicals, Auto, Realty and Pharma. FMCG declined more than 1.70 per cent, making it the worst-performing sector, while PSU banks, IT and metals also ended lower.

GAINERS, LOSERS

Among Nifty constituents, Dr Reddy's Lab, Bajaj Auto and Tata Motors PV were among the leading gainers, while Apollo Hospitals, ITC and Tech Mahindra were among the biggest losers.

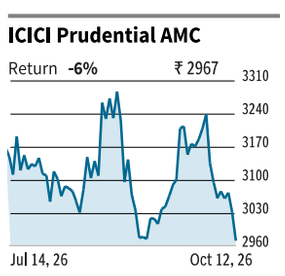
ICICI Prudential AMC net profit up 6% on rise in AUM

Our Bureau
Mumbai

ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company reported that its net profit was up 6 per cent in the September quarter at ₹889 crore against ₹838 crore logged in the same period last year, on higher in AUM.

Revenue increased 16 per cent to ₹1,674 crore (₹1,439 crore) while other income was down 76 per cent at ₹169 crore (₹719 crore).

Other income was down due to mark-to-market valuations on treasury investments, surplus cash deployments, or seed capital investments in its own mutual fund schemes, impacting profits.



The leading fund house has declared an interim dividend of ₹30 a share.

Overall expenses jumped to ₹493 crore (₹418 crore) as employees benefit was up 15 per cent at ₹213 crore (₹186 crore) and fees and commission paid was up 32 per cent at ₹133 crore (₹102 crore).

The quarterly average AUM of the fund house increased 14 per cent to ₹11.61 lakh crore (₹10.15 lakh crore) while the active AUM jumped 11 per cent to ₹9.59 lakh crore (₹8.63 lakh crore).

The inflows through Systematic Investment Plan (SIP) was down 3 per cent at ₹4,672 crore (₹4,803 crore) as most investors paused their SIP due to negative returns in last few months.

Zetwerk IPO opens on Oct 15 at ₹143-151

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses is banking on rising demand for energy equipment and artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure to sustain growth, as the manufacturing platform prepares to open its ₹5,012-crore initial public offering (IPO) on October 15 at a price band of ₹143-151 per share.

The company's order book, comprising confirmed orders, rose to more than ₹13,000 crore as of the first quarter of FY27, from ₹12,300 crore reported earlier, according to Executive Director, MD, Chairperson and CEO Amrit Pratik Acharya. The order book grew about 40 per cent year-on-year, providing visibility for future revenue, he said.

A key growth driver is demand for power equipment used by US data centres. Zetwerk has disclosed around ₹2,000 crore in orders linked to this segment, where long lead times for equipment are creating opportunities for suppliers that can deliver faster.

"There's a lag between orders and revenue," Acharya said, adding that a substantial portion of the AI infrastructure orders won in FY26 had yet to be reflected in the previous year's revenue. The company's international business, largely comprising the US, contributes around 30 per cent of its manufacturing revenue.



Amrit Pratik Acharya, Chairperson and CEO, Zetwerk

REVENUE GROWTH

Zetwerk reported revenue of ₹15,913 crore in FY26, up nearly 40 per cent from the previous year. Adjusted EBITDA rose to ₹420 crore from ₹97 crore in FY24, reflecting operating leverage from investments in design, engineering and software over the past eight years.

However, its loss widened to ₹1,606 crore in FY26 from ₹371 crore. Acharya attributed the increase largely to one-time, non-cash accounting adjustments following a restructuring of the company's capital and an increase in the founders' ownership stake, alongside charges associated with its discontinued civil infrastructure business.

The IPO comprises a fresh issue of ₹2,830 crore and an offer for sale of ₹2,182 crore. Proceeds from the fresh issue will primarily be used to repay debt, with the balance earmarked for acquisitions and general corporate purposes.

Risk-o-Meter may make bond risks easier to compare

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

SEBI's new Credit Risk-o-Meter could make it easier for retail investors to compare debt investments by translating credit ratings into six colour-coded risk categories, addressing a common difficulty in interpreting ratings assigned by different credit rating agencies. SEBI has mandated, effective in 45 days, the meter for listed and proposed-to-be-listed debt instruments including non-convertible securities and commercial papers, whether issued through public issues or private placements.

The framework maps existing credit ratings to six categories, ranging from lowest credit risk to high or very high risk of default.

Gibin John, Senior Investment Strategist at Geojit Investments, said differences in how rating agencies present ratings for the same bond could confuse investors assessing the underlying risk. "A common Risk-o-Meter will help investors easily understand the risk level of bonds in a standardised and uniform manner," he said, adding that the framework could improve investor confidence in debt investments.

The standardisation is intended to help investors compare securities more easily, but the meter will not replace credit ratings.

Makarand M Joshi, founding partner of MMJC & Associates, said the initiative would simplify risk communication by converting technical terminology into colour-coded indicators.

The measure could be significant for a corporate bond market valued at more than ₹45 lakh crore, where retail investors account for less than 3 per cent.

For investors, the immediate benefit is a standardised visual indicator alongside existing disclosures. Whether this translates into higher retail participation will depend on investors' understanding of debt products and their willingness to assess risks beyond the colour-coded rating.

SEBI notifies common ad code

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India has notified a common advertisement code for market intermediaries, allowing them to engage celebrities for brand or entity-level promotion and prohibiting endorsements of specific financial products or services.

The Common Advertisement Code will apply to regulated entities, including stock brokers, depository participants, investment advisers, research analysts, online bond platform providers, portfolio managers, and mutual funds/asset management companies.

"The celebrities shall be allowed to endorse the regulated entity at the brand level or the entity level. Such endorsements may include the name of products or services offered by a regulated entity but may not include any inducement or claim directly or indirectly regarding any specific product or service," the notification dated October 8 said.

Indian Gas Exchange gets SEBI nod for IPO

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

OIndian Gas Exchange Ltd (IGX), on Monday secured SEBI's approval to float an initial public offering (IPO), an update with the regulator showed.

The proposed public issue is entirely an offer for sale (OFS) of up to 1.67 crorey shares by promoter Indian Energy Exchange Ltd (IEX), according to the draft red herring prospectus (DRHP).

As the issue is entirely an OFS, IGX will not receive any proceeds from the IPO. The entire proceeds will go to the selling shareholder, IEX.

The company had filed its preliminary IPO papers in July. After reviewing the draft prospectus, SEBI gave its final observation on October 12.

UPL jumps 5% on speciality chemical prospects

Our Bureau
Mumbai

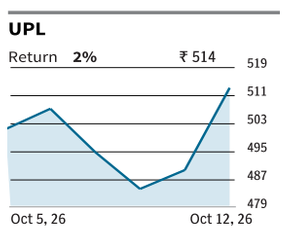
Shares of UPL Ltd rose about 5 per cent to ₹514 on Monday after brokerage reports highlighted the growth potential of Superform, the company's speciality chemicals business subsidiary.

The brokerage said Superform is targeting revenue growth of 20-23 per cent annually, with phosphorus and cyanide chemistries emerging as key growth drivers.

BATTERY PUSH

The Superform business will also expanding into battery chemicals, seeking to capitalise on demand for specialised materials and opportunities to diversify global supply chains beyond China.

"Superform bis looking to re-accelerate speciality-chemicals growth, targeting a 45–50 per cent contribution to total revenue over time, while clocking a 20 per cent revenue CAGR, with the segment likely to outpace overall business growth", said a Motilal Oswal Financial Services report.



The brokerage also highlighted the business's backward and forward integration, which it said could strengthen supply-chain resilience, reduce dependence on external suppliers and improve cost competitiveness.

The China plus 1 trend is expected to provide an additional growth opportunity.

BROKER'S CALL.

Jefferies

CAN FIN HOMES (BUY)
Target: ₹1,075
CMP: ₹735.15
Can Fin Homes Ltd, promoted by Canara Bank, is among the leading housing finance companies offering affordable housing loans to borrowers in the low- and middle-income group segment. About 76 per cent of its overall loans are to salaried borrowers. The company has a network of 187 branches across 21 States, with primary presence in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka. It is the first housing finance company promoted by any nationalised bank in the country and is one of the very few housing finance companies permitted by NHB to take deposits from public. Can Fin Home's September quarter PAT grew 9 per cent y-o-y to ₹275 crore, 3 per cent beat to Jefferies expectations (JFe) on lower provision and operational expenditure. Assets under growth moderated to 10 per cent (11 per cent June quarter) as disbursements (-7 per cent y-o-y) was impacted by tech implementation driven disruption.
Rundown rates was tad better q-o-q and NIM fell 3 bps q-o-q and exit spreads fell 3 bps q-o-q. Yields rose 3 bps vs 5 bps q-o-q rise in cost of fund. Gross stage 3/GS2 rose 2/8 bps q-o-q. Credit cost fell 5 bps q-o-q to 7 bps due to drop in ECL cover.
Our price target of ₹1,075 is based on 1.7x P/BV Sep-28e.
Key downside risks include slower loan growth; steeper fall in NIMs due to fall in home loan rates, and deterioration in asset quality.

Asit C Mehta

EMMVEE PHOTOVOLTAIC (BUY)
Target: ₹395
CMP: ₹297.05
We initiate coverage on Emmvee Photovoltaic Power Ltd (EMMVEE) with a 'Buy' rating and a target price of ₹395, valuing the company at 7.5x its 4-quarter ending Sep-28 EEBITDA.
Emmvee is among India's leading integrated solar PV module and cell manufacturers with 10.30 GW of module capacity and 2.94 GW of cell capacity, with further capex and backward integration plans. It is among the pioneers of the high-efficiency TOPCon technology in India, thus catering to the market's deficit in TOPCon capacity. It is enlisted in ALMM List I and List II, enabling it to supply to projects with DCR mandate. Being among the larger players in a fragmented market and an early mover in technology adoption and backward integration has helped the company to benefit from the industry tailwinds. This is reflected in its strong order book and better margins. We expect the company will continue to see these benefits, as India continues its focus on achieving its renewable energy targets. Emmvee is currently trading at 6.2x 1-year fwd EV/EBITDA. It trades at 5.7x FY28E EBITDA, which is at about 6 per cent discount to the industry average of 6x, and a significant 28/41 per cent discount, respectively, to Waaree and Premier's corresponding multiples. Considering the strong growth expectation and further benefit from backward integration, we value the company at an EV/EBITDA multiple of 7.5x based on 4-quarter ending Sep-28E EBITDA, arriving at a target price of ₹395.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

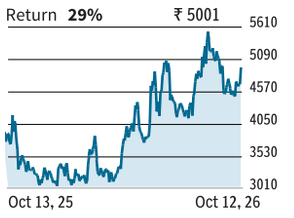
Netweb Technologies India (₹5,001.45): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Netweb Technologies. The stock has begun the week on a strong note by surging over 5 per cent on Monday. This rise has taken the share price well above a key resistance level of ₹4,880. The region between ₹4,900 and ₹4,800 is a good support zone for the stock now. Moving Average indicators are also giving good bullish signal.

Netweb Technologies India share price can rise to ₹5,450-₹5,500 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Netweb Technologies India shares now at ₹5,001. Accumulate on dips at ₹4,940. Keep the stop-loss at ₹4,740 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹5,080 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹5,160. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹5,230 and ₹5,320 when the share price touches ₹5,280 and ₹5,390 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹5,440.

Netweb Technologies



Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

22399 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
22280	22000	22485	22530	Go short on a rise at 22420 and 22460 with a stop-loss at 22510

₹703 » **HDFC Bank**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
700	696	708	715	Take fresh shorts below 700. Keep the stop-loss at 702

₹1015 » **Infosys**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1005	990	1030	1045	Go short only below 1005. Keep the stop-loss at 1010

₹257 » **ITC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
256	253	260	264	Go short only below 256. Stop-loss can be kept at 257

₹219 » **ONGC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
218	215	221	223	Go long on a bounce from 218. Keep the stop-loss at 217

₹1156 » **Reliance Ind.**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1140	1100	1165	1175	Go short now and at 1160. Stop-loss can be kept at 1170

₹940 » **SBI**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
938	932	944	948	Take fresh shorts below 938. Keep the stop-loss at 940

₹2125 » **TCS**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2105	2070	2150	2190	Wait for dips. Go long at 2110. Keep the stop-loss at 2095

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 157.10 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Bajaj Auto	10034.00	6.04	23.87	1.06
Bharat Elec	373.90	4.45	44.46	1.29
Dr Reddys Lab	1229.40	4.27	32.24	0.72
Kotak Bank	443.40	3.82	21.73	3.16
BSE Ltd	3330.20	3.80	48.14	1.31
M&M	2813.00	3.24	17.28	2.43
Eicher Motors	7119.00	2.06	33.86	0.95
Tata Motors PV	284.45	2.06	0.00	0.58
HCL Tech	1223.00	1.43	19.04	1.25
Cipla	1311.30	1.25	31.57	0.71
JSW Steel	1173.00	1.04	10.25	1.09
HDFC Life	559.25	0.60	61.52	0.58
TataConsumerProduct	958.80	0.53	57.78	0.60
Sun Pharma	1760.00	0.00	34.85	1.80
PowerGrid Corp	249.00	-0.15	14.57	1.09
Adani Enter	2630.00	-0.32	47.38	0.86
SBI Life	1680.80	-0.37	64.84	0.73
Trent Ltd.	2913.00	-0.37	85.60	0.94
Eternal Ltd.	323.00	-0.70	719.88	2.26
Asian Paints	2331.00	-0.79	46.22	1.02
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	213.45	-0.83	68.20	0.68
Titan	4400.00	-0.89	67.82	1.76
ONGC	220.00	-1.07	6.18	0.83
Adani Ports	1754.00	-1.19	30.80	1.33
NestleIndia	1324.70	-1.29	67.03	0.92
Bajaj Finance	957.25	-1.62	28.86	2.52
Bajaj Finserv	1719.90	-1.86	13.35	0.97
IntGlobeAvi	4795.00	-1.86	0.00	1.05
NTPC	310.00	-2.05	10.61	1.42
Infosys	1020.00	-2.60	13.65	3.48
Grasim Ind	2858.00	-2.61	17.09	1.04
Tata Steel	172.24	-2.80	19.09	1.38
Max Healthcare	865.95	-2.87	57.83	0.62
Maruti Suzuki	11315.00	-2.95	24.82	1.42
Shriram Finance Ltd.	929.40	-3.35	19.32	1.26
Coal India	404.80	-3.49	8.00	0.94
Axis Bank	1253.00	-3.79	13.96	3.48
UltraTech Cement	10520.00	-3.96	36.17	1.20
Hindalco	882.50	-5.58	12.09	1.23
Apollo Hosp	7775.00	-5.62	51.47	0.77
Tech Mahindra	1471.00	-5.92	27.93	0.90
TCS	2125.00	-6.84	14.83	2.10
Hind Unilever	1820.70	-6.90	40.77	1.56
HDFC Bank	704.90	-7.78	13.17	10.44
State Bank	941.00	-16.17	9.69	3.76
Reliance Ind	1158.90	-16.47	17.79	7.49
ITC	257.90	-16.88	16.01	2.40
Bharti Airtel	1778.70	-17.35	30.48	5.23
L&T	3627.50	-19.17	25.43	4.10
ICICI Bank	1340.00	-23.23	16.10	9.28

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 185.00 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Hindustanaeronautics	4760.00	56.57	34.15	3.77
Samvardmothersoninternatl	156.99	50.35	36.38	2.90
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3940.30	49.31	51.98	3.87
Power Finance	337.90	42.01	3.31	2.06
Divis Lab	9426.00	31.22	85.55	5.01
Bosch	44585.00	25.77	55.65	1.62
Hitachi Energy	31290.00	24.89	121.23	1.66
Cg Power & Ind Sol	867.50	23.41	110.38	2.49
Solar Industries	20334.00	23.24	89.74	2.07
Polycab India	8405.00	22.90	43.59	1.88
Indian Railway Finance Corp	77.50	17.92	14.09	0.73
Adanigreenenergy	1274.00	17.43	97.79	1.78
Adani Energy Solutions .	1280.00	16.77	50.65	1.75
Hdfc Amc	2289.70	15.86	33.33	1.95
Siemens	3654.00	14.89	89.57	1.35
Tata Capital	327.00	13.03	25.34	0.75
Zyduslifesciences	1134.40	11.96	24.64	1.17
Abb India	6855.50	11.32	93.41	1.50
Torrent Pharma	4682.00	10.55	82.60	2.88
Vedanta Aluminium	373.50	8.96	0.00	2.65
Tata Power	343.70	7.43	20.89	2.41
Hindus Zinc	546.90	4.67	13.54	1.10
Vedanta	264.90	4.53	6.20	1.95
Siemens Energy India .	3118.10	4.32	74.62	1.15
Mazagoan Dock	2027.00	3.69	28.65	0.64
Muthootfin	2634.10	2.88	9.23	1.18
Dlf	650.00	2.56	36.19	1.74
Gail (India)	166.91	2.08	11.12	1.88
Cummins Inida	4835.00	1.93	56.62	2.73
Hyundai Motor India .	1941.10	0.45	31.86	1.15
Bank Of Baroda	235.40	-2.12	6.62	1.82
Pidilitind	1477.70	-3.81	56.21	1.92
Jindal Steel	1012.50	-4.45	38.13	1.57
Wipro	161.80	-5.96	12.06	1.83
Ambuja Cements	348.00	-6.23	16.67	0.91
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1580.70	-8.55	23.48	2.86
Bajaj Holdings	10750.00	-8.66	13.30	1.95
Union Bank	171.33	-9.55	6.34	1.38
Punjab Natl Bank	116.00	-9.64	6.02	1.67
Godrej Consumer	852.05	-9.70	45.57	1.43
Indian Oilcorp	125.35	-10.67	4.95	1.96
Canara Bank	118.38	-11.62	5.42	1.66
Ltimindtree	4018.90	-13.55	22.94	1.56
Britannia Ind	4774.50	-16.99	44.06	2.35
Bpcl	284.50	-18.92	7.20	2.39
Idea Cellular	12.67	-25.95	3.67	1.46
Varun Beverages .	433.30	-30.07	42.99	2.48
Tata Motors Cv	404.50	-34.65	35.58	3.54
Adani Power .	185.90	-36.84	24.67	3.23
Avenuesuper	3364.90	-70.00	71.78	2.27

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Mittal conferred France's highest civilian award



Mumbai: France honoured Bharti Enterprises Founder and Chairman Sunil Bharti Mittal with the *Knight of the National Order* distinction of the Legion of Honour for his role in deepening economic ties between India and France and achievements in telecommunications and digital infrastructure. Established in 1802 by Napoleon Bonaparte, the Légion d'Honneur is the highest civilian award bestowed by the French Republic. OUR BUREAU

Aequs, Safran expand ties

Bengaluru: Precision manufacturing company Aequs has signed long-term supply agreements with Safran for critical aerospace components. Aequs has extended its relationship to Safran Aerosystems and Safran Electronics & Defense. OUR BUREAU

DoT readies Cabinet note on spectrum charges for satcom

HOME-GROWN BOOST. Domestic players will be encouraged to participate in the sector

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi



DIGITAL DRIVE. The draft is ready and it can come any time in the coming days, says a senior government official

The Department of Telecom has prepared a Cabinet note on spectrum usage charges for satellite communication (satcom) services, which is expected to be placed before the Cabinet for consideration and approval in the coming days, according to government sources.

"The Cabinet may soon approve the spectrum norms for the satcom services...the decision has been already taken for 5 per cent AGR with 1 per cent discount for some rural areas, which the government would decide. The draft is ready and it can come any time in the coming days," a senior government official told *businessline*.

NOD FOR SUC

Last month, the Digital Communications Commission (DCC) approved a spectrum usage charge (SUC) of 5 per cent of adjusted gross revenue (AGR) for satcom service providers, with a reduction of one percentage point, taking the charge to 4 per cent for services delivered in government-notified hard-to-connect and remote border areas. The proposal now awaits the next stage of government consideration.

Even after a decision on the spectrum usage charge and administrative allocation of spectrum, companies will have to obtain the requisite security clearances, including from the Ministry of Home Affairs, before commencing operations, in accordance with the applicable conditions.

Meanwhile, government sources said domestic companies would be encouraged to participate in the sector rather than India depending only on foreign players, citing concerns over security, accountability and the sourcing of equipment.

This is significant in the context of recent outburst by Elon Musk who has accused certain "oligarchs" of trying to block Starlink's satcom services in India to "maintain their monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people". In posts on X, he questioned whether "Ambani is the real boss of India".

"I think liabilities can be taken care of if more domestic players are involved in the sector, Satcom is an all-new sector and we need to understand who is doing what, and equipment are procured within the country. Who would take the responsibilities of anything going wrong up in the orbits? We have to rely on someone who can be trusted," said another government official.

FOREIGN OPERATORS

However, officials said India could also consider other foreign operators, including Amazon Leo, formerly known as Project Kuiper, which is in the process of seeking approval for satcom testing in the country. Such companies would have to comply with Indian security requirements.

Amazon Leo is a low-earth-orbit (LEO) satellite broadband network designed to provide high-speed, low-latency internet connectivity, including in underserved areas.

"Any company that is ready to work with conditions laid out by the government are welcome. National security is our primary requirement and also a priority, and anybody who wants to operate in our country, has to follow the law of the land. We have data centres that store data within our country, apps/ social media platforms that abide by set conditions. So, in similar way, same has to be done for the satcom," the official said.

Canadian Minister leads trade team to India

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



Maninder Sidhu, Canadian International Trade Minister

Canadian International Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu is leading a nearly 300-member trade delegation to India this week, as the two countries push to advance negotiations for a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) that could open up new opportunities for businesses in both countries.

The Team Canada Trade Mission to India, running from October 12 to 17 with stops in Mumbai and Bengaluru, is the largest trade delegation Canada has sent to the country in over 30 years, according to a recent Canadian government statement. The visit will connect Canadian businesses with Indian decision-makers, industry players and potential clients to explore commercial opportunities and forge new partnerships.

The delegation includes businesses from aerospace and space, clean technologies and energy transition, information and communication technologies, life sciences and agri-food sectors.

"By matching Canadian expertise in sectors like aerospace, agri-food and clean technology with India's growing demand, we will diversify our trade and attract new investment. This is how we will more than double our trade with India to $70 billion by 2030," Sidhu said in his statement.

EXPANDING TIES

The mission comes as the two countries are pushing to conclude a CEPA by this year-end, potentially providing a wider framework for expanding trade and investment ties. Both governments are working towards finalising the agreement before Prime Minister Narendra Modi's expected visit to Canada in December.

Canada is seeking to diversify its trade beyond the US, with a target of doubling exports to markets outside the US over the next decade. Doubling annual two-way trade with India to C$70 billion by 2030 is a key component of this strategy.

The fifth round of CEPA negotiations took place in Ottawa beginning October 5, with predictable market access for agricultural products and farm inputs, including pulses and fertilisers, technical standards and adequate visas for workers among the issues the two sides are seeking to resolve, sources said.

KEY AREA

Agriculture is expected to be one of the most difficult areas of the negotiations, given Canada's demand for stable, long-term access to India's market for pulses. India has changed import duties on pulses several times in recent years, prompting Canadian farm groups to seek enforceable commitments against sudden policy changes.

"Canadian farm groups have asked for enforceable commitments rather than tariff cuts that could be reversed at short notice," a source tracking the negotiations told *businessline*.

Sidhu had earlier highlighted Canadian farmers' demand for certainty and predictability in accessing the Indian market. The proposed agreement also focuses on ties in energy, advanced manufacturing, AI, with both countries looking to deepen commercial engagement and supply chains.

FM proposes 5 priority areas for steel firms; decarbonisation, lower import on the list

Our Bureau
New Delhi



Nirmala Sitharaman, Finance Minister

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday proposed five priorities including a focus on decarbonisation for the domestic steel sector.

"Decarbonisation is the steel industry's greatest long-term challenge. We must reduce both the energy intensity and the carbon intensity of steel production, even as we expand capacity to meet development needs, Sitharaman said while addressing the World Steel Association General Assembly here.

Other four points include moving up the value chain, decarbonise at a pace consistent with development, supporting open and rules-based trade and meeting growing domestic demand through domestic capacity.

She mentioned that the government has introduced the PLI scheme for specialty steel, with an approved outlay of ₹6,300 crore. The scheme encourages investment in domestic manufacturing and technology upgradation, helping India produce more of the specialised steel that its economy needs. "While much of the global industry is grappling with excess capacity and weak demand, India is experiencing a different trajectory, driven by domestic consumption and sustained investment," she said.

At approximately 109 kg per person, against the world average of 209 kg, she said, India's steel consumption has considerable room to rise. The demand for steel is driven by the government's sustained public capital investment programme. Union government capital expenditure has risen sixfold, from approximately ₹2 lakh crore in 2014-15, to ₹12.2 lakh crore in FY27.

With construction and infrastructure accounting for about two-thirds of India's steel use, this investment directly translates into demand for the metal, she said, adding that public investment gives the industry a sustained domestic market and the confidence to invest in capacity and modernisation. She emphasised that for World Steel Association members, India offers the fastest-growing major steel market, with a public investment programme and a green steel framework already in place. Sitharaman also urged the World Steel Association to consider setting up an office in India, citing the country's emergence as the largest single source of growth in global steel demand.

Noting that the association opened its Beijing office in 2006, when China drove most of the growth in steel demand, she said a stronger presence in India would bring it closer to a key market for incremental demand, technological development, and industrial expansion. An India office would also help the association strengthen its engagement with fast-growing steel markets in South Asia, South-East Asia, West Asia and Africa, with which India has longstanding commercial ties, she added.

IndiGo eyes 9-10 A321 XLR aircraft by March

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

IndiGo expects to have 9-10 A321 XLR planes in its fleet by the end of March 2027 and these aircraft will be deployed on medium-haul routes, a senior executive said on Monday.

"The real piece is that the India market is probably maturing, which means there is a bigger appetite for a more premiumised offering... that is reflected in IndiGo's fleet network product as we move towards a greater share of having more business class seats on the domestic product (and) also on the short haul international (routes)...," the airline's Chief Strategy Officer Aloke Singh said.

IndiGo has a fleet of more than 430 planes, including 4 A321 XLRs.

"The market which is a little beyond the one that we are now looking at, which is the medium-haul market... and that will be served by... the (A321) XLRs, which are really made for long-term routes. We have four already in the fleet. We should get to about nine or ten by the end of the financial year," he said.

India is a manufacturing centre for the world: KONE CEO

bl.interview

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

> We see opportunities across residential segments, from high-rise developments in Mumbai to individual villas.
>
> **PHILIPPE DELORME,** President and CEO of KONE Corporation



Finland-headquartered KONE Corporation, one of the world's largest elevator and escalator makers, is betting on India's ageing lift infrastructure to drive its next phase of growth.

With an estimated installed base of nearly one million elevators and a growing need for upgrades, the company sees significant opportunities in modernisation and retrofit solutions alongside new installations.

Philippe Delorme, President and CEO of KONE Corporation, discussed India's growth prospects, technology-led retrofit solutions, expansion plans beyond metros, investment priorities and the proposed acquisition of TK Elevator. *Edited excerpts:*

India's estimated one-million-lift installed base presents a substantial modernisation opportunity. How is KONE approaching this market?

India is still a relatively young elevator market, but we are beginning to see demand for modernising equipment installed earlier. We are at the beginning of this opportunity.

We have developed a solution that can modernise an elevator in one week. By simplifying and standardising the process, we can complete essential upgrades much faster.

For a six- to 10-storey residential building with a single elevator, shutting it down for five weeks is difficult, particularly for elderly residents or those with mobility challenges. We are seeing encouraging traction for this offering.

When will the one-week modernisation programme be launched in India?

We intend to introduce it in the coming weeks. Our ambition is to complete suitable projects in one week, particularly in buildings of up to about 10 floors. Not every installation will qualify, but we want to achieve this wherever technically feasible.

KONE has invested around ₹450 crore in its Sriperumbudur manufacturing facility near Chennai. What further investments are planned through FY2030?

India is a manufacturing centre for the world. Sriperumbudur is one of our four principal manufacturing locations globally.

The plant primarily serves India, but we also want to increase our export capacity.

India has been an important market for us, particularly over the past decade. Manufacturing, technology and innovation remain central to our development here.

When do you expect the proposed €29.4-billion acquisition of TK Elevator to close, and what would it mean for India?

We have announced our intention to combine with TK Elevator, but the transaction has not closed.

Regulatory approvals are required in India, Europe and the US. We believe the conditions are right, but the authorities must give their approval.

We are planning for a closing in 2027, potentially towards the latter part of the year. Until then, we continue to compete with TK Elevator. TK Elevator has operations in India, and we would look at combining those operations if the transaction receives the necessary approvals.

KONE has held roughly 25 per cent of India's elevator market for several years. Could the acquisition help it capture a larger share?

We do not comment on market-share figures for individual countries.

We are one of the leaders in India and aim for leadership. Our differentiation comes from safety, customer satisfaction and innovation. These have driven our development in India and will continue to guide us.

Beyond the major metros, where do you see the strongest growth opportunities?

We are well established in high-rise and mid-rise buildings in major cities. We also see opportunities in the next 20 cities, where we have expanded our geographical presence, particularly in low-rise and mid-rise developments.

Residential construction remains a major driver. Buildings are becoming taller, increasing demand for higher-speed elevators.

Are you developing products for emerging segments such as luxury villas and data centres?

We see opportunities across residential segments, from high-rise developments in Mumbai to individual villas. We have introduced Villa 100 for premium residential properties and are seeing encouraging demand.

What is KONE's single biggest priority over the next five years?

Digital transformation. It is something we cannot afford to miss.

Digital technology helps us improve safety, predict maintenance requirements and deliver a better customer experience.

Our new Digital Experience Center in Pune is an important milestone in demonstrating these capabilities to customers.



CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - OCTOBER 13 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Crude oil slips on hopes of increased Russian supplies



New Delhi: Crude oil prices slipped on expectations of more Russian supplies after US President Donald Trump said Ukraine and Russia had agreed to halt attacks on each other's energy facilities following a US diesel-supply deal with Moscow. Brent crude futures fell 11 cents, or 0.11 per cent, to $104.61 a barrel, while US West Texas Intermediate crude was at $91.36 a barrel, down 49 cents, or 0.53 per cent. REUTERS

Palm oil rises 1% on cues from Dalian exchange

Kuala Lumpur: Malaysian palm oil futures climbed 1 per cent on Monday, rebounding from the previous session's losses, as firmer Dalian palmolein prices and strong export data lent support. The benchmark palm oil contract for December delivery on the Bursa Malaysia Derivatives Exchange gained 46 ringgit, or 1 per cent, to 4,638 ringgit ($1,136.49) a tonne at the close. REUTERS

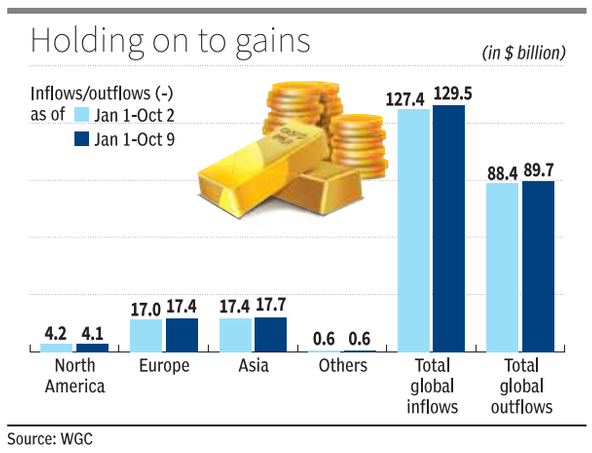
Aluminium rebounds from 8-month low; copper climbs

Aluminium prices touched an eight-month low as a strong dollar pressured sentiment, while copper climbed to its highest in more than two weeks due to worries over mine supply disruptions. Benchmark three-month aluminium on the London Metal Exchange was up 0.3 per cent at $3,058 a tonne. Meanwhile, LME copper rose 0.8% to $14,657 a tonne after hitting $14,688, its highest since September 25. REUTERS

Positive inflows into gold ETFs continue for the 12th week in a row

LEADING THE PACK. China led the inflows with $365 million, while US investors redeemed $132 million

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai



Source: WGC

Investments in physically backed gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) remained positive for the twelfth week in a row last week, but for every $10 in inflows, there were $7 in outflows, data from the World Gold Council (WGC) showed.

Data showed that while US investors led ETF exits, Chinese investors led the inflows. While $2.08 billion was invested in gold ETFs last week, redemptions were to the tune of $1.46 billion.

The trend follows an over 3 per cent fall in the price of the yellow metal in the past month. On Monday, gold was quoted below $4,165 an ounce, down a little less than one per cent.

PRICES FLUCTUATE

"Gold prices witnessed fluctuations over the past week, falling to near two-month lows before recovering on bargain buying and softer US yields. While the rebound has brought some stability, prices remain sensitive to the dollar, interest-rate expectations and geopolitical developments," said Darshan Desai, CEO of Aspect Bullion & Refinery.

"Hawkish Fed minutes and speeches, a firm dollar and US Treasury yields at two-decade highs weighed heavily on gold midweek of last week. Sentiment turned after President Trump spoke of 'productive discussions' with Iran, which cooled oil prices and eased inflation fears," said Renisha Chainani, chief research officer at Augmont. In the week ending October 2, the US led inflows, totalling $686 billion. That week, investments were $3.46 billion, and redemptions were $1.51 billion.

ASIANS TOP

Last week, US investments were a negative $132 million, but inflows in China were $365 million and in Switzerland $223 million. Overall, investments in North America were a negative $111 million, while they were positive in Europe and Asia at $370 million and $376 million, respectively.

Year-to-date, net investments by Asians topped at $17.72 billion. European investments were $17.38 billion, while they were $4.12 billion in North America.

Country-wise, Chinese inflows were $9.9 billion, followed by the UK at $.966 billion. Though the latest data on India were not available, the country was third in investing in ETFs at $4.7 billion, followed by the US at $4.2 billion.

Swiss investments were positive at $3.6 billion, as also Germans at $2.33 billion and the French at $1.8 billion. Canadians have redeemed more than they have invested, with inflows a negative $111 million.

STRONGEST FLOOR

Chainani said official buying remained gold's strongest floor. The People's Bank of China stepped up purchases in September, its 23rd consecutive month of additions. World Gold Council data released this week showed global gold ETFs added 67.3 tonnes in September, taking holdings to a record 4,256 tonnes.

"For the week ahead, gold may remain range-bound as US inflation data, Federal Reserve signals and geopolitical developments will continue to drive price movements," said Desai.

Cotton rebounds on fears of yield drop, offtake

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru



Due to low yields and a smaller crop, farmers are holding back their produce ANI

Cotton prices rebounded by around ₹3,000-4,000 per candy last week to around ₹68,000 amid slow arrivals of the new crop and fears of yield losses due to deficient rainfall. This comes even as farmers have begun holding back their crop, anticipating higher prices in the days ahead, according to trade sources.

The rebound also mirrors the recovery in Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) cotton futures for the December and March contracts during the week. Meanwhile, the Cotton Corporation of India (CCI) raised its auction prices for the 2025-26 crop by ₹500 per candy (356 kg) across all states.

New crop arrivals have begun, with cumulative arrivals reaching around 5 lakh bales in the first nine days of the current 2026-27 season. On Monday, arrivals stood at around 78,000 bales, including approximately 17,000 bales in North India, 16,000 in Madhya Pradesh, 15,000 in Gujarat, 9,000 in Karnataka, 8,000 in Andhra Pradesh, 7,000 in Maharashtra and 6,000 in Telangana.

NO HURRY TO SELL

"Farmers are not in a hurry to sell kapas at the MSP of ₹8,650, as yields are low and they have less kapas to sell," said Atul S Ganatra, CMD of Radhalakshmi Group. The price of Gujarat S6 cotton rose by ₹4,000 per candy to ₹68,000 on Monday from ₹64,000 on September 30, amid fears that the crop would be significantly lower than last year's. "Demand for cotton from mills is good at these levels," he said.

"Indian cotton prices strengthened significantly during the week, supported by limited immediate availability and expectations of higher mill demand. Despite increasing new-season arrivals, October supplies may remain insufficient to meet domestic consumption requirements. Low inventories at many spinning mills and substantial import requirements are expected to support cotton demand," said Anand Popat of CotYarn Trade Link in his weekly newsletter.

"Considering the supply-demand situation, the Indian cotton market appears fundamentally supportive, although increasing arrivals and international price movements may cause short-term fluctuations. The outlook for the Indian cotton market remains firm to cautiously bullish," Popat said.

INCREASE IN DEMAND

Ramanuj Das Boob, a sourcing agent in Raichur, said there was good demand for local cotton as arrivals were low. "Overall, it looks like demand has improved, and there is good buying interest," he said.

Cotton prices have risen by ₹3,000 per candy over the past 10 days. In Raichur, prices rose to ₹9,700 per quintal on Monday from ₹9,500. In Telangana, prices have also increased to around ₹9,200 per quintal.

"Due to low yields and a smaller crop, farmers are holding back their cotton. They are not bringing it to the market because yields have been poor this year. Instead, they are holding on to their produce, anticipating higher prices, and are not rushing to sell," Das Boob said.

Cardamom gains aroma on strong demand, export enquiries

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi



A PREMIUM PEAK. The average price realisation at the auctions has touched a record high of ₹3,200 per kg

Surging cardamom prices have brought cheer to stakeholders in the sector, supported by strong upcountry demand and rising export enquiries.

The average price realisation at the auctions has touched a record high of ₹3,200 per kg, with daily arrivals on the auction platform reaching around 100 tonnes, supported by a good harvest.

PC Punnoose, General Manager of KCPMC, the auctioneers, said farmers are now witnessing a good harvest despite lower production at the start of the season. The initial setback was attributed to a rainfall shortage, particularly in the Idukki region, which recorded a rainfall deficiency of more than 40 per cent in June and July.

LACK OF RAINS

The lack of adequate rainfall affected flowering and fruit setting in cardamom plants, resulting in poor vegetative growth. However, subsequent rains revived the plants, leading to good yields across plantations. Improved production is expected to continue until December.

At the same time, farmers are concerned about a possible decline in production next year amid fears that the ongoing El Nino event could lead to a prolonged summer.

Punnoose said the upcountry market remains active with the festive season approaching. However, buyers are adopting a cautious approach, largely following a "feed-to-mouth" strategy amid higher prices and avoiding advance purchases.

EXPORT ENQUIRIES UP

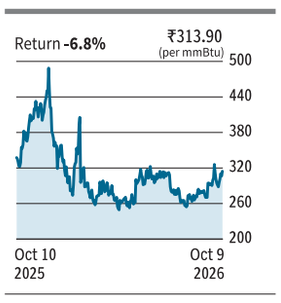
Although export enquiries have increased, no significant orders have been confirmed so far. The West Asia crisis has affected overseas buying, with shipping delays and higher freight costs weighing on trade.

Indian cardamom continues to attract strong demand in Gulf countries, particularly amid crop failures in Guatemala. Punnoose said stronger exports could strengthen market fundamentals, sustain price momentum and benefit the industry as a whole.

SB Prabhakar, a cardamom planter in Idukki, said harvesting is in full swing, and October rains so far have been good. The lack of monsoon rains led to flower and capsule drop and poor fruit setting, with losses estimated at around 30 per cent. Much will depend on the North-East Monsoon. With a strong El Nino expected, there is a need to watch the rains till mid-December, he said.

Stay long, raise stop-loss in natural gas to ₹298

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



Natural gas futures (₹304/mmBtu) saw a rally recently where the October contract hit a high of ₹318.8 last week. But since then, the price has been dropping.

Although the contract has seen higher volatility, the price has largely remained within the range of ₹302-315 in the recent sessions.

The bias will be bullish until the support at ₹302 holds.

COMMODITY CALL.

From the current level, we expect the contract to rise and retest the resistance at ₹315. If this level is breached, natural gas futures can rally to ₹330.

On the other hand, if the price slips below the support at ₹302, the contract can fall to ₹295. A breakdown below ₹295 can drag the price lower to ₹286. Overall, as it stands, the likelihood of natural gas (Oct) futures moving up to ₹315 is high.

TRADE STRATEGY

Last week, we suggested buying natural gas (Oct) futures at ₹293 with initial stop-loss at ₹278 for a target of ₹325. Given that the contract is now staying in a range, we suggest some revisions.

Raise the stop-loss to ₹298.

Since ₹315 is now acting as a hurdle, traders can revise the target lower from the earlier ₹325 to ₹315.

As N-E monsoon nears, heavy rains set to lash TN, Kerala, Karnataka, coastal AP

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram



Thunderstorms bloom along the periphery of a circulation that would set up the low-pressure area

Conditions are turning favourable for the South-West monsoon to retreat from remaining parts of the country and the North-East monsoon to set in over the South Peninsula in the next 2-3 days. Rainfall is expected to gather pace towards the weekend and around October 15, setting the stage for the seasonal transition.

With the onset of the North-East monsoon, the South Peninsula is likely to see a wet spell over the next 5-6 days, India Meteorological Department (IMD) said. Isolated heavy rainfall is expected over Kerala and Mahe, Coastal and South Interior Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal, and Coastal Andhra Pradesh.

The performance of the North-East monsoon will be closely watched against the backdrop of a super El Nino. Historical studies suggest that North-East monsoon rainfall during El Nino years after 1976 was, on average, considerably higher than during the 1950–1976 period.

Scientists have pointed to changes in atmospheric circulation during El Nino that can strengthen easterly flows, transport more moisture towards the subcontinent. For now, the retreating South-West monsoon, the emerging Bay of Bengal low-pressure area, and the prospect of intensifying rainfall across the South Peninsula make the next few days a critical watch period.

HEAVY RAIN FORECAST

The IMD sees isolated heavy rainfall for Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal, Keralam, Mahe and South Interior Karnataka for four days from Thursday. Coastal Karnataka is likely to receive heavy rain on Saturday and Sunday, while North Interior Karnataka faces rain for three days from Friday. Coastal Andhra Pradesh and Yanam are in for four days of heavy rain from Wednesday, with Rayalaseema likely to see similar conditions.

Two cyclonic circulations are shaping the evolving weather: one over the Gulf of Mannar and adjoining south Tamil Nadu, and another over the south Andaman Sea. The latter is expected to trigger a low-pressure area over the south-east Bay on Tuesday.

September clocks second-highest global temperature as El Nino gains strength

Srikrishnan PC
Chennai



September 2026 was the second hottest month on record globally, with temperatures 1.63°C above pre-industrial levels.

Strengthening El Nino conditions pushed sea surface temperatures (SST) to record levels.

The latest data from Copernicus Climate Change Services, implemented by the European Centre for Medium Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF), show intensifying climate extremes, with global temperatures forecast to remain above the 1.5°C threshold into 2027.

Carlo Buontempo, Director of the Copernicus Climate Change Service, said, "September was the second warmest on record globally, with exceptionally high temperatures experienced across parts of Europe after an extreme summer. We are in a new run of months above 1.5°C, and with a strong El Nino still intensifying, it is likely to last into 2027. Crossing the Paris Agreement's long-term limit is only a matter of time. How far we overshoot and for how long is still up to us."

The global-average surface air temperature for September 2026 was 16.27°C, which was 0.82°C above the 1991–2020 average and makes it the second-warmest September globally in the ERA5 dataset, 0.11°C cooler than September 2023.

It was 1.63°C above the estimated pre-industrial average of 1850–1900, marking the first time since November 2025 that two consecutive months have been above 1.5°C.

BOILING OCEANS

The average SST for the extra-polar oceans (60°S–60°N) during September 2026 was the warmest on record for the month at 21.05°C, exceeding the previous September record of 20.92°C set in 2023.

Exceptionally high SSTs persisted over much of the tropical Pacific, where El Nino conditions are strengthening and are expected to intensify further in the coming months.

The monthly SST in the Nino 3.4 region (the ocean area used to monitor El Nino conditions) for September was 29.70°C, the highest on record and above the peak values of the previous very strong El Nino events of 1982/1983, 1997/1998 and 2015/2016, demonstrating the exceptional strength of the current El Nino.

FPOs' prospects linked to expertise of third parties: Study

Our Bureau
New Delhi

In their current form, most farmer producer organisations (FPOs) are likely to be constrained by their capabilities, processes and resources in connecting effectively with markets, says a report on the FPO sector released on Monday.

It is suggested that third-party organisations should step in to bridge the gap and empower FPOs.

The National Association of Farmer Producer Organisations (NAFPO) released the study, in which experts examine specific aspects of the FPO sector.

SCALING CHALLENGES

Although FPOs were being promoted before the launch of the "Formation and Promotion of 10,000 FPOs Scheme" helped achieve the target by February 2025.

The study concurred with critics that many FPOs exist only on paper, lack the capacity to conduct business or struggle to provide even basic services to member farmers.

The NAFPO study concurred with critics that many FPOs exist only on paper, lack the capacity to conduct business

But it says, "That is exactly the contribution of the scheme: to understand issues arising in a farmer collectivisation movement at scale."

In a chapter on market linkages authored by Aashish Argade and Aneesha Bali, three case studies illustrate the responsibility for marketing currently rests with agencies and actors outside FPOs. They possess the marketing knowledge and capabilities needed to understand buyer requirements and supply goods that meet those requirements.

Typically, FPOs lack this knowledge for various reasons, a gap that is bridged by the expertise of external agents, the report said.

RETAIL REACH

"The three case studies described above adopt different approaches to connecting FPOs to markets. Arya.ag and Bayer's Farmrise One follow a Business-to-Business (B2B) approach, enabling FPOs to engage with structured markets or institutional buyers in the organised sector. KisaanSay, a start-up, specialises in Business-to-Consumer (B2C) connections helps FPOs with branding activities," the report said.

According to co-founder Nitin Puri, consumer food needs are as diverse as geographical, climatic and demographic conditions.

Arya.ag helps guide FPOs on when and whom to sell to. Production, aggregation and market access are treated as parts of an integrated operating model.

Aggregation is strengthened through execution led by Community Value Chain Resource Persons (CVRPs) and digital tools, while warehousing, working capital and structured buyer linkages support market participation.

Mathura Mant Mustard Producer Company in Uttar Pradesh is among the FPOs supported by Arya.ag, with its revenue rising from ₹50 lakh to ₹1.2 crore.

Bayer deploys dedicated personnel at FPOs to train member farmers in crop cultivation and post-harvest practices. Farmrise One supports FPOs in establishing forward linkages by identifying reliable corporate buyers. It also assists with price negotiations, payment coordination and logistics.

'Dip in rice, maize & cereal area warrants monitoring'

AJ Vinayak
Mangaluru



CROP CRUNCH. The total kharif sowing was 1.1% lower y-o-y as of October 5, while foodgrain acreage was down 1.6%

Weaker sowing in rice, maize and cereals warrants monitoring, according to a report titled 'Economic impact of monsoon deficit in India: Production, supply chain and price risks'.

Published by Dun & Bradstreet, the report said El Nino-related monsoon risks and rainfall deficits could impact agricultural production, food supply chains, business costs, and inflation in India.

The total kharif sowing was 1.1 per cent lower year-on-year as of October 5, while foodgrain acreage was down 1.6 per cent. Although modest, these declines matter because they include crops with a large weight in India's foodgrain basket, it said. "Current sowing trends are therefore an early warning, not a measure of eventual output; production losses will depend on whether rainfall deficits, moisture stress and higher temperatures persist through critical crop stages," it said.

RICE 3.5% LOWER

Terming rice as India's dominant foodgrain, the report said it constitutes a major component of the public distribution system.

Rice warrants particular attention, as its acreage was 3.5 per cent lower year-on-year as of October 5.

The crop remains dependent on sustained moisture availability through most of its growth cycle. Yield performance will largely determine production outcomes, as it remains sensitive to moisture stress during key growth stages.

Favourable crop conditions in other regions, together with substantial public rice stocks, can absorb moderate losses before they materially affect food availability, procurement operations or downstream food businesses. "The key question is therefore not whether rice output weakens, but whether any decline is large enough to overcome existing supply buffers and influence market conditions," the report said.

MAIZE DOWN 2.9%

However, maize has wider economic exposure because it feeds poultry, livestock and aquaculture. It is also used in starch, processed foods, alcohol and ethanol. Maize acreage was 2.9 per cent lower year-on-year (October 5), while yields remain vulnerable during flowering and grain filling, when yield losses can occur even after planting has been completed.

"Unlike rice, where public stocks can absorb part of a production shortfall, maize shortages tend to affect commercial supply chains more directly. If lower yields reduce market arrivals, feed costs could rise for poultry, dairy and livestock producers, while input costs increase for starch manufacturers, food processors and ethanol producers," it said.

VISUALLY.

Compiled by **Sourashis Banerjee** | Graphic **KS Gunasekar**

Nobel: Gaining colour



The 2026 Nobel prize announcements concluded October 12, prompting us to analyse the contributions and representation of laureates till date. This year's winners highlight advances across six fields, from astrophysics to economic stabilisation. However, even now only 72 laureates can be classified as persons-of-colour, representing less than 9 per cent of all winners since 1901. The trend is improving recently rising to 16.7 per cent of winners in 2021-26. Japan leads in 'coloured' nationality-based counts, with India coming second. However, expanding the definition to people either ethnically Indian or born in India or an Indian citizen, Indian laureates jump to 14, spanning all six fields.

Best of 2026

PHYSICS



Francis Halzen
University of Wisconsin, US

Contribution: Discovery of high-energy neutrinos of astrophysical origin

CHEMISTRY



Henri B. Kagan
Université Paris-Sud, France



Kenso Soai
Tokyo University of Science, Japan

Contribution: Discovery of non-linear effects and autocatalysis in asymmetric organic synthesis

MEDICINE



Karl Deisseroth
Stanford University, US



Peter Hegemann
Humboldt University of Berlin, Germany



Georg Nagel
University of Würzburg, Germany

Contribution: Discoveries concerning light-gated ion channels and optogenetics

LITERATURE



Anne Carson
Canada

Contribution: Oeuvre, in playful dialogue with the classical tradition, has created new forms for contemporary literature

PEACE



Navanethem 'Navi' Pillay
South Africa

Contribution: Efforts to promote peace and international law

ECONOMICS



Robert E. Hall
Stanford University, US

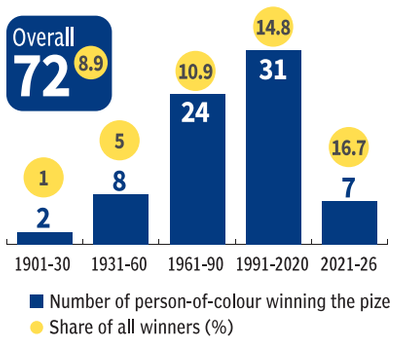


Michael Woodford
Columbia University, US

Contribution: Microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation

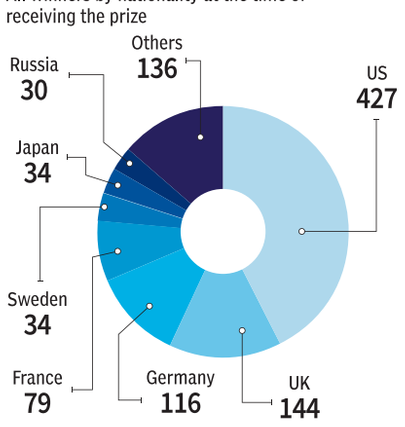
Although more person-of-colour received the prize recently, overall share remains below 9 per cent

Share of person-of-colour in Nobel laureates



US alone makes up 43 per cent of all individual recipients

All winners by nationality at the time of receiving the prize



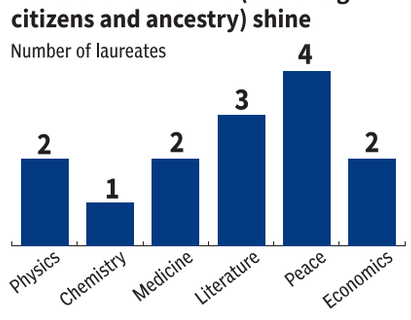
Japan leads the list of 'coloured' recipients

'Coloured' winners by nationality



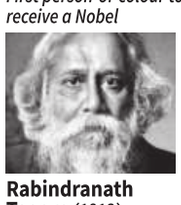
Fields where Indians (including citizens and ancestry) shine

Number of laureates



Other trivia

First person-of-colour to receive a Nobel



Rabindranath Tagore (1913)
Literature

Latest person-of-colour to receive a Nobel



Navi Pillay (2026)
Peace

Source: nobelprize.org

SC seeks explanation for limiting 30% margin cap to cancer drugs

CRUCIAL QUERY. Why benefit of such price regulation not extended to other essential medicines, asks top court

Aaratrika Bhaumik
New Delhi

Even as the Centre informed the Supreme Court on Monday that it had decided to cap trade margins at 30 per cent for non-scheduled cancer drugs, the court questioned why the benefit of such price regulation should be confined to cancer drugs and not extended to other essential medicines and medical products.

The development comes after a Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta expressed concern over stark disparities between the price to retailer (PTR) and the maximum retail price (MRP) of certain medicines, particularly cancer drugs, with mark-ups in some instances soaring to 1,000 per cent.

The Bench had flagged that such exorbitant mark-ups constituted "broad daylight dacoity" and placed an enormous financial burden on patients.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, informed the Bench that the proposed 30 per cent trade-margin cap would cover both patented and non-patented cancer medicines, with an expert committee headed by the Director General of Health Services tasked with identifying the drugs to be brought within its ambit.

The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority will examine the committee's recommendations before issuing a price notification to implement the cap.



RED FLAG. The development comes after Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta expressed concern over stark disparities between price to retailer and the MRP of certain medicines REUTERS

16% RETAILER MARGIN

The Bench, however, said that while the intervention was commendable, it was inadequate, and questioned why other medicines and medical devices could not also be brought within the 16 per cent retailer margin prescribed under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order (DPCO), 2013.

"This is just the tip of the iceberg. This has come around only because of the unduly hard observations we made during earlier hearings. What about other drugs?" the Bench questioned.

The top court was hearing petitions filed by advocate Kishan Chand Jain and paediatric surgeon Sanjay Kulshrestha seeking stricter enforcement of price controls under the DPCO to curb disproportionate margins across the pharmaceutical supply chain.

Justice Mehta drew attention to steep mark-ups on medical devices and consumables, pointing out that an India-made cardiac stent costing around ₹5,000 was being sold by hospitals for more than ₹25,000. He also cited the example of a saline drip line carrying an MRP of ₹11 being sold for ₹270.

"We understand that there are transportation costs, raw material costs, R&D costs and other ancillary costs, but all these are included in the MRP. What is the logic behind allowing them to sell at 400 times the actual cost? How can you allow this? What is the benefit for the patients?" the Bench observed.

'BALANCE IN PRICING'

Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, also appearing for the Centre, cautioned against a uniform cap across medicines, arguing that low-value products often required higher margins to remain commercially viable for retailers. Excessive regulation, she said, could discourage retailers from stocking such medicines and affect their availability, particularly in rural areas.

Bhati also stressed the need to preserve some room for market forces rather than subject the entire pharmaceutical sector to price controls.

"Higher margins in such cases are important for ensuring the availability of such medicines to consumers... Our concern is that there has to be a balance in pricing. There has to be some level of market play available for drugs. We do not want to control the entire ecosystem of drugs. The policy was framed with the outlook that there should be intervention only when necessary," she submitted.

The Bench, however, was not persuaded, observing that ensuring the availability of price-controlled medicines was the government's responsibility.

"If the DPCO approved medicines do not reach customers, then it is the duty of the government to ensure they reach the patient. The actual dispute is over which medicines should be on the DPCO-controlled list and which should not," Justice Mehta observed.

Accordingly, the Bench gave the Centre until October 27 to work out the modalities for capping medicine prices, when the matter will be heard next.

Two Americans win Nobel prize for economics

Press Trust of India
Stockholm

American economists Robert E Hall and Michael Woodford won the Nobel memorial prize in economics on Monday for their work on models that have helped governments and central banks manage economic shocks, such as energy crises and inflation.

The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences announced the winners in Stockholm, saying the two were being honoured for work that has helped policymakers deal with economic fluctuations.

"The laureates' research has made it possible to manage major macroeconomic crises far more effectively than before," the Nobel committee wrote. "It has been hugely beneficial during the pandemic and the energy crises of recent years."

Hall is affiliated with Stanford University in California, and Woodford with Columbia University in New York. Woodford spoke to the committee, saying: "It's a tremendous honour, it's a surprise."

The Nobel committee said the laureates' work has created the theoretical foundation for models now used by central banks and governments around the world.

"With them, we are better equipped to deal with shocks in the economy, such as energy crises or sudden changes in how much households consume," John Hassler, chair of the Committee for the Prize in Economic Sciences, said.

RESEARCH AREA

The two overturned earlier economic assumptions.

Hall studied the way that consumers' decisions about whether and how much to spend depend on what they expect their future income to be. "If they are optimistic, they will consume more," the committee wrote. But consumer expectations can change unexpectedly as new information about the economy comes in. And some households are so poor they can't borrow or tap savings in response to economic changes.

Whereas, Woodford's research established that businesses make decisions about prices based on where they think interest rates will go in the future. "If the business believes that its competitors' prices and its own costs will increase, it is best to set a higher price than it would with the opposite expectation," the Nobel committee wrote. "Businesses' decisions are thus also governed by their expectations."

Therefore, central banks such as the US Federal Reserve, which set short-term interest rates, should provide "clear and credible communication about how they reason and what they plan to do." During the news conference, Woodford said his work has stressed "the understanding of the people who are in the markets and making decisions about spending."

TATA
TATA POWER
(Corporate Contracts Department)
Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173188) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Tata Power Company Limited hereby invites Expression of Interest from eligible parties for the following packages:
PRE-FABRICATED CONSTRUCTION WORKS FOR LABOUR COLONY AT SHIRAWTA PUMPED STORAGE PROJECT (Package Ref. No.: CC27SR045)
For package: Eligible parties willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee on or before **25th October 2026.**
For details of pre-qualification requirements, purchasing of tender document, bid security, tender documents etc., please visit Tender section of our website **(URL: https://www.tatapower.com/tender/tenders-listing).**

THE MYSORE PAPER MILLS LTD.
(A Govt. of Karnataka Company)
Finance Division
Papertown, Bhadravati-577 302
No.MPML/2026-27/SE0054 Dated:12.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDERS FOR INSURANCE COVERAGE OF MPM ASSETS

E-Tenders are invited from **interested Insurance Agencies for insuring Assets of the Company for the year 2026-27.** EMD: **Rs. 5000/-.** The due date for uploading the tenders is **31.10.2026 before 5.00 p.m.** The estimated cost put to tender for the year 2026-27: **Rs. 20.00 lakhs.**
Tenderers are required to submit tenders only through e-procurement portal of Government of Karnataka **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.** Cost of document: **As per e-portal norms.** Blank tender documents can be downloaded from e-procurement portal **from 12.10.2026.** Tenderers who have not registered with e-procurement portal may get registered immediately and participate in the tender. Tender document can also be seen in our website: **mpm.karnataka.gov.in**
Sd/- Chief Finance Officer

TATA
TATA POWER
The Tata Power Company Limited
(Corporate Contracts Department)
The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 2nd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road, Andheri East, Mumbai-400059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173941)

Notice for Inviting bids

Tender ref no: Tender / Trombay/ Coal/ 04/ 26-27
The Tata Power Company Limited, a company organized and existing under the laws of India, whose registered office at Bombay House, 24, Homi Mody Street, Mumbai 400001, India intents to source low calorific value with low Sulphur and low ash Imported Thermal coal for its 750 MW coal based Thermal Power Plant at Trombay, Mumbai, Maharashtra.
Bids are invited from reputed Coal suppliers for supply of **12.85 lacs Metric Ton (+/-10%) Indonesia origin coal, for the delivery period within January 2027 to June 2027.** The interested bidders are requested to visit the website **https://www.tatapower.com/tender/tenders-listing** for further details. Eligible Bidders willing to participate may submit their expression of interest latest by **17:00 Hrs. (IST) 17th October 2026.** Future corrigendum's (if any), to the above tenders will be published on Tender section on our website- **https://www.tatapower.com/tender/tenders-listing** only.

ITI LIMITED
CIN No.: L32202KA1950GOI000640
Registered & Corporate Office: ITI Bhavan, Doorvaninagar, Bengaluru - 560016
Website: www.itiltd.in; E-mail: cosecy_crp@itiltd.co.in
Tel: +91 (80) 2561 7486; Fax: +91 (80) 2561 7525

NOTICE OF THE 76TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, BOOK CLOSURE AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

Annual General Meeting:
NOTICE is hereby given that the **76th Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of Members of ITI Limited will be held on Wednesday, 4th November 2026 at 12:30 p.m. through Video Conference ("VC") or Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM")** to transact business as set out in the notice of AGM.

Notice of AGM and Annual Report:
In compliance with MCA and SEBI Circulars and applicable rules made thereunder, the notice setting out the business to be transacted thereat along with the Annual Report for the year 2025-26 will be sent through electronic form to those members whose email id's have been registered with the Company / Depository Participant(s).
The Notice convening the 76th AGM containing the procedure for e-voting, to attend the AGM through VC/OAVM facility and registration of E-mail ID by shareholders along with full version of Annual Report 2025-26 will be uploaded on the website of the Company at www.itiltd.in under 'Investors' section and the website of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) viz., https://www.evoting.nsdl.com and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and the National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com respectively.

Remote e-voting and e-voting during AGM:
The Company has provided facility to the members to cast their votes electronically through remote e-voting as well as e-voting during AGM, to those members who have not cast their vote on remote e-voting, through the e-voting portal of NSDL.
Members are requested to note the following:
i. The details of registration of email id for members in physical and dematerialized mode along with the manner of registration of KYC details are provided in the Notice of AGM.
ii. Cut-off date to determine eligibility to vote through remote e-voting or e-voting during AGM is 28th October 2026.
iii. Persons whose names appear on the Register of Members / Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories as on the Cut-off Date for voting i.e., 28th October 2026 only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting / e-voting during the AGM.
iv. Any person who acquires shares of the Company and becomes a Member after dispatch of Notice but before the cut-off date for voting i.e. 28th October 2026 may obtain the Login ID and password by sending a request to evoting@nsdl.com or contact our Registrar & Share Transfer Agent at the address mentioned in the notice and can also attend the AGM.
v. The remote e-voting period from 09.00 A.M. on Sunday, 1st November 2026 till 5.00 P.M. on Tuesday, 3rd November 2026.
vi. Members will not be able to cast their vote through remote e-voting beyond the above mentioned date and time and the remote E-voting module shall be disabled for voting by NSDL after 5.00 P.M on 3rd November 2026. The votes once cast by the members cannot be changed subsequently.
vii. The Members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the meeting may also attend the meeting through VC/OAVM by logging on to the e-voting website of NSDL at https://www.evoting.nsdl.com, but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again.
viii. The facility for e-voting during the AGM shall also be made available at the meeting and the Members attending the meeting who have not cast their vote by remote e-voting shall be eligible to exercise their vote at the meeting.
ix. Shri D Venkateswarlu, Company Secretary in Practice, Bengaluru has been appointed as scrutinizer for conducting the remote e-voting and e-voting at AGM in a fair and transparent manner.
x. The results of voting of the AGM will be declared along with the Scrutinizer's report, which shall be placed on Company's Website at www.itiltd.in and website of NSDL at https://www.evoting.nsdl.com. The same shall also be simultaneously communicated to the National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) and Bombay Stock Exchange Limited (BSE), where the shares of the Company are listed, within Two (02) working days after the conclusion of AGM.

Notice of Book Closure:
In compliance with Companies Act and applicable rules made thereunder, Notice is hereby given that the Register of Members and Share Transfer Book of the Company shall remain closed from 29th October 2026 to 04th November 2026 (both days inclusive) for the purpose of AGM.

Contact details:
Any queries/ grievances connected with the E-voting can be addressed to Mr. Harish K, Assistant General Manager, Integrated Registry Management Service Private Limited, No. 30 Ramana Residency, 04th Cross, Sampige Road, Malleswaram, Bengaluru – 560 003, phone: 080-23460818, email: irg@integratedindia.in or Mr Falguni Chakraborty, Senior Manager, NSDL, Email-id: evoting@nsdl.com

By the order of the Board
For ITI Limited

Place: Bengaluru
Date: 09th October 2026
Y.Sathyan
Company Secretary

Air India Express betting on compact aircraft to boost tier 3 connectivity

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Air India Express, promoted by the Tata Group, sees an opportunity to expand connectivity to tier 3 cities as it grows, with smaller aircraft needed to serve these markets, the airline's Chairman Nipun Aggarwal said.

Speaking at GE Aerospace's "India Taking Flight: Aviation, Innovation, and the Road to Viksit Bharat 2047" event's panel discussion held here, Aggarwal, who is also Chief Commercial Officer of full service carrier Air India, said the network is currently geared towards its major hubs at Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru.

However, expansion over time could create opportunities to serve smaller cities, he said during the discussion moderated by Vikram Rai, Chief Executive Officer, South Asia, GE Aerospace.



"But as we grow and as we expand in the future, we believe there is an opportunity in tier 3 cities as well," he said. According to Aggarwal, tapping this opportunity would require smaller aircraft. His remarks indicated a longer-term possibility, without specifying an aircraft type, acquisition programme or timeline. Notably, the opportunity, he said, comes against the backdrop of low utilisation at several airports outside the country's major cities, despite the expansion of aviation infrastructure.

Aggarwal estimated that, of around 160 airports in the country, only about 40 were operating at capacity, while the remaining 120 were not reaching even 30-40 per cent utilisation. Accordingly, he said the next step should be to ensure the airports already built are better utilised through stronger regional connectivity, particularly to tier 2 and tier 3 cities.

TAX BURDEN

Besides, Aggarwal pointed to the potential for aviation to attract passengers from railways, where demand for tickets remains high. He argued that treating aviation as a luxury and imposing a heavy tax burden hampers the sector's ability to expand. Changes that make flying more accessible, he said, could enable growth beyond the steady increases reflected in existing projections. The discussion also highlighted the importance of smaller cities in the domestic aviation market.

IndiGo's Chief Strategy Officer Aloke Singh said routes connecting metros with tier 2 and tier 3 cities accounted for almost two-thirds of the domestic market and were growing faster than metro-to-metro routes.

ADDITIONAL AIRCRAFT

However, airline executives cautioned that growth would require more than additional aircraft and airport infrastructure. Reliable support from aircraft and engine manufacturers, along with greater domestic repair capabilities, would be necessary to sustain expanding operations.

Meanwhile, Akasa Air's Chief of Governance and Strategic Acquisitions Priya Mehra said fleet expansion must be supported by reliability and efficiency. She emphasised that dependable partnerships with original equipment manufacturers were essential for airlines to deliver consistent service as they scale up.

CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - OCTOBER 13 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Ladakh records 4.6 lakh tourist arrivals till Sept



Srinagar: Ladakh recorded 4.60 lakh tourist arrivals between January and September 2026, surpassing the number of visitors for the whole of 2025 by 37.16 per cent, Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena said in a post on X on Monday. OUR BUREAU

Dharavi rehabilitation project takes shape

Mumbai: After several false starts, rehabilitation of slum dwellers of Dharavi in central Mumbai is finally taking shape. On Monday the Adani group performed the ***bhoomi pujan*** (ground breaking ceremony) for over 10,000 homes on a 22 acre railway plot at Matunga. These will be constructed in the first phase and will be delivered by August 2030..OUR BUREAU

Rahul leads march to SC; no more protests at Jantar Mantar, says govt

TOUGH STAND. Congress leader alleges 'larger conspiracy' behind SRI, demands CEC resigns, turns 'approver'

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Delhi witnessed another day of protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar on Monday, with Rahul Gandhi leading the INDIA bloc march towards the Supreme Court and the Delhi Police withdrawing Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site.

The Opposition is demanding Kumar's resignation over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and a halt to the exercise. Gandhi accused the government of protecting the CEC and questioned the heavy security deployment across the Capital.

The Congress had also sought a meeting with the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant to submit a memorandum on its concerns, but the CJI declined, citing the pendency of related matters before the court and judicial propriety. The Opposition subsequently filed a petition against the ECI over the SIR process. The march began from the Connaught Place–Barakhamba Road junction at around 1.30 pm, with Rahul Gandhi and other Opposition leaders seeking to take their protest to the Supreme Court. Gandhi claimed that around 200 government officers, including officials from the Enforcement Directorate, CBI and Ministry of External Affairs, were sharing information with the Opposition.



Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi with RJD leader Tejashwi Yadav, Karnataka Chief Minister DK Shivakumar at the INDIA bloc's protest march in New Delhi, on Monday ANI

TURN APPROVER

He urged the CEC to resign and "turn approver", alleging that Kumar was not the person behind the larger conspiracy responsible for electoral irregularities. Gandhi also said the agitation was a fight to protect the Constitution and that the Opposition will continue its campaign until the electoral system was reformed.

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said he received the INDIA bloc's letter seeking a meeting and responded the same night and wrote a letter to Rahul Gandhi and Mallikarjun Kharge, explaining his reasons and expressing his inability to meet the opposition delegation.

SITE DENOTIFIED

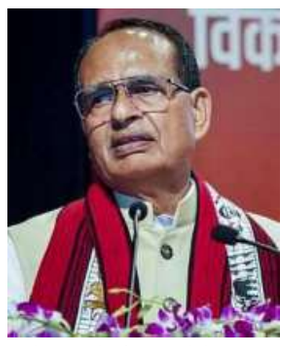
In another significant development, the Delhi Police on Monday denotified Jantar Mantar as a designated protest venue and named three alternative sites: the Ramlila Ground in central Delhi, Burari Ground in north Delhi and CBD Ground in east Delhi.

A standing order issued by Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar on October 11 said the decision followed recommendations of a committee constituted by the Union Home Ministry to examine alternative venues for protests. Revised standard operating procedures for organising demonstrations at the three sites are to be issued separately. The decision came after days of protests, heavy police deployment and mass detentions in central Delhi. The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), which had been mobilising protesters against the CEC, criticised the move, calling it an assault on the right to peaceful assembly. CJP representatives have also sought permission and a date for their next demonstration, giving the police 24 hours to respond.

The developments followed a weekend of intense restrictions across the Capital, including the closure of Metro stations, traffic diversions and the detention of thousands of protesters trying to reach Jantar Mantar.

'Focus on outcomes in agriculture properity scheme'

Our Bureau
New Delhi



Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan PIB

Reviewing the one-year performance of the Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDDKY), Union agriculture minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Monday said that the first year had focused on establishing strong foundations, while the coming year must be dedicated to delivering visible and measurable outcomes on the ground.

The scheme is meant to rejuvenate agriculture in 100 selected low-performing districts and augment farmers' income.

He highlighted the importance of improving agricultural productivity, increasing cropping intensity, strengthening irrigation and water management, facilitating access to agricultural credit, promoting high-value agriculture, improving post-harvest infrastructure and enhancing farmers' incomes.

The government aims to increase agricultural productivity, crop diversification, post-harvest storage, irrigation and creditdisbursement.

The prioritises implementation of 36 existing schemes across 11 departments in these districts. The Centre has also appointed one senior nodal officer for each district.

MONTHLY RANKINGS

However, experts said that due to poor implementation and non-fixing of accountability of nodal officers, there are several districts reporting very low score on the official dash board.

The scheme monitors district performance against 121 indicators with monthly rankings.

The bottom 10 districts according to performance are – Mamit (Mizoram), South Goa (Goa), Sribhumi (Assam), Kandhamal (Odisha), Tamenglong (Manipur), Nuapada (Odisha), Chitradurga (Karnataka), Kozhikode (Kerala), Dima Hasao (Assam) and Mon (Nagaland). As many as 62 districts have less than 50 score.

On the other hand the top 10 performers are – Gaya (Bihar), Nagaur (Rajasthan), Umaria (Madhya Pradesh), Dindori (Madhya Pradesh), Sidhi (Madhya Pradesh), Dantewada (Chhattisgarh), Chitrakoot (Uttar Pradesh), Chamoli(Uttarakhand), Alirajpur (Madhya Pradesh) and Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar (Maharashtra) in August ranking.

FARM INCOMES

The ultimate measure of PMDDKY's success would be the meaningful difference it makes to the lives of farmers, the agriculture ministry said in a statement.

The Minister called upon all stakeholders to strengthen coordination, accelerate implementation and focus on measurable improvements in agricultural outcomes and sustainable farm incomes.

SC: 'Did not approve or disapprove' changes to Form 6

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday clarified that it had neither approved nor disapproved the controversial alterations made to Form 6 in its May 27 judgment, which was entirely about the legality of the pilot Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process in Bihar. The court said the May 27 ruling pre-dated the changes made to Form 6.

The changes and modified declarations, which required applicants to provide ancestry details or linkage to previous SIR rolls on the ECINet portal, were introduced subsequently in July.

"When the Bihar SIR issue was heard and decided, the new Form 6 was not there. The new Form 6 was neither approved nor disapproved by us. But we will examine it now," Justice Joymalya Bagchi, who is part of the Bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant, observed.

SIR PROCESS

The remarks came in response to a petition filed by



Priya Mishra against the Union government challenging the alterations made to Form 6 to register new voters during the SIR exercises undertaken across multiple States. The May 27 judgment on the Bihar SIR had observed that Form 6 was a guide to the SIR verification process. The apex court said that the Form 6 used in Bihar SIR "set out a framework of documentation".

"It is neither practicable nor desirable for the verification process to be left entirely unguided or subjective. It is true that Form 6, as prescribed under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, sets out a framework of documentation; however, the same is tailored to the process of revision contemplated under Section 21(2) of the Representation of the People Act," the May 27 judgment authored by Chief Justice Kant had observed.

On October 5, during the hearing of petitions challenging the SIR process, the CJI had sharply reacted to submissions about the July alterations in the Form 6. "We are making it clear, any modifications to Form 6 have not been made by us," the Chief Justice had said.

Modifications to Form 6,provided in the Schedule of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, should be done through the proper lawmaking process, and not by unilateral administrative actions. The alterations included a supplementary declaration form for voter registration. New applicants have to declare whether they, their parents, or their grandparents were registered in the previous SIR electoral rolls. Further, a response to these mapping and linkage questions was made a prerequisite for submitting the form.

Opposition moves apex court for full disclosure of EC records on SIR

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi moved the Supreme Court on Monday seeking full and complete disclosure of "files, agendas, minutes, notings and objections" recorded by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) which has so far deleted about 13 crore names from the voters list across India.

Gandhi sought a judicial examination of the Election Commission records to verify whether Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar acted arbitrarily and unilaterally during the ongoing SIR.

The Congress leader said the petition highlights serious concerns regarding the integrity of the electoral process itself under the SIR. He argued that the aftermath of the SIR has witnessed the infringement of the constitutional right of eligible citizens to be registered as voters and to exercise their right to vote. Gandhi sought an interim direction from the Supreme Court to suspend the SIR pending consideration and adjudication of the issues raised in the petition in order to protect the rights of eligible electors and preserving the integrity of the electoral process.

The petition, urged the court to direct the ECI to provide ECINET and ERONET access logs and the file recordings on the decision to start the SIR

"The right to vote belongs to every eligible citizen irrespective of political affiliation, and its protection is a constitutional imperative that transcends party politics," the petition, represented by senior advocate AM Singhvi and filed through advocate Prasanna S, said.

The petition reproduced an excerpt of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant's response to Gandhi's and co-petitioner and Congress party president Mallikarjun Kharge's letter seeking a meeting on October 12. The top judge had pointed out that pending petitions on identical issues were coming up for hearing on October 13.

EARLY HEARING

"If so advised, you may submit your petition on Monday (October 12), either physically at the Supreme Court of India, between 10:30 am and 4:30 pm. You have my assurance that any such petition shall be heard at the earliest possible opportunity, in accordance with law," said the CJI's letter.

Gandhi and other Opposition leaders marched to the Supreme Court on October 12 even though their petition was technically filed at 4.37 p.m. They entered the Supreme Court Registry, verified their supporting documents with the Registry officials and left. Their arrival was in the presence of heavy security and under stampede-like conditions with supporters raising slogans.

The petitioners, urged the court to direct the Election Commission to provide ECINET and ERONET access logs and the file recording the June 24, 2025 decision to commence the SIR.

Rajasthan PCB orders Carlsberg to shut Alwar unit

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

Even as Carlsberg India gears for an IPO, the Rajasthan State Pollution Control Board has ordered the closure of Danish brewer's Alwar facility.

A regulatory inspection in July 2026 found particulate matter emissions nearly eight times the prescribed limit of 80mg/Nm³, along with inadequate transmission of emissions-monitoring data to the Central Pollution Control Board, according to a copy of the order accessed by *businessline*.

The facility transmitted emissions-monitoring data to the CPCB's portal at just 35.12 per cent, against the mandatory threshold of 85 per cent.

Carlsberg India was yet to respond to *businessline*'s detailed questionnaire seeking clarification by the time of going to print.

Six cities key to TN becoming $1.5 t economy: Credai-TN, JLL

Our Bureau
Chennai



Tamil Nadu's ambition of becoming a $1.5 trillion economy by 2036 hinges on accelerating growth across six cities — Coimbatore, Madurai, Tiruchirappalli, Hosur, Salem and Thoothukudi — with faster project clearances, quicker industrial land development and advanced infrastructure planning emerging as key priorities, according to a new report by Credai Tamil Nadu and JLL. The report, titled *Tamil Nadu 2036: Building the next decade*, said the current government's target requires coordinated growth across the six cities, not just sequential development behind Chennai.

Success depends on the State expediting statutory clearances, extending the single-window clearance mechanism to project expansions and enabling land pooling, zoning approvals and development permissions before fresh capital investment arrives.

Success depends on the State expediting statutory clearances, extending the single-window clearance mechanism

DEVELOPMENT ZONES

The report also proposes pre-approving transit-oriented development zoning along the planned metro corridors in Coimbatore and Madurai before construction is completed. This would enable housing development to keep pace with employment generation and reduce delays in creating integrated urban centres, it notes.

It also recommends a unified rollout calendar for TIDEL Neo projects to make infrastructure expansion for Global Capability Centres (GCCs) more predictable.

Coimbatore offers an indication of the potential of decentralised growth, with the assessment citing more than 60 operational GCCs, 9.1 million sq ft of Grade-A office space and institutional retail commitments exceeding ₹3,870 crore, it said.

LuLu Group makes Chennai debut with metro hypermarket, daily essentials store

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Retail major LuLu Group entered Chennai on Monday, opening two retail outlets at the Shenoy Nagar and Chennai Central Metro Stations.

LuLu makes its long-awaited Chennai debut with two distinct retail formats — LuLu Hypermarket at Shenoy Nagar Metro Station and LuLu Daily at Chennai Central Metro Station.

Spanning about 1 lakh sq ft, the Shenoy Nagar facility is also India's first and largest hypermarket within a metro station. It comprises a 56,000 sq ft supermarket and a 50,000 sq ft department store housing LuLu Fashion Store and LuLu Connect. Customers can shop for groceries, fresh produce, daily essentials, fashion, footwear and electronics under one roof. The facility also offers parking for more than 1,000 vehicles.



TN Assembly Speaker JCD Prabhakar; Education Minister Rajmohan Arumugam; Food & Civil Supplies Minister P Venkataramanan; and others with Lulu Group Chairman MA Yusuffali at the Lulu Hypermarket in Chennai BIJOY GHOSH

At the Chennai Central Metro Station, LuLu Daily spans 35,000 sq ft and offers fresh market products, groceries and everyday essentials, catering to commuters and residents in the surrounding areas.

Speaking to *businessline* at the inauguration, LuLu Chairman MA Yusuff Ali said "We are very happy to be in Chennai, one of the most cosmopolitan cities with good buying power.

TN EXPANSION

We are particularly excited about setting this up in the metro station and want people from all walks of life to choose LuLu for their monthly purchases," he said. This is only the beginning; we will continue to expand here, he added.

The retail industry titan announced plans to establish a mini mall in Tiruppur. He also said the group is interested in setting up a food processing unit in Tamil Nadu. Sources in the know said a much-awaited LuLu mall will soon enter Chennai and is still on the cards.

How can Karnataka clear Cauvery backlog amid drought conditions, SC asks TN

Aaratrika Bhaumik
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday questioned Tamil Nadu on how Karnataka could be expected to make good the backlog in the release of Cauvery water even when it is grappling with water scarcity and drought conditions.

"A backlog can be covered only when there is excess water. If there is less rainfall and there is scarcity, how do you expect them to fulfil the backlog? They are also reeling from water scarcity," a Division Bench headed by Justice Vikram Nath observed. The Bench reserved its order on Tamil Nadu's application in the decades-old Cauvery water-sharing dispute. Tamil Nadu has contended that there is a shortfall of 11.719 thousand million cubic feet (tmcft) in the flows due to it at Billigundulu, the inter-State border measuring point, up to October 6. Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi, appearing for Tamil Nadu, contended that one State alone should bear the brunt of the water shortage. He pointed out that in a distress year, the available water must be shared proportionately among the States and that, even on such a reduced *pro rata* entitlement, Tamil Nadu was facing a shortfall of 11.719 tmcft.

'11 TMCFT SHORTFALL'

The court was also told that the continuing shortfall was severely affecting Samba cultivation and the livelihoods of farmers in the Cauvery Delta. "11 tmcft is my shortfall. A shortfall is not a shortfall of money that you can make up after one year or six months. I need water today for my crops...They should make up the shortfall," Rohatgi said.

Karnataka, represented by senior advocate Shyam Divan, however, sought to distinguish its position from that of Tamil Nadu. He submitted that while both States were grappling with water scarcity, Tamil Nadu had the advantage of the impending north-east monsoon, which was expected to replenish its reservoirs in the Cauvery basin.

Divan further contended that Karnataka was itself facing an acute drought, with several districts notified as drought-affected. The prevailing conditions, he said, had forced the State to curtail irrigation releases and conserve its limited water reserves to safeguard drinking water requirements.

Karnataka also submitted that it was complying with the direction of the Cauvery Water Management Authority. The Bench said it would pass order on Tamil Nadu's application shortly.

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Make Growth Happen

Festival online sales trail last year by up to 10% as shoppers opt for smaller baskets

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru



Online festival sales in India are estimated to have reached ₹29,800-30,900 crore between October 7 and 10, down 7-10 per cent from the corresponding four-day period last year, as higher smartphone prices and the absence of a GST-led demand boost resulted in a flatter opening to the season, according to Datum Intelligence.

The research firm estimates that mobile phones will account for 30 per cent of festive sales this year, compared with 35 per cent last year. However, the overall festive season is expected to grow, with spending spread across categories and over a longer period rather than concentrated in the opening days. "What happened last year was not going to repeat this year because last year there was a GST 2.0 and everyone was buying, especially retail items, to get that benefit out of it," said Satish Meena, Analyst, Datum Intelligence.

"The sales overall for the month are expected to grow 25-30 per cent, but first week is — don't expect the same as last year because there are so many things missing compared to last year," he said.

PLATFORM-WISE SALE

Platform-level numbers showed strong demand in several categories despite the softer overall opening.

Amazon reported a 100 per cent year-on-year increase in products ordered in the first 12 hours of its Great Indian Festival sale, while Meesho's day-one orders rose 75 per cent.

Myntra recorded four times its usual demand in the first 24 hours of its Big Fashion Festival, and Flipkart reported 6.3 million peak concurrent users in its opening hour. Electronics and appliances continued to draw shoppers, with Amazon reporting strong demand for large appliances, premium wearables and home entertainment systems.

However, Meena said smartphone upgrades were not generating the same momentum as last year. "Frankly, smartphone apart from the price, there's no buzz around the models also. As a customer, you don't see updating your phone again and again," he said.

Datum expects the first week to account for 46% of festive sales this year, compared with 48% in 2025, leaving a larger share of spending for the run-up to Diwali on November 8.

Quick commerce is also expected to account for 16 per cent of festive sales, up from 12 per cent last year, as shoppers purchase more during festival seasons.

Medical-device maker SMT seeks 'optimum' pricing to balance access and quality

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

Homespun medical device maker Sahajanand Medical Technologies Ltd (SMT) has taken its cardio-vascular products into developed markets largely dominated by multinational companies, on the back of its clinical efficacy, among other things, says Bhargav Kotadia, Managing Director and Chief Executive of Sahajanand Medical Technologies Limited.

Back home, though, as medical devices find themselves at the centre of a price discussion, he says, prices need to be pegged at an "optimum point" - accessible, but without affecting the quality of the product.

"There is a price point which gives greater accessibility, and then there is a price point which starts to reduce the quality. So we want to make sure that you are placing the price at the right point.

"There is an optimum point, and you don't want to overdo it because, ultimately you're dealing with people's lives in this product," Kotadia told *businessline*. Cardiac stents were the earliest medical devices to be brought into the Centre's price control net, in 2016.

SMT management were in Mumbai ahead of its Initial Public Offering (IPO) scheduled to open on Thursday, with a price band between ₹327 to ₹344 per equity share. The company is looking to raise ₹475 crore, he said. The IPO closes on October 19, 2026. "We funded large randomised clinical trials that did head-to-head comparison of our product versus the US brands, where we were able to showcase exactly how our product performs across across the world....We were able to prove that our devices are at par in terms of clinical efficacy," says Kotadia.

In a market like Germany, "the land of ultra-precision, the land of quality engineering", he adds, the company has a greater market share than one of its competitors.

IPO DETAILS

The IPO comprises an offer for sale of up to 13,822,116 equity shares of face value of ₹1 each by the company's promoter, Shree Hari Trust; a member of the promoter group, Dhirajkumar Savjibhai Vasoya; and investor shareholders: Samara Capital Markets Holding Limited, Kotak Pre-IPO Opportunities Fund and NHPEA Sparkle Holding BV, he said.

The offer includes a reservation of up to 250,000 equity shares for subscription by eligible employees, the company said.

About four percent of the company's capital is also in ESOPs with employees, Kotadia said, some of them with the company for about 25 years. "So we wanted to create basically a monetization opportunity for them as well," he added.

The Offer is being made through the book-building process, and the company looks to list on NSE and BSE.

Corrugated box makers face a rough ride as raw material, freight rates rise

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

The Indian corrugated box manufacturing industry is facing a crisis with its basic raw material price — kraft paper — increasing by 25-35 per cent over the past few weeks, depending on the grade. Rising costs of imported waste paper and crucial inputs, currency fluctuation and surging freight rates, mainly due to the Iran war, have added to the sector's woes, stakeholders said.

Corrugated boxes are cardboard cartons or boxes used in e-commerce, electronics, electrical, automobile, pharmaceutical and food sectors to deliver goods to customers.

"The current price escalation is particularly concerning because it is not being driven by a corresponding increase in demand for corrugated boxes. Instead, the industry is facing a supply-side shock arising from higher raw material costs, restricted availability of waste paper and rising costs across the paper manufacturing chain," said Vikash Goel, Partner at Jaishree Cartons.

WASTE PAPER COSTS UP

"Kraft paper constitutes 75 per cent of the product cost. We also use old carton cuttings (OCC), which are imported. There is a dollar fluctuation, there is war and ship transportation is a big issue. Due to these reasons, waste paper costs have gone up," said G Raj Kumar, Co-Chairman of Paper Mills Coordination Committee (PMCC) of the Federation of Corrugated Boxes Manufacturers of India.

This has affected paper mills, which have increased the price of kraft paper. However, box manufacturers are unable to pass the price hike to their customers.

"Imported waste paper has become more expensive due to higher international freight costs and longer shipping cycles. Currency fluctuations have added further pressure to the landed cost," said Vijay Shekhar, President of the South Indian Kraft Paper Mills Association.

Imported waste paper prices have increased by $50 a tonne in the past couple of months, said Jay Kedia, Partner, Cellpap Mercantile LLP, one of the leading imported waste paper dealers in India.

Virgin paper prices have soared, forcing manufacturers to seek recycled paper even in the US and Europe. This has pushed up waste paper prices, he said, adding that prices will likely rise in the coming months, albeit slowly.

Currently, DSOCC (double sorted old corrugated container) grade paper is quoted at $250-290 a tonne. Paper mills are facing acute raw material shortages and severe working-capital crunch, forcing them to fulfil older, lower-priced orders using highly expensive new inventory, said Shekhar.



COST PRESSURE. The current price escalation is particularly concerning because it is not being driven by a corresponding increase in demand for corrugated boxes

ALL INPUTS SURGE

Indian waste paper prices have gone up, on average, by 22 per cent since the start of the current fiscal; OCC prices have gone up by around 23 per cent, coal prices by about 55 per cent, chemical prices between 16 per cent and 25 per cent, and finished product prices have gone up by 10 per cent, he said. adding that the situation has turned grim over the past two months.

The cost of power, one of the critical inputs for the paper industry, has increased sharply, as have chemicals. "Prices of starch, a big contributor to the industry, have gone up from ₹32 to ₹41. These are the big contributors to the rise in kraft paper prices," said Manish Bothra, Director of B&B Triplewall Containers Ltd.

Prices of waste paper are ruling above ₹25 a kg in places such as Andhra Pradesh, said Kartik Balasundaram, Member, Tamil Nadu Recovered Paper Dealers Association (TNRPDA), adding the current trend may be a temporary one.

The shortage has been further aggravated by increased procurement from mills in other regions, resulting in greater competition for the limited waste paper available in the domestic market, he said.

SHORTAGE INTENSIFIES

Exports of finished kraft paper from India are complicating the domestic situation. At a time when corrugated box manufacturers are facing higher input costs and uncertainty over paper availability, exports of finished paper are an additional factor in the balance between domestic supply and demand, said Alok Agarwal, Director, B&B Triplewall Containers Ltd.

A combination of higher raw-material costs and constrained availability has translated into a sharp increase in kraft paper prices. A 25–30 per cent increase in the principal raw material of the industry, mainly comprising micro, small and medium entrepreneurs, has a major effect on the economics of every box produced, said G Nagaraj, Chairman of PMCC.

However, the selling price of a corrugated box cannot be increased at the same speed. The process in the case of large customers such as corporate and multinational firms takes several weeks or months.

For companies operating on relatively thin margins, recovering additional costs takes time, and this erodes their profitability and puts pressure on their working capital.

GST WOES

An inverted goods and services tax (GST) structure, with kraft paper attracting 18 per cent levy and finished corrugated boxes 5 per cent, is compounding the problems for the industry as it takes time to get the input tax credit refund.

A prolonged pressure on the packaging industry can eventually have an impact beyond box manufacturers, said Goel, adding that the sector faces an uncertain future as there are clear indications that the shortage of waste paper will ease soon, said Agarwal. If domestic availability remains tight and competition for raw material continues, kraft paper prices could remain under pressure, said Balasundaram.

Shekhar sought duty suspension on waste paper imports to help the industry stabilise. Nagaraj sought a suspension of import duty on finished paper as well, as a measure to address the pressures facing the domestic industry.

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***Based on revenue from operations for 6 months ending June 30, 2026 I ^In terms of revenue from operations in Fiscal 2025 I #As on June 30, 2026*

BONFIGLIOLI TRANSMISSIONS LIMITED is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with SEBI, RoC, Tamil Nadu at Chennai and the Stock Exchanges on October 9, 2026. The RHP shall be available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, and is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of our Company at www.bonfiglioli.in and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., Axis Capital Limited, BNP Paribas, ICICI Securities Limited and Jefferies India Private Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com and www.jefferies.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see "Risk Factors" beginning on page 20 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges, and should instead rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision.
This announcement does not constitute an invitation or offer of securities for sale in any jurisdiction. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act or any state securities laws of the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable U.S. state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (a) in the United States only to persons reasonably believed to be "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in and in reliance on Rule 144A) and referred to in the Red Herring Prospectus as "U.S. QIBs"; for the avoidance of doubt, the term U.S. QIBs does not refer to a category of institutional investor defined under applicable Indian regulations and referred to in the Red Herring Prospectus as "QIBs" in transactions exempt from or not subject to the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and in reliance on Rule 144A and (b) in "offshore transactions" as defined in, and in reliance on, Regulation S and in compliance with the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of the Equity Shares in the United States.

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
20 Microns [5]	196.12	198.59	198.25	200.90	196.01	72.50	238.10	130.50	11	197.60
360 One WAM	1048.00	1068.70	1040.00	1068.70	1037.90	330.90	1236.20	906.05	-	-
5PAISA	339.55	340.50	339.00	351.60	338.20	33.90	416.65	245.00	36	341.35
63 MoonsT [2]	766.30	824.00	838.30	859.65	811.00	2274.07	957.70	465.55	66	823.60
A										
A2Z Infra	14.00	13.79	14.40	14.40	13.71	285.27	19.21	11.60	-	13.81
Aadhar Hsg	443.65	441.20	443.60	446.95	438.20	111.57	563.00	427.30	-	-
Aarey Drugs	104.08	104.79	102.22	106.00	100.51	146.06	110.00	50.31	-	-
Aarti Drugs	413.30	413.60	415.40	421.20	411.70	69.11	533.60	318.60	22	414.15
Aarti Ind [5]	460.15	473.90	460.45	476.00	460.45	504.14	551.45	338.20	33	473.90
Aarti Pharm	855.50	878.35	865.00	890.75	861.00	433.41	1002.40	585.00	-	-
Aavas	1193.00	1194.40	1190.70	1212.00	1188.90	79.12	1774.95	1050.25	14	1193.45
AB Capital	380.70	380.25	382.90	387.15	377.00	3567.32	430.55	288.00	31	378.85
AB Real Est	1022.30	1015.30	1029.70	1060.80	1011.40	414.82	1914.00	1002.30	-	-
AB Sun Life	1004.05	986.90	1001.00	1022.15	980.55	159.32	1224.90	708.00	-	-
ABB [2]	6780.00	6855.50	6800.50	6980.00	6800.50	203.40	7923.35	4640.50	94	6869.10
Abbott (I)	26000.00	25790.00	26000.00	26100.00	25500.00	2.66	30598.00	25140.50	34	25800.35
ABFRL	43.65	43.53	43.80	44.36	43.40	1659.17	86.19	43.07	-	43.54
ACC	1133.00	1124.90	1140.00	1148.50	1123.00	99.38	1986.90	1122.55	11	1124.95
ACCELYA	1061.60	1012.70	1055.00	1055.00	1010.00	36.02	1523.95	1011.05	14	1013.75
ACEVECTOR	30.58	29.00	30.90	31.69	28.71	23972.12	33.27	23.37	-	-
ACME Solar	418.10	418.75	423.60	426.75	413.50	499.49	476.90	195.90	-	-
Action Cons [2]	1176.90	1201.10	1179.90	1212.00	1172.50	230.66	1267.05	746.10	32	1201.05
Acutaas Chem	3160.60	3144.10	3160.00	3199.80	3130.00	129.65	3740.00	1467.50	-	-
Adani Ent [1]	2634.40	2630.00	2641.00	2664.20	2625.20	1112.87	3245.00	1753.45	107	2631.00
Adani Green	1255.80	1274.00	1273.00	1279.00	1255.40	1529.82	1631.35	767.00	307	1268.65
Adani Ports [2]	1761.00	1754.00	1770.10	1778.00	1746.40	10901.71	1891.80	1293.10	146	1752.10
Adani Pwr [2]	189.00	185.90	189.75	190.99	185.31	13331.87	254.15	128.35	30	185.60
Adani T Gas	563.45	563.20	567.30	573.55	562.00	388.69	859.85	462.80	-	-
Adani Wilm	182.18	183.37	182.21	185.06	180.84	1813.45	282.90	171.19	-	-
Adani.E.Sol	1262.00	1280.00	1274.90	1292.00	1264.80	789.69	1789.00	803.10	-	-
ADF Foods [2]	289.70	288.40	292.60	292.60	287.10	75.30	346.95	153.65	31	287.25
AdityaBirlaL	72.46	72.14	73.00	74.47	71.71	1183.63	142.82	71.10	-	-
AdityaInfote	4185.20	4134.10	4252.00	4279.20	4051.20	648.30	4279.20	1304.00	-	-
AdityaVisi	581.05	586.20	584.95	588.05	581.05	38.88	705.00	436.55	-	-
AdorWelding	1479.60	1540.20	1479.00	1547.00	1476.00	25.61	1766.40	848.00	-	-
Advait Ener	1888.80	1932.90	1907.00	1949.00	1882.90	32.52	2485.00	1351.00	-	-
Advance Agro	113.27	126.52	113.01	131.90	113.01	2903.88	154.00	84.10	-	-
Advent Hotel	120.25	122.29	121.57	123.95	120.00	88.39	345.05	115.83	-	-
Advenzymes [2]	267.15	266.70	268.05	272.00	265.60	153.39	419.80	251.90	36	266.70
Advit Jewels	357.45	375.30	367.00	375.30	366.05	362.96	375.30	161.60	-	-
Aegis Log [1]	1388.90	1450.00	1396.30	1455.90	1387.20	724.45	1528.00	576.00	40	1449.80
Aegis VopakT	284.80	286.40	284.75	289.00	280.00	591.46	320.95	158.00	-	-
Aequs	273.50	265.90	275.00	275.85	262.60	2761.60	294.70	113.30	-	-
Aeroflex Ind	520.50	567.90	530.00	599.00	530.00	12895.31	599.00	158.00	-	-
AeroflexEnt	123.31	136.68	124.90	139.40	124.90	4240.03	159.60	62.20	-	-
Aether Ind	1748.10	1779.30	1769.90	1810.00	1757.60	193.20	1814.10	728.00	-	-
Afcons Infra	242.04	240.42	242.04	246.74	238.18	524.93	465.90	225.35	-	-
Affle [2]	1417.50	1423.10	1417.50	1445.50	1417.50	88.12	1973.30	1251.85	138	1424.30
AGI Greenpac	770.45	765.10	772.00	787.00	761.90	47.20	896.15	465.00	-	-
AGI Infra	254.10	248.55	254.85	256.65	247.25	174.45	434.40	224.70	-	-
Ahluwali [2]	557.60	562.15	557.60	570.70	541.00	41.79	1076.60	542.25	17	565.05
AIA Engg [2]	3737.70	3746.10	3737.00	3801.60	3730.10	14.86	5175.00	3180.05	27	3747.40
Ajanta P [2]	3410.10	3399.40	3405.00	3421.40	3380.90	92.29	3796.95	2380.90	42	3398.15
Ajax Engg	570.40	568.30	570.35	583.30	565.60	24.35	678.00	394.80	-	-
Ajmera [2]	116.92	116.91	114.90	117.83	114.08	426.01	221.23	98.10	20	116.90
Akums Drugs	751.85	751.45	750.00	774.65	749.30	177.02	838.80	409.30	-	-
ALEM PH [2]	800.95	789.05	796.95	806.00	786.20	110.57	998.00	635.30	20	787.65
Alembic Ltd [2]	99.25	99.56	100.14	101.00	98.35	324.82	117.91	70.64	21	99.35
Algoquant Fi	67.25	67.38	67.30	68.20	66.26	1107.69	76.20	47.80	-	-
Alicon [5]	861.70	862.25	875.05	884.95	849.10	19.90	1024.95	580.55	32	866.25
AlivusLife	1326.30	1345.20	1333.70	1348.50	1317.80	44.48	1493.80	819.00	-	-
Alkem labs [2]	5279.00	5205.00	5256.50	5300.50	5201.00	179.60	5933.00	5052.05	28	5225.00
ALKYL AM [2]	1807.60	1824.60	1825.00	1860.00	1805.20	38.32	2115.00	1212.35	41	1824.20
Allcargo Glo [2]	10.53	10.52	10.58	10.80	10.03	4212.78	16.18	7.10	-	10.49
Allcargo Glo	12.24	12.25	13.11	13.11	12.10	1149.27	22.00	12.03	-	-
Allcargo Ter	26.18	26.70	26.70	27.15	26.06	349.35	38.69	18.20	-	-
ALLIED DIGIT [5]	109.97	108.68	109.97	110.44	104.60	478.57	189.30	86.50	-	108.40
AlliedBlend	711.55	705.60	720.15	722.85	693.70	732.71	753.80	382.10	-	-
Alok Ind	9.00	8.78	9.00	9.29	8.65	35285.03	18.45	6.92	-	-
Alpine Texwo	44.30	43.30	44.01	44.97	43.00	86.97	105.00	43.00	-	-
Amagi Media	559.40	567.75	560.00	575.00	559.40	171.14	727.40	310.20	-	-
AMAL.	764.95	917.90	851.00	917.90	823.60	248.23	917.90	636.05	-	-
Amar.Raj.Enr	721.00	732.65	722.10	743.20	722.10	254.48	1023.00	670.00	-	-
Amber	6445.00	6528.00	6479.50	6582.00	6463.00	139.79	8970.00	5404.00	156	6530.10
Ambuja Cem [2]	351.50	348.00	352.00	356.90	341.20	2236.84	588.55	341.30	23	348.85
AmirChand Ja	218.41	220.68	221.50	225.50	216.15	1279.08	225.50	117.02	-	-
Anand RathiW	2038.70	2087.00	2028.00	2087.80	2015.90	932.37	3735.00	1710.60	-	-
AnandRathiS	539.60	550.60	540.00	555.00	536.10	238.49	794.85	416.00	-	-
Anant Raj [2]	570.75	569.55	576.70	586.40	565.95	870.33	700.00	403.00	67	569.65
Anant Raj Gl	117.47	120.35	117.50	121.11	116.94	418.07	186.30	109.10	-	-
Andhra Paper	67.21	71.34	67.95	78.99	67.07	3503.77	80.02	58.00	-	-
Andhra Sug [2]	88.43	90.99	89.20	92.04	88.49	378.23	107.00	63.27	10	90.79
AngelOne	292.00	302.25	294.25	305.90	294.25	6496.97	2867.00	208.63	-	-
Anlon Health	28.11	29.51	29.51	29.51	28.69	10771.81	172.75	12.91	-	-
ANNU PR	47.01	46.60	47.01	49.25	45.83	624.55	75.60	43.22	-	-
AntelopusSel	1101.50	1108.90	1124.30	1150.00	1103.30	201.40	1290.90	357.00	-	-
AnthemBiosci	862.30	883.55	862.30	889.00	862.30	321.65	977.55	579.15	-	-
Antony W Hdg	334.05	331.05	339.15	339.15	327.55	59.09	605.00	327.55	-	-
Anup Engg	1488.20	1497.60	1488.20	1514.00	1480.00	11.99	2479.90	1422.30	-	-
Anupam Ras.	1132.40	1151.60	1142.40	1175.00	1133.20	316.22	1415.00	1047.90	-	-
A-ONE STEELS	407.10	401.70	405.00	421.75	395.00	288.60	470.00	366.45	-	-
Apar Ind	17984.00	18100.00	18150.00	18284.00	17862.00	102.42	19269.20	6800.00	64	18116.70
Apcotex Ind [2]	578.35	602.55	578.35	610.70	578.35	79.58	712.45	310.15	19	602.25
Apex	331.30	336.45	334.90	339.90	331.60	67.02	514.20	221.55	21	336.15
APL Apollo [2]	2114.10	2157.40	2112.00	2170.00	2109.40	286.34	2300.90	1691.05	104	2156.15
APOLLO [1]	388.35	401.40	388.80	408.60	388.75	6360.04	466.70	180.80	116	401.50
Apollo Hosp. [5]	8027.50	7775.00	8028.50	8100.00	7759.00	990.81	9326.80	6680.00	71	7805.10
Apollo Pipes	513.70	532.95	513.70	537.50	511.55	125.94	668.80	252.10	-	-
Apollo Tyres [1]	400.05	401.20	401.95	406.60	400.05	209.13	540.30	365.35	13	400.85
Aptus V Hsg	215.73	219.47	219.44	223.89	217.55	1332.26	322.75	193.03	-	-
Archean Chem	455.05	473.40	455.95	476.00	455.95	156.27	676.00	446.00	-	-
Ardee Indus	47.87	47.93	47.96	49.50	47.50	1213.17	73.19	46.50	-	-
Arfin IndiaL	105.14	106.07	107.52	108.70	105.20	5036.72	113.83	49.00	-	-
Arih.Capital	96.19	96.63	96.19	98.89	95.43	396.35	120.00	56.97	-	-
Arisinfra So	140.31	139.02	140.49	141.56	138.00	281.57	178.30	82.18	-	-
Arkade Dev	118.88	120.06	119.97	121.59	118.80	208.33	180.00	92.62	-	-
Arman Fin	1694.20	1672.50	1693.40	1731.10	1650.90	19.23	2159.10	1302.30	41	1678.35
ARMEE IN	253.90	245.80	256.50	257.00	243.90	430.83	375.00	243.90	-	-
Arrow green	855.65	844.95	881.00	881.00	838.90	21.81	950.00	342.00	22	847.70
Artemis Med	313.20	311.45	313.25	317.60	310.40	162.50	378.80	203.35	-	-
Arvind Fash [4]	402.80	394.25	401.65	405.80	391.10	128.81	572.20	366.60	379	393.70
Arvind Ltd	509.45	511.55	510.90	521.40	510.00	438.52	607.00	278.00	51	511.50
ArvindSmart	598.20	605.40	593.80	611.70	590.00	60.08	707.20	490.35	41	604.30
Asahi Ind. [1]	945.95	944.10	948.00	960.45	940.70	33.12	1072.95	775.05	56	944.30
Ashapura [2]	470.80	471.85	478.00	480.00	468.80	132.45	924.70	456.50	30	471.75
ASHAPURI GOLD	4.36	4.84	4.39	5.23	4.35	1642.79	5.23	4.35	-	-
Ashok Leyl [1]	145.06	144.25	146.85	148.20	144.08	12509.98	215.35	134.20	22	144.40
Ashoka [5]	102.02	106.50	105.00	110.00	104.06	3615.06	214.35	100.35	16	106.65
Asian Energy	450.10	462.00	449.80	466.80	447.05	153.50	565.70	230.00	-	-
Asian granit	45.59	51.54	45.75	53.46	45.51	25812.52	79.08	42.50	-	51.51
Asian Paints [1]	2339.10	2331.00	2362.00	2373.40	2318.00	396.38	2985.50	2116.00	47	2335.00
ASK Auto.	588.15	603.55	595.25	608.40	594.05	91.49	687.70	375.30	-	-
ASSET RECONS	150.54	152.88	153.54	156.60	146.19	1555.81	164.90	124.50	-	-
Asso Alcohol	570.30	586.30	569.50	594.00	569.50	36.54	1277.00	567.00	-	-
ASTECFE	729.30	730.85	729.30	739.85	713.85	22.98	936.00	512.35	-	727.60
ASTERDM	699.85	679.40	699.85	701.65	673.30	1153.01	890.95	519.80	191	681.75
Astha Spint	27.65	27.44	27.64	28.24	27.26	379.44	140.01	27.26	-	-
Astra Micro [2]	1652.90	1689.80	1664.50	1692.50	1656.30	223.94	1960.00	835.90	92	1687.20
Astral Poly [1]	1409.80	1430.40	1415.20	1444.80	1412.80	459.98	1767.95	1111.90	58	1438.85
AtherEnergy	1434.40	1511.00	1435.00	1511.00	1432.00	3581.45	1744.00	582.05	-	-
Atlanta Elec	1769.50	1846.00	1796.00	1869.00	1775.00	139.75	2152.60	707.60	-	-
ATUL AUTO [5]	416.60	416.10	414.55	423.45	413.00	40.57	596.65	381.00	21	417.10
ATUL.	5882.50	5978.50	5891.00	6017.00	5891.00	53.07	7198.20	5563.00	25	5974.35
AU SFB	982.00	977.20	987.50	992.40	968.90	1073.82	1144.65	761.05	26	974.70
AUGMONT ENTE	1337.80	1368.50	1381.80	1404.60	1340.40	994.28	1404.60	806.05	-	-
Aurionpro So	601.60	607.15	608.70	623.00	602.00	117.04	1247.15	595.00	31	607.65
Aurob Ph [1]	1693.00	1706.90	1692.50	1715.00	1681.00	1190.87	1739.95	1080.10	38	1702.75
Aurum Prop	232.77	228.12	235.50	235.86	226.25	37.19	264.64	151.90	-	-
Authum Inv	549.70	551.85	549.70	560.00	549.05	87.58	3318.70	400.00	-	-
Avadh Sugar	945.75	987.25	950.05	997.95	947.55	233.11	997.80	307.75	29	988.70
Avalon Tech	2300.50	2378.00	2314.00	2424.00	2284.30	267.41	2618.00	777.30	-	-
Avantel	143.98	150.77	146.09	152.40	146.09	1439.88	203.38	117.05	-	-
Avanti Feeds [1]	699.10	706.50	702.60	716.00	702.60	131.08	1592.30	650.55	21	706.60
AvenueSai	14.90	13.83	14.91	15.03	13.61	42602.78	20.50	12.92	-	-
Avro India	5.43	4.98	5.47	5.69	4.80	896.27	158.70	4.80	-	-
AVT Natur [1]	94.78	97.50	96.00	101.74	94.79	1879.40	101.80	53.34	22	98.01
Awfis Space	247.03	245.96	247.35	253.00	244.10	242.47	639.40	229.05	-	-
Axis Bank [2]	1259.10	1253.00	1265.40	1265.40	1244.00	5684.91	1418.30	1150.50	15	1256.00
AXISCADES [5]	2082.30	2033.10	2089.00	2105.90	2022.00	122.03	2360.00	1061.00	-	2030.60
Aye Finance [2]	156.94	161.73	156.75	163.41	156.75	353.49	197.95	156.50	21	161.65
Azad Engg	2910.20	2968.40	2941.00	3043.20	2932.20	554.19	3127.90	1360.00	-	-
B										
Baazar Style	376.05	379.30	376.95	386.40	376.20	310.32	447.10	229.95	-	-
BAJAJ AUTO	9778.00	10034.00	9876.00	10138.00	9870.00	313.93	12470.00	8606.00	26	10060.00
Bajaj Cons [1]	506.95	492.40	507.00	507.00	488.80	352.37	691.15	242.80	29	492.60
Bajaj Elect [2]	298.00	298.85	296.00	301.95	295.05	70.14	561.05	289.35	-	298.20
Bajaj Fin [1]	960.00	957.25	960.00	972.85	954.00	5044.93	1177.60	788.40	33	960.85
Bajaj Finser [1]	1734.70	1719.90	1746.30	1752.30	1710.70	565.06	2194.65	1598.15	124	1714.10
Bajaj HCare	320.00	330.65	320.00	332.95	318.00	218.79	490.00	272.35	-	-
Bajaj Hindus [1]	20.42	21.12	20.55	21.35	20.42	19685.73	26.00	14.89	-	21.13
Bajaj Holdng	10820.00	10750.00	10820.00	10969.00	10714.00	25.29	13245.00	8597.50	40	10793.75
Bajaj HsgFin	81.51	81.29	81.70	82.50	81.22	2038.19	112.40	72.65	-	-
Bajel Proj.	157.26	156.27	165.50	168.89	154.31	915.71	215.50	135.10	-	-
Balaji Amine [2]	2040.80	2062.30	2064.90	2110.20	2055.00	188.18	2627.95	905.15	34	2062.40
Balkrish Ind [2]	2010.30	1996.80	2025.00	2028.60	1984.10	123.22	2775.00	1971.50	28	1995.85
BalmerLawrie	156.98	157.05	156.45	158.74	156.00	90.21	205.95	148.35	11	157.25
BalramChini [1]	678.15	700.80	685.90	705.00	683.45	1140.30	781.00	393.40	43	700.95
Balu Forge	481.20	476.00	486.10	490.60	473.40	348.77	672.35	341.05	-	-
Banco Prod [2]	590.80	593.20	591.20	601.15	589.30	60.51	865.45	503.00	20	591.85
Bandhan Bk	157.00	157.50	157.80	161.00	156.50	6411.44	220.70	134.30	19	157.35
Bank of Maha	83.16	83.00	83.17	83.87	82.24	10916.98	94.50	54.70	9	83.00
Bansal Wire	315.80	319.80	319.95	324.00	315.00	69.01	370.00	222.50	-	-
BASF India	3347.40	3378.20	3340.00	3443.40	3340.00	10.26	4618.30	2906.90	24	3377.05
Bata India [5]	613.25	609.75	613.25	619.05	599.65	158.10	1184.95	600.30	45	609.75
Bayer Crop	3492.00	3538.90	3492.00	3578.40	3490.00	34.31	5133.00	3366.10	22	3541.75
BCL Ind.	30.26	30.10	30.30	30.98	29.92	390.50	41.00	25.53	-	-
BDL [5]	1075.90	1089.00	1081.30	1103.00	1081.30	509.52	1633.15	1048.25	77	1092.00
Behari Lal	495.60	504.65	498.75	508.70	483.00	693.97	548.00	415.00	-	-
Belrise Inds	234.17	234.97	235.39	240.04	233.25	1545.91	268.20	142.59	-	-
BEML [5]	1894.70	1950.50	1899.00	1960.00	1895.00	153.86	2276.75	1361.10	88	1950.50
BergerPaints [1]	471.90	470.20	471.90	476.25	466.45	189.61	594.20	391.50	46	469.35
Best Agroli	16.78	17.03	16.87	17.34	16.55	514.04	464.15	12.30	-	-
Beta Drugs	1950.20	1844.30	1950.00	1974.90	1835.00	53.17	2807.90	990.10	-	-
BF UTILI [5]	469.10	463.25	471.50	479.90	461.70	38.46	812.55	369.00	-	463.30
BHAGIL [5]	364.90	380.35	360.00	383.00	358.20	140.64	424.70	128.15	22	381.00
BHANSALI [1]	124.89	125.35	125.95	128.25	124.48	705.87	138.50	75.52	16	125.50
BHARAT B [5]	2189.00	2332.90	2180.50	2373.60	2180.50	87.61	3403.40	2009.45	24	2328.50
Bharat Elect [1]	368.15	373.90	370.00	375.20	370.00	8428.54	473.25	360.80	45	373.60
Bharat Forge [2]	1816.90	1815.30	1814.60	1839.60	1806.60	1189.32	2293.00	1200.00	72	1815.00
Bharat Wire	167.78	162.82	166.56	169.76	162.05	197.31	262.20	149.15	16	162.95
BharatCoking	31.12	30.73	31.20	31.44	30.60	3375.98	45.09	29.74	-	-
BharatSeats	210.18	210.98	212.48	216.48	207.27	188.94	263.18	133.60	-	-
Bharti Airte [5]	1805.10	1778.70	1805.30	1809.00	1758.60	4819.38	2174.70	1726.05	64	1778.00
Bharti Hexa	1531.90	1521.30	1531.90	1541.40	1505.40	150.76	1955.60	1359.20	-	-
BHEL [2]	433.60	439.90	435.20	441.20	433.10	8403.72	455.90	229.70	64	439.20
Bikaji Fds	472.05	470.35	473.05	480.60	468.00	147.34	768.50	464.50	-	-
Billionbrain	192.39	192.61	194.12	195.16	190.79	19275.94	227.20	112.00	-	-
Biocon [5]	349.40	346.35	348.10	351.80	345.10	2632.16	447.00	337.95	187	345.25
BIRLA CORPN.	817.30	815.50	811.30	823.50	811.10	100.99	1245.70	773.90	26	816.60
Birla Eric	385.20	387.10	385.20	391.15	372.30	336.55	418.00	104.00	25	387.15
Birlasoft	285.30	272.85	285.50	288.00	269.20	1662.80	474.00	267.05	-	-
Bk of baroda [2]	235.80	235.40	237.77	237.89	233.38	3198.23	325.55	223.90	6	235.00
Bk of India	134.46	133.40	134.96	135.55	132.11	6324.41	178.45	122.20	5	133.05
BL kashyap [1]	55.27	57.02	55.00	58.60	54.59	1355.40	63.60	40.79	23	57.04
Black Box	892.10	924.60	904.00	930.00	897.45	1459.45	1103.00	444.30	-	-
BLACK ROSE	107.30	104.84	106.77	109.39	104.45	19.83	129.90	80.05	-	-
BLS [1]	216.23	216.81	216.50	221.60	215.25	485.75	343.10	212.15	61	216.95
BLS e-Svc	149.35	145.90	149.00	153.30	145.30	494.59	339.80	124.30	-	-
Blue CloudSo	19.86	19.75	19.86	20.14	19.61	1945.92	24.50	18.85	-	-
Blue Jet Hlt	514.60	518.90	516.10	530.00	516.10	153.51	688.50	325.00	-	-
Blue Star [2]	1574.00	1570.00	1584.00	1593.70	1553.50	190.20	2032.00	1432.00	90	1564.90
BlueDart Exp	4560.40	4564.20	4600.00	4670.00	4560.00	11.77	7030.15	4460.05	34	4560.90
BluestoneJew	817.65	794.25	817.00	820.30	790.45	422.97	969.90	399.80	-	-
BluspringEnt	146.96	157.01	146.50	164.87	144.18	6455.82	164.87	43.98	-	-
BMW Ventures	57.95	63.25	62.28	64.37	59.50	2273.65	73.20	48.00	-	-
Bom Dyeing [2]	97.11	96.39	98.00	99.71	95.67	615.16	178.05	92.10	94	96.45
BombayBu [2]	1222.10	1245.40	1226.90	1252.40	1224.40	79.77	2135.00	1205.35	108	1246.20
Borosil	270.20	270.40	270.15	273.05	264.90	90.32	363.40	213.73	-	-
Borosil.Ren.	430.40	427.70	431.80	436.50	426.00	203.16	721.00	374.40	-	-
Borosil.Sci.	107.27	109.86	107.90	111.99	107.00	37.39	180.80	96.64	-	-
Bosch Home	1980.20	1922.30	1980.20	2020.00	1911.20	33.43	2037.00	1021.30	-	-
BOSCH	43545.00	44585.00	43545.00	44585.00	43530.00	20.33	49629.50	28650.05	56	44503.80
BPCL	287.80	284.50	289.80	291.55	284.50	4312.62	391.85	266.55	8	285.00
BrainbeesSol	169.17	169.17	170.02	171.83	168.12	892.96	371.75	163.37	-	-
Brigade	548.80	578.00	547.90	583.00	547.85	684.06	801.56	461.25	54	578.40
BrightcomGr [2]	9.05	8.98	9.05	9.15	8.97	3380.07	15.12	7.71	-	8.98
Britannia [1]	4825.00	4774.50	4825.00	4844.60	4752.10	65.62	6269.90	4736.00	44	4780.00
Brooks Lab	70.13	65.54	70.00	73.45	64.51	160.79	131.00	36.90	42	65.68
BSE	3287.20	3330.20	3311.00	3364.40	3296.70	3342.32	4446.80	2326.10	-	-
C										
Caliber Mini	529.25	563.20	536.35	572.30	527.10	788.62	624.40	460.00	-	-
Camlin Fine [1]	89.98	89.44	90.17	91.50	89.11	266.56	204.35	88.27	-	89.33
Campus Act.	197.00	196.19	198.49	200.26	195.40	466.16	287.80	195.40	-	-
CAMS	672.50	679.05	676.45	689.70	675.85	1251.06	4065.00

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Patanjali Fd	360.45	361.35	359.95	361.50	356.20	1397.37	614.05	328.20	-	-
Patel engg [1]	24.98	24.92	25.09	25.37	24.76	2606.69	37.43	22.08	6	24.96
Patel Retail	238.28	245.46	238.39	249.00	238.39	178.05	266.00	150.25	-	-
Paushak	700.35	724.35	708.20	735.90	702.35	49.56	826.75	342.50	-	-
PayTM	1636.00	1690.00	1638.70	1690.00	1637.20	2236.20	1855.50	930.60	-	-
PB Fintech	1012.00	1047.00	1012.00	1059.00	1010.10	2985.02	1964.20	945.10	-	-
PC Jeweller [1]	14.81	15.00	15.00	15.50	14.90	602153.15	15.50	7.45	-	15.00
PCBL	312.40	315.00	315.00	322.70	313.55	691.89	385.80	226.50	-	-
PDS	336.00	333.55	338.00	340.90	332.10	45.81	418.50	246.05	-	-
PENNAR IND [5]	171.50	172.96	172.90	176.23	172.15	224.12	279.80	128.90	23	173.00
PERSISTENT [5]	5770.00	5787.00	5770.00	5830.00	5736.00	332.43	6597.00	4242.65	53	5777.00
Petronet LNG	291.50	290.50	294.00	294.05	288.50	1341.07	326.40	235.45	11	290.30
Pfizer Ltd.	3808.20	3872.40	3809.10	3891.90	3809.10	13.11	5561.55	3732.00	23	3876.80
PG Electro [1]	511.80	525.00	514.10	528.15	511.35	1695.76	644.90	436.85	137	524.20
PGIL [5]	1281.10	1331.40	1290.00	1344.00	1285.60	215.29	1356.55	630.03	213	1330.30
Phoenix Mill [2]	1813.10	1840.00	1804.80	1852.40	1804.80	517.07	2168.65	1465.30	210	1837.90
PhysicsWall	143.69	140.26	142.00	144.70	138.56	11397.74	161.99	77.72	-	-
PI INDUS. [1]	2118.20	2131.50	2131.00	2153.70	2118.20	75.51	3829.90	2102.00	23	2123.40
PiccadilyAgr	580.70	575.15	585.00	589.15	569.85	76.87	809.70	515.00	-	-
Pidilite [1]	1482.00	1477.70	1495.00	1499.80	1462.00	533.42	1707.95	1259.45	59	1476.25
Pine Labs	163.07	163.02	164.85	166.37	161.25	8293.58	284.00	134.73	-	-
Piramal Fin	1971.20	1993.50	1974.00	2019.50	1974.00	82.48	2326.40	1260.00	-	-
Piramal Phr	196.88	196.66	197.29	199.50	194.80	1479.41	231.93	132.30	-	-
Pitti Engg [5]	1023.60	1028.30	1025.90	1052.80	1018.00	98.72	1228.15	677.20	38	1028.30
PLASTIBL [5]	201.79	205.21	202.90	209.90	202.85	211.80	215.95	121.00	12	205.50
PlatinumInd	198.44	202.11	199.90	203.90	198.76	47.41	299.00	183.50	-	-
PN Gadgil Jw	599.95	603.40	607.00	614.90	592.15	914.86	736.40	503.00	-	-
Pnb Gilts	70.44	70.71	70.30	71.50	70.01	199.51	99.90	58.75	13	70.56
PNB Housng	1158.00	1200.00	1162.00	1205.90	1162.00	1808.66	1210.80	730.00	13	1198.80
PNC Infra [2]	134.74	138.26	134.74	138.90	134.74	605.00	291.20	116.25	7	138.30
PNGS Reva Di	687.75	667.85	695.00	707.00	661.65	510.41	738.00	324.25	-	-
POCL Enterp	124.85	132.23	125.57	133.80	124.95	51.74	168.97	123.75	-	-
Pokarna Ltd [2]	687.05	666.65	689.00	703.40	663.00	68.87	1147.35	661.60	-	666.25
Poly Medicu [5]	1587.10	1641.20	1599.00	1649.90	1582.10	54.47	2093.95	1184.00	49	1643.95
POLYCAB INDIA	8255.00	8405.00	8300.00	8469.00	8291.00	456.25	10126.00	6663.00	-	-
Polyplex	1001.30	1003.20	1000.00	1023.80	997.00	53.65	1267.75	743.00	64	1008.45
PonawallaFin	447.30	449.10	476.90	484.00	442.00	28015.92	544.80	361.20	-	-
Pondy Oxides	441.20	426.20	445.00	447.75	423.55	343.37	1619.00	423.55	-	-
Ponni Sug(er	345.60	345.95	344.05	361.30	339.60	406.64	454.20	253.50	10	344.20
Power Finan	327.80	337.90	328.10	337.90	328.10	6955.06	486.45	313.50	6	336.15
Power grid	249.15	249.00	250.90	251.90	247.60	6205.67	324.80	245.40	15	249.25
Power Trad	148.00	149.48	149.48	149.90	148.55	553.62	229.40	146.30	12	149.50
Powerica Ltd	585.45	611.20	593.55	618.00	584.00	220.16	676.95	365.10	-	-
POWERMECH	2419.00	2392.90	2419.00	2456.80	2372.00	28.70	3008.85	1718.00	22	2393.50
Prabha Energ	219.22	220.21	223.58	223.58	218.22	58.83	262.80	137.91	-	-
PRADEEP ME	635.35	643.40	645.15	680.00	610.00	97.03	680.00	357.05	-	-
Praj Ind.ltd [2]	285.80	288.70	286.45	294.75	286.20	517.73	427.75	273.05	38	288.70
Prakash Ind.	118.70	117.42	118.00	120.72	116.50	362.36	173.00	110.00	7	117.20
PRANAV CONS	98.40	98.14	98.38	100.39	96.20	1269.86	165.10	89.10	-	-
PRASOL CH	847.50	824.75	850.00	854.75	804.00	337.62	933.10	601.00	-	-
Precam	111.20	114.10	110.50	116.08	110.50	97.86	198.65	104.05	30	114.05
Precision Wr [1]	482.70	485.15	483.05	490.10	473.15	342.71	524.00	193.10	51	485.30
Premier Enr	895.35	908.85	903.40	908.85	883.80	1272.55	1134.00	660.00	-	-
Premier Expl [2]	687.05	685.95	690.00	692.90	685.10	213.86	829.95	378.80	107	685.70
prestige Est	1406.80	1429.50	1407.30	1461.40	1407.30	494.69	1804.65	1090.45	340	1419.10
Pricol Ltd [1]	670.85	667.00	674.00	680.85	665.00	268.50	822.35	508.80	37	666.80
Prime Focus [1]	261.10	281.95	261.20	303.65	261.10	19806.64	367.25	161.05	-	282.05
Prime Secu [5]	299.45	312.20	302.85	323.40	295.55	232.62	325.00	240.50	41	307.10
Primo Chemic	26.30	26.49	27.30	27.36	25.68	609.04	29.80	16.10	-	-
Prince Pipe	248.95	267.15	249.00	273.00	249.00	1129.72	334.50	205.00	-	-
PRIORITY	325.55	359.25	334.95	386.00	328.30	6966.38	386.00	209.61	-	-
Prism Cement	97.47	97.76	98.05	99.35	97.05	112.38	165.80	95.35	49	98.30
Pritika Auto	15.86	15.48	17.00	17.00	14.66	579.11	20.99	10.41	-	-
Privi Speclt	3424.10	3355.80	3463.40	3463.40	3320.00	68.78	3785.30	2470.00	-	-
Procter&Gam	6942.50	6950.50	7010.50	7019.50	6916.50	6.57	14300.60	6575.70	28	6962.60
ProstarmInfo	127.46	127.84	127.95	130.33	127.10	71.11	208.65	114.64	-	-
Protean EGov	640.65	629.70	643.80	647.00	626.00	268.95	885.00	444.00	-	-
Prozone Rlty	53.62	53.00	53.21	55.20	49.81	340.51	72.77	39.55	-	-
Prudent Corp	3254.70	3163.20	3228.60	3295.80	3142.50	29.20	4105.50	2121.00	-	-
PSPPROJECT	747.45	758.30	749.80	765.00	747.45	34.69	1142.00	569.30	45	755.65
PTC Ind.	24535.00	25715.00	24800.00	25875.00	24520.00	52.37	25875.00	14499.00	-	-
PTCFIN SER	26.60	26.47	26.60	26.90	26.34	179.96	40.51	23.78	8	26.44
Pudumjee [1]	92.20	96.05	92.51	107.80	91.62	4880.71	124.40	63.11	10	96.30
Punjab N [2]	116.98	116.00	116.99	117.33	114.76	8980.42	135.15	98.50	6	116.00
PUNJABNSIND	21.01	20.98	21.01	21.19	20.83	856.78	32.47	20.46	11	20.99
Puravankara [5]	207.26	209.83	209.00	213.90	206.50	216.58	288.65	160.00	32	210.00
PVP Ven	50.97	48.43	51.97	51.97	48.43	724.76	72.16	23.10	43	48.58
PVR Inox	1327.20	1401.30	1340.50	1412.00	1340.50	1150.78	1412.00	907.40	-	-

Q

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Quadrant Fut	511.25	483.80	513.00	516.30	477.35	471.88	567.20	248.55	-	-
QualityPower	1547.40	1512.00	1556.90	1560.00	1501.10	260.38	1681.00	581.00	-	-
QUESS	321.35	333.60	320.00	335.00	319.00	212.00	386.35	166.05	20	333.30

R

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
RACL Geartch	1460.60	1504.90	1480.00	1550.00	1433.40	46.08	1927.70	921.80	-	-
RadiKhait [2]	4550.00	4555.00	4579.00	4605.80	4505.10	216.67	4747.95	2504.60	87	4545.00
Raghav Prod.	1734.10	1798.50	1748.00	1817.00	1715.60	88.21	1943.70	561.30	-	-
Rail Tel	248.15	248.10	250.00	253.60	247.00	563.84	391.00	245.00	-	-
RAIN [2]	215.42	217.96	216.73	223.00	215.62	3191.27	251.95	99.85	-	218.25
Rainbow Ch.	1250.20	1229.00	1260.00	1262.80	1222.00	211.30	1610.00	1084.00	-	-
Rajoo Engine	59.45	62.20	60.80	63.23	59.96	819.73	93.09	46.00	-	-
Rajratan Glo	450.80	455.95	450.00	462.00	450.00	33.85	563.95	308.35	-	-
Rajsh.sugar	27.50	30.99	27.50	31.60	27.50	252.08	45.48	22.80	-	31.02
Rallis India [1]	198.06	200.11	198.06	200.85	197.21	273.12	304.15	194.00	17	200.10
Ram Ratna Wr	584.25	583.50	586.10	594.65	580.20	75.41	669.20	268.00	-	-
Ramco Systm	542.90	539.10	545.40	550.45	529.00	57.54	968.20	342.50	67	539.85
Ramco Cem [1]	807.55	804.85	810.70	815.05	800.10	92.36	1214.00	800.20	102	802.25
Ramco Inds. [1]	291.80	292.95	293.00	296.85	289.30	62.70	395.80	230.70	20	293.20
Rana Sugars	13.18	13.40	13.29	13.67	12.92	353.76	16.45	10.05	-	13.33
RANE MADRAS	1285.20	1297.40	1301.00	1313.40	1291.10	11.58	1439.45	612.50	28	1302.95
Rashi Perip.	889.70	907.35	903.60	928.40	883.50	222.08	1004.70	316.30	-	-
Rashtr.chem.	104.44	104.27	105.40	106.44	103.30	735.44	157.40	103.10	14	104.45
RatanindiaEn	24.95	24.87	25.00	25.53	24.80	800.02	54.39	23.89	-	-
Rategain Tr.	853.65	862.25	852.00	865.00	849.20	116.97	1050.00	437.00	-	-
Ratnamn M [2]	2523.60	2547.10	2548.50	2595.00	2531.00	21.08	3342.35	1900.05	51	2550.00
Ratnaveer Pr	343.60	331.65	345.00	345.10	324.10	4233.09	357.70	130.50	-	-
Ravindra Enr	141.49	138.19	141.49	144.00	135.05	156.18	196.45	117.07	-	-
Raymond	1186.60	1157.90	1193.10	1217.90	1151.00	606.61	1338.30	320.40	-	1157.85
Raymond Life	596.40	575.20	605.00	605.00	572.00	242.08	1246.40	572.00	-	-
RaymondReal	698.20	682.80	702.00	707.35	675.50	687.43	741.95	349.00	-	-
RAYS OF BELIEF	215.56	210.33	214.00	220.00	208.00	545.32	267.61	208.00	-	-
RBLBank	418.00	417.70	420.00	424.00	413.80	3453.16	429.55	285.80	74	420.00
RECL	300.00	301.00	300.00	307.70	300.00	6909.26	388.00	286.25	5	302.00
Redington [2]	380.00	390.20	380.25	396.55	380.25	2810.09	419.55	191.25	22	391.10
Redtape	112.77	111.86	113.50	114.38	111.12	186.97	158.99	107.53	-	-
Refex Refrig [2]	254.40	254.35	255.90	259.65	253.80	117.23	382.05	188.00	12	253.90
RegaalResour	84.09	85.27	84.09	87.66	83.25	316.02	103.00	57.27	-	-
Relax Foot [1]	286.00	290.30	287.35	292.35	286.60	67.54	455.45	236.55	39	290.15
Reli Indlnf	683.40	684.90	686.00	694.70	681.15	38.78	932.80	620.50	100	684.65
Reliance	1170.30	1158.90	1180.30	1185.50	1153.20	11338.33	1611.20	1153.10	40	1159.00
Religare ent	217.59	221.78	218.15	227.40	216.02	6484.25	284.85	197.00	-	221.90
Remsons Ind [2]	101.46	103.69	101.93	107.20	101.93	261.81	152.40	75.36	28	103.45
Renaiss.Glo	160.74	164.29	160.59	165.30	159.02	433.30	173.80	85.00	-	-
RENTOMOJO	590.35	593.65	591.95	632.25	583.00	4429.79	648.00	482.45	-	-
REPCO HOME	329.40	327.95	330.00	342.00	326.55	82.50	455.40	325.70	4	327.95
RestaurBrand	91.10	91.43	91.35	92.13	91.00	933.00	111.15	57.15	-	-
Rhetan TMT L	17.40	16.67	17.45	17.49	16.53	3009.25	34.87	14.42	-	-
RHI Magnesit	369.10	369.80	373.00	374.65	368.30	133.34	499.60	323.05	-	-
Rico Auto [1]	115.18	116.03	115.99	119.00	115.46	472.09	157.90	78.10	56	116.20
RIR Power El	174.12	175.10	175.10	179.00	173.31	302.83	213.94	154.00	-	-
Rishabh Ins	677.90	679.55	695.00	712.60	674.00	283.16	852.00	315.00	-	-
RITES	198.66	198.79	200.85	201.80	197.37	473.64	259.30	175.10	24	199.15
RK Forgings [2]	685.45	693.60	688.95	699.20	685.00	273.05	772.40	460.15	104	692.55
Rolex Rings	169.14	172.45	170.99	174.43	168.81	1453.95	1349.90	99.79	-	-
Rossari Bio	409.80	426.00	409.80	429.00	404.10	86.68	690.30	375.00	-	-
Rossell Tech	1574.80	1572.00	1570.00	1599.00	1551.50	105.44	1699.00	551.90	-	-
Roto Pumps	60.09	60.88	60.00	61.80	59.63	204.97	80.77	47.50	-	-
Route Mobile	416.70	418.10	421.55	429.80	413.45	206.60	769.45	410.70	-	-
RPG lifesc [8]	2719.20	2863.50	2705.10	2894.90	2705.10	29.77	3130.50	1731.25	41	2859.35
RPOWER	20.01	19.85	20.01	20.28	19.72	21557.02	47.68	19.10	-	19.88
RR Kabel	2705.60	2721.50	2731.80	2769.00	2705.60	211.76	2983.80	1218.90	-	-
RSystems Int [1]	274.30	260.65	266.70	269.30	256.65	2417.98	435.65	213.50	13	261.45
RTNPOWER	6.54	6.63	6.68	6.68	6.58	8277.64	11.69	6.33	-	6.64
Rubicon Rese	1548.50	1540.20	1557.60	1569.50	1523.90	120.70	1899.00	570.75	-	-
RUNWAL ENT	262.55	273.10	264.35	277.60	264.35	509.96	307.75	258.85	-	-
RUPA & CO [1]	124.74	125.11	123.72	127.44	123.70	124.13	205.25	109.50	12	124.95
RVNL	190.65	192.74	191.00	195.97	191.00	3633.36	400.70	186.90	-	-

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
S&W Solar	162.12	167.77	163.79	168.51	163.00	1116.49	260.80	148.00	-	-
SaatvikGreen	395.95	398.05	402.00	408.00	395.40	107.00	565.00	328.00	-	-
Safari Ind	1319.60	1316.70	1311.00	1422.00	1303.10	82.02	2507.10	1280.00	-	-
Sagility Ind	44.00	43.19	44.03	44.49	43.00	5958.32	57.89	35.83	-	-
Sai Life Sci	1487.90	1471.30	1489.00	1505.20	1464.00	380.93	1697.00	783.85	-	-
Sai Parenter	493.90	504.00	493.20	515.70	488.10	178.94	706.00	400.00	-	-
Sai Silks	75.14	74.53	75.50	76.09	74.35	345.40	223.03	73.10	-	-
Sakar Health	1011.50	981.50	1023.90	1026.10	964.60	107.91	1229.85	345.50	-	-
SAKSOFT [1]	138.79	137.18	138.79	141.12	136.10	208.47	222.50	108.00	22	137.05
SALASAR [1]	4.08	4.13	4.08	4.16	4.08	3160.27	11.53	3.81	-	4.15
SALSTEEL	85.89	86.46	85.40	88.75	84.50	419.92	102.40	26.20	-	87.37
SambhvStee	160.41	161.59	161.80	163.59	156.80	3151.90	171.70	81.42	-	-
Samhi Hotels	141.90	144.07	143.00	145.80	142.00	290.91	217.30	127.00	-	-
Samman Cap.	126.44	132.44	126.55	133.00	126.55	5108.16	192.95	125.66	-	-
Samvard.Moth	153.00	156.99	153.00	156.99	152.77	7845.51	173.27	101.08	-	-
Sanathan Tex	503.20	523.65	512.00	531.20	510.00	59.98	544.30	352.60	-	-
Sandhar	530.30	532.85	534.70	549.95	527.10	112.20	764.10	423.90	17	534.10
Sandur Mang.	177.68	178.17	177.80	180.11	176.30	283.92	273.00	170.51	-	-
Sanghvi M [1]	392.60	392.05	392.60	405.00	389.25	229.11	532.40	221.00	21	391.80
Sanofi Cons.	3581.70	3559.70	3580.90	3666.20	3549.60	5.38	5255.00	3540.00	-	-
Sanofi ind	2945.40	2932.80	2945.40	2980.90	2920.00	11.45	4896.00	2915.70	20	2932.40
Sansera Engg	4124.70	4228.20	4120.00	4244.00	4106.60	137.80	4743.50	1382.70	-	-
Sanstar	101.90	99.01	101.10	102.78	98.10	111.62	137.49	74.30	-	-
Sapphire Fd	207.08	199.54	206.02	210.18	197.85	606.33	310.50	139.91	-	-
Sarda EnMin [1]	481.15	479.65	484.60	494.00	474.50	188.41	624.00	452.75	19	479.85
Saregama (I) [1]	485.60	497.90	484.00	503.35	484.00	216.81	574.85	305.65	41	497.70
SarveshwarFd	3.66	3.86	3.66	3.97	3.66	4713.59	6.05	2.50	-	-
SASKEN COMM	1566.10	1557.20	1576.00	1608.80	1532.00	33.56	2785.05	993.05	27	1559.30
Satia Ind.	68.06	69.47	70.00	70.00	67.91	84.93	80.23	50.80	-	-
SATIN	223.87	226.42	227.00	227.89	221.30	112.92	274.20	136.25	7	226.10
SBC Exports	62.43	64.18	63.00	64.83	62.68	25712.28	64.83	22.19	-	-
SBFC Fin.	84.40	87.27	84.90	89.77	84.63	3619.67	123.00	79.60	-	-
SBI Cards	562.00	558.70	562.10	569.55	558.00	373.73	965.00	547.65	-	-
SBI FUNDS MAN	500.00	518.55	500.10	522.90	500.10	2082.05	624.95	494.00	-	-
SBILIFE	1684.60	1680.80	1688.90	1700.50	1658.00	809.69	2132.90	1653.00	65	1694.30
SChand Co [5]	140.88	138.18	142.00	142.00	132.91	124.00	197.00	128.00	47	139.30
SchlossBanga	587.50	594.75	589.90	600.95	573.50	131.36	609.00	384.50	-	-
SCHNEIDER [2]	1176.90	1185.60	1193.50	1210.00	1178.10	104.09	1548.30	572.60	146	1185.40
ScodaTubes	120.24	118.13	119.10	122.99	117.20	125.37	181.48	110.00	-	-
SE INVESTM [1]	80.90	82.54	80.30	83.63	80.30	10352.10	94.84	30.00	30	82.58
Sedemac Mech	3229.80	3223.20	3245.80	3258.00	3140.00	202.95	3650.00	1413.10	-	-
Senco Gold	334.75	332.80	338.00	343.30	330.10	1859.75	430.00	276.00	-	-
Senores Phar	1320.00	1318.70	1335.10	1349.00	1311.00	130.50	1599.00	705.10	-	-
SEPC	5.28	5.71	5.55	5.81	5.41	66803.79	11.79	4.65	-	-
Servote.Pwr	69.05	68.81	69.15	70.00	68.25	270.25	128.50	57.51	-	-
Sesha.paper [2]	222.49	221.94	222.49	227.39	220.70	607.60	311.00	210.15	17	222.00
Seshaasai Te	349.05	347.75	355.90	355.90	346.00	34.19	434.70	209.11	-	-
SFL [5]	603.65	612.15	605.85	621.00	605.85	77.68	832.00	460.75	44	612.10
SG Mart L	775.60	764.10	786.20	797.00	760.00	258.25	860.60	313.10	-	-
SGFinserveLt	676.05	688.55	679.50	703.40	679.50	615.95	727.45	323.00	-	-
Sh Renu Sug [1]	21.72	22.43	21.90	22.63	21.81	11945.76	30.80	20.92	-	22.35
Shadowfax Te	294.85	295.00	302.00	302.35	279.15	11058.55	302.35	98.55	-	-
Shaily Eng	3063.40	3156.70	3100.00	3171.90	3080.80	135.27	3615.20	1770.90	-	-
SHAKTI PUMPS	419.00	416.90	422.70	428.50	413.10	413.17	834.85	415.40	27	418.30
SHALBY	131.84	132.83	131.60	134.64	131.01	45.16	260.10	125.70	13	133.10
Shank Jewel	93.03	98.58	94.61	101.34	93.49	10457.83	115.90	86.58	-	-
Shankara Bld	117.57	118.21	119.95	121.59	117.92	52.03	152.85	98.50	-	118.25
Shankara Bui	246.50	227.90	245.20	247.80	225.30	783.42	1380.00	225.30	-	-
Shanti EduIn	178.68	179.05	178.67	183.68	177.03	170.75	239.96	172.90	-	-
Shanti Gear [1]	562.40	542.30	560.10	574.90	534.30	50.32	741.80	385.70	62	546.75
ShantiGoIInt	380.55	386.70	385.00	397.80	376.30	4733.59	397.80	155.00	-	-
Sharat Inds	155.80	158.71	157.40	160.79	152.50	176.43	179.99	130.60	-	-
Sharda Crop	723.90	727.65	721.00	736.00	721.00	38.23	1297.80	698.15	9	727.75
SHARDA M [2]	872.30	900.15	872.30	916.70	872.30	51.56	1189.00	701.85	16	900.25
ShareInd Sec	182.71	182.91	183.40	187.00	181.06	887.63	233.35	115.36	-	-
Shilchar Tec	3925.30	3867.10	4000.00	4085.40	3850.00	25.47	5399.00	2852.50	-	-
SHILPA ME [1]	1021.70	1013.90	1045.00	1046.90	1007.60	352.04	1095.65	260.00	127	1015.10
Shipping Cor	277.25	281.55	278.95	283.60	278.25	1207.52	368.50	195.45	8	281.30
Shiprocket L	130.18	134.11	130.30	137.80	130.30	10592.24	156.90	116.64	-	-
Shivalik Bi	1041.60	1100.70	1040.10	1145.70	1033.10	512.43	1215.70	368.60	-	-
Shivalik Ras	349.45	355.05	353.30	357.90	344.15	40.95	471.00	206.40	-	-
SHK	136.61	136.87	136.15	139.75	135.96	187.73	230.55	111.70	-	136.95
SHOPPER S [5]	385.10	385.20	382.40	395.45	380.45	17.79	541.70	267.00	-	385.70
Shree Cem	22080.00	21860.00	22085.00	22375.00	21700.00	37.00	30274.00	21365.00	52	21887.20
ShreejiShipp	811.80	823.50	814.00	825.00	813.00	545.99	825.00	231.03	-	-
Shringar Hou	221.13	265.35	221.85	265.35	221.50	12953.14	266.50	166.00	-	-
Shriram Fin	940.45	929.40	946.00	952.00	926.85	1976.08	1153.70	658.75	-	-
Shriram Pist	4284.50	4386.70	4287.50	4437.00	4258.30	62.59	4843.00	2525.80	-	-
Shriram Prop	66.83	67.92	67.56	70.95	66.95	358.41	99.44	60.57	-	-
Shukra Pharm	66.94	66.47	67.27	68.89	66.31	1925.55	75.40	40.06	-	-
ShyamMetalic	1060.10	1088.50	1058.00	1092.80	1048.10	268.14	1148.00	746.00	-	-
Siemens Ener	3101.00	3118.10	3130.10	3158.20	3063.90	460.05	3968.00	2115.00	-	-
Siemens Ltd. [2]	3595.00	3654.00	3619.90	3720.50	3610.80	212.25	4149.40	2827.00	102	3670.00
Sigachi Ind	28.52	28.33	28.60	29.16	28.26	1001.79	40.80	16.65	-	-
SignatureGlo	710.05	706.25	716.00	727.90	704.00	211.09	1153.90	695.00	-	-
Silgo Retail	70.42	69.92	71.70	71.70	69.08	51.52	87.50	61.00	-	-
Silver Tou.	131.18	128.72	132.49	134.50	127.50	248.59	1690.20	100.50	-	-
Simp.Inf [2]	246.13	246.35	243.69	252.88	242.14	123.78	317.70	136.00	44	246.80
Sirca Paint	402.70	408.20	403.50	410.95	403.50	99.69	539.00